

■■ India Election & Political News Report

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■ Trending political, election and voting news from India

1. Kiren Rijiju flags 'very serious' concerns over Rahul Gandhi's foreign trips, seeks funding disclosure

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The New Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://www.newindianexpress.com/india/2026/May/15/kiren-rijiju-flags-very-serious-concerns-over-rahul-gandhis-foreign-trips-seeks-funding-disclosure>

■ **Summary:**

Union Minister Kiren Rijiju on Friday described questions raised over Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's foreign trips and their funding as "very serious", and urged the Leader of Opposition to disclose details of his overseas visits to the concerned authorities to avoid possible legal action. The remarks came a day after the BJP questioned Gandhi's foreign travel expenses and sought details of the source of funding, alleging a mismatch between his declared income and expenditure on foreign visits.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP headquarters, party spokesperson Sambit Patra claimed that Gandhi had undertaken 54 foreign trips over the last 22 years, incurring a cumulative expenditure of around Rs 60 crore. Patra alleged that Gandhi's annual income disclosed in election affidavits over the past decade totalled around Rs 11 crore, raising questions over the funding of the trips. Commenting on the issue, Rijiju said the concerns raised over Gandhi's foreign visits were "very serious". "My request to Rahul Gandhi and the Congress party is that (you) please follow the rules

and provide the requisite information to the authorities... Tomorrow, if anything happens, if some actions are initiated, then the government should not be blamed for targeting Rahulji," the Union Minister for Parliamentary Affairs told reporters.

2. India News | Delhi: Janakpuri POCSO Case; Female Teacher Sent to Judicial Custody | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/india-news-delhi-janakpuri-pocso-case-female-teacher-sent-to-judicial-custody-7431824.html>

■ **Summary:**

New Delhi [India], May 15 (ANI): In a fresh development in the Janakpuri POCSO case involving the alleged sexual assault of a three-year-old girl inside a private school, a female teacher has been sent to judicial custody after being arrested based on evidence collected during the investigation. The case pertains to an incident reported on April 30 at a school in West Delhi's Janakpuri, where the minor was allegedly sexually assaulted during school hours. Also Read | Kanye West Delhi Concert May 2026 Cancelled: Organisers Cite Government Security Advisories and High Alert Situation in Capital. Meanwhile, the Delhi Police, through social media, confirmed that they will file an appeal against the bail order of the accused in the said case. In a post on X, it clarified, "Certain media reports alleging harassment or intimidation by police officials are false, baseless and contrary to the actual facts of investigation. The complainant and the child victim were provided a comfortable, child-friendly environment during the inquiry proceedings and were met only for lawful inquiry and counselling." Also Read | NEET UG 2026 Exam Paper Leak: CBI Arrests Kingpin PV Kulkarni, Chemistry Professor Who Used NTA Panel Access to Dictate Leaked Questions in Pune. It mentioned that during the investigation, the accused was arrested immediately, after identification by the victim on the same day.

"Statements of the child and her mother were recorded before the Judicial Magistrate immediately, rel

3. World News | Iran FM Araghchi Assures EAM Jaishankar of Commerce Safety Through St of Hormuz | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/world-news-iran-fm-araghchi-assures-eam-jaishankar-of-commerce-safety-through-st-of-hormuz-7431850.html>

■ **Summary:**

Get latest articles and stories on World at LatestLY. Araghchi clarified that Iran will always carry out historical duty as protector of security in Hormuz. New Delhi [India], May 15 (ANI): Foreign Minister of Iran, Seyyed Abbas Araghchi on Friday held talks with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar where he affirmed that friendly nations can rely on Iran for commerce safety. Araghchi clarified that Iran will always carry out historical duty as protector of security in Hormuz. Also Read | Iran Diplomat Says Nuclear Program Remains Tough Issue with US. In a post on X, he said, "In fruitful engagement with my host External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, discussed regional developments and clarified that Iran will always carry out historical duty as protector of security in Hormuz. Iran is a reliable partner of all friendly nations, who can rely on safety of commerce." <https://x.com/araghchi/status/2055268065055764548?s=20> Also Read | 'The Boys' Season 5 Episode 8 Leaks: Fans React to Homelander's Fate and Billy Butcher's Last Stand Ahead of Series Finale. Araghchi said that Iran's resistance against US' bullying is familiar to all. He called on all member states who have encountered similar instances to step up. In a post on X, he said, "Told BRICS FMs summit: Iran's resistance against U.S. bullying is not an unfamiliar battle. So many of us encounter slight variations of same repugnant coercion. High time for us to jointly step up and work towards making clear that those pra

4. UK leadership hopeful Burnham faces tricky test to return to parliament

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/world/uk-leadership-hopeful-burnham-faces-tricky-test-to-re-turn-to-parliament/2932517/>

■ **Summary:**

On the streets of Ashton-in-Makerfield, a former mining town in the constituency where many struggled after the closure of the coal pits, voters were split between Burnham and Reform. Anthony McCormack, a former miner who retrained as a welder and is now retired, said he would back Burnham because he is "right man for the job" and would "100%" make a better prime minister than Starmer. "The man is not a politician, he's middle management," he said about the British prime minister. Labour voter Alan Birch, who is retired, said he would also rather "get Andy in and see what goes from there," adding that under Starmer things were "going downhill." Starmer is under pressure from dozens of his own lawmakers to set a timetable for his departure after the election losses, and the by-election is yet another twist to a political drama that has sent markets spiralling. Burnham was a member of parliament before becoming Manchester mayor, serving as a minister in Gordon Brown's government and running unsuccessfully for the party leadership in 2010 and 2015. He is not yet formally Labour's candidate for the Makerfield seat but, unlike a previous bid for a parliamentary return earlier this year, the Labour leadership is not expected to block him from entering the race. Labour has represented the area in parliament since 1906, but with the party in crisis and Reform winning all the council seats that were contested in the constituency last week, Burnham's return is far from a foregone concl

5. 'Aagey Badhna Hai To Cycle Hi Vikalp Hai': Akhilesh Targets BJP Over Fuel Price Hike In UP

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Free Press Journal

■ **URL:** <https://www.freepressjournal.in/india/aagey-badhna-hai-to-cycle-hi-vikalp-hai-akhilesh-targets-bjp-over-fuel-price-hike-in-up>

■ **Summary:**

Lucknow: "Aagey badhna hai to cycle hi vikalp hai," Akhilesh Yadav said on Friday as he took a swipe at the BJP government following the latest increase in petrol, diesel and CNG prices in Uttar Pradesh. The remark by the Samajwadi Party chief, posted on social media, carried political undertones as the bicycle is the election symbol of the Samajwadi Party. The remark was seen as both a swipe at rising fuel prices and a political message projecting the bicycle, the Samajwadi Party's election symbol, as an affordable alternative for the common man struggling with inflation. Fuel prices increased across Uttar Pradesh on Thursday, adding to inflation concerns among consumers. In Lucknow, petrol prices rose by Rs 2.84 per litre while diesel prices increased by Rs 3.01 per litre. Following the revision, petrol is now being sold at Rs 97.55 per litre and diesel at Rs 90.82 per litre in the state capital. CNG prices also remained elevated. Officials of Green Gas Limited said the revised rates implemented earlier continue to remain applicable in Lucknow and nearby districts. Praveen Singh, AGM of Green Gas Limited, said CNG prices in Lucknow currently stand at Rs 98 per kilogram. He added that the same rates are applicable in Ayodhya, Sultanpur, Unnao and Agra. In another social media post, Akhilesh Yadav also targeted the BJP government over the delay in allocation of portfolios to newly inducted ministers in Uttar Pradesh. He alleged that the delay reflected internal power struggle

6. Modi's Outreach to the UAE and Europe

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ORF

■ **URL:** <https://www.orfonline.org/research/modi-s-outreach-to-the-uae-and-europe>

■ **Summary:**

From May 15 to 20, the prime minister will visit key powers across West Asia and Europe. The underlying message is India is no longer content with symbolism; it's looking to strengthen partnerships Prime Minister Narendra Modi's five-nation visit to the UAE, Netherlands, Sweden, Norway, and Italy from May 15-20, 2026, underlines the growing sophistication of Indian diplomacy at a time when the international system is undergoing profound structural churn. With geopolitical rivalries sharpening, supply chains fragmenting, and energy markets remaining volatile, New Delhi is seeking to consolidate partnerships that can simultaneously serve its economic transformation and strategic autonomy. At one level, the visit is about economic statecraft. India's external engagement today is increasingly driven by the recognition that domestic growth ambitions cannot be separated from global economic integration. The outreach to Europe and the Gulf reflects New Delhi's effort to position itself as a credible manufacturing, technology, and investment hub amid the reconfiguration of global supply chains. Recent agreements such as the India-EU Free Trade Agreement negotiations gaining momentum and the India-EFTA Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement have already created a favourable backdrop for deeper commercial engagement. As the world navigates the twin challenge of energy insecurity and green transition, India is attempting to diversify both its suppliers and technological partnerships.

7. British PM on Borrowed Time: Labour Slides into Bitter Leadership Fight as Keir Starmer Clings to Power

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Latest Asian, Middle-East, EurAsian, Indian News

■ **URL:** <https://www.eurasiantimes.com/british-pm-on-borrowed-time-labour-slides-into-bitter-leadership-fight-as-keir-starmer-clings-to-power/>

■ **Summary:**

British Prime Minister Keir Starmer is clinging on to power a week after disastrous local and regional election results for his beleaguered Labour Party. Here is what we know as rival Labour politicians manoeuvre for a likely leadership battle that promises to be long, bitter and paralysing for the government. Starmer, 63, survived after his top team mostly rallied behind him following the resignation of four junior ministers, while dozens of Labour MPs called for his departure. Health Secretary Wes Streeting resigned with a withering assessment of Starmer's leadership, but no other senior minister followed, and Streeting crucially did not trigger a leadership contest. Streeting, from Labour's right-wing and long believed to covet the premiership, instead called for a future contest made up of the "best possible field of candidates". Shortly afterward, Greater Manchester mayor Andy Burnham, popular on the party's center-left, unveiled a bid to become an MP that, if successful, would allow him to run in any race. Earlier, ex-deputy prime minister Angela Rayner, a left-wing figurehead among Labour's grassroots, announced that she had settled a long-running tax case seen as an obstacle to a leadership bid. Streeting, Burnham, and Rayner all stopped short of formally launching a bid for the top job, meaning Starmer, who has vowed not to walk away, faces a likely drawn-out wait for any challenge. The prime minister's official spokesman insisted Thursday that Starmer is "getting on

8. Every vote transformative, can choose development or mafia rule, says UP CM

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/every-vote-transformative-can-choose-development-or-mafia-rule-says-up-cm/2932511/>

■ **Summary:**

"Your single vote is working to bring about a transformative makeover -- converting the Gorakhpur-Sonauli route into a four-lane highway. This is the power of your vote. When cast in the right place, it leads to development, ensures security. "It creates employment opportunities for the youth. It provides facilities for our farmers. Every daughter receives protection. Every poor household receives the benefits of government schemes," the chief minister said. He claimed that when the same vote follows divisions based on caste, region or dynastic politics, it gives rise to a culture of mafia rule. "It breeds anarchy and hooliganism. The malicious trend of encroaching upon the lands of the poor and on public properties originates from precisely this source. The 'double engine' government has put an end to it," Adityanath said. He further claimed that the transformation of Uttar Pradesh can be observed today, as before 2017, youth in the state faced a crisis of 'identity'. "Citizens used to hesitate to reveal their identity as residents of Uttar Pradesh when they went outside. Healthcare facilities were non-existent, and farmers were driven to the point of committing suicide...As of today, Uttar Pradesh stands as the state boasting the finest infrastructure across India. "It accounts for a 60 per cent share of the country's expressways. It is the state operating the highest number of airports in India. It is the state running the most extensive metro networks in the nation. Uttar

9. VHP opposes Karnataka move allowing hijab in educational institutions, seeks withdrawal of order

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/vhp-opposes-karnataka-move-allowing-hijab-in-educational-institutions-seeks-withdrawal-of-order/2932504/>

■ Summary:

Bengaluru, May 15 (PTI) The VHP on Friday objected to the Karnataka government's decision allowing hijab in educational institutions across the state and demanded the immediate withdrawal of the order lifting the restriction. The demand comes two days after the state government passed an order allowing students to wear hijab, sacred thread, Shivadhara, and Rudraksha in schools. The government scrapped the BJP government's 2022 order banning hijab in government schools following a hijab versus saffron shawl controversy, which, according to the VHP, reflects "appeasement politics." In a statement, the VHP said that the restrictions imposed vide government order dated February 5, 2022, were issued under Section 133(2) of the Karnataka Education Act, 1983. The order empowered institutions to prescribe uniforms to ensure discipline, uniformity, and the secular character of classrooms. It was founded on the principle that educational spaces must remain free from visible religious markers that create segregation among students.

10. Why are Dalit organisations staging an indefinite protest for the PTCL Act in Karnataka?

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The News Minute

■ **URL:** <https://www.thenewsminute.com/karnataka/why-are-dalit-organisations-staging-an-indefinite-protest-for-the-ptcl-act-in-karnataka>

■ Summary:

The reference here is to the Punjab Agricultural Land Alienation Act, 1901 which classified communities into , and prohibited acquisition of land by the later sets of communities. Two of the most populous Dalit communities were included in the non-agricultural category, prohibiting transfer of lands to them. While the Dalits were not statutorily prohibited from purchasing land in the Princely State of Mysore, other caste-derived disabilities operated to ensure that here too, they were largely landless

labourers. The 1931 Census, considered to be the most comprehensive, showed that while the Depressed Classes comprised only 15% of the population of the state, their share in agricultural labourers was over 36%. Of all the members of Depressed Classes deriving income from agriculture, over 46% were agricultural labourers, while just over 8% were tenant cultivators. Historically, there were two major sources of land ownership among Dalits in the Princely State of Mysore - grants of lands referred to as darkhast lands and gift of lands in lieu of services referred to as inams. The rulers of Mysore took several positive measures in the first half of the 20th century to grant lands to landless members of Depressed Classes either free or at discounted rates. The inams were given to individuals for services rendered to the state (called personal inams) and for services rendered to the village (called village service inams). The village service inams were attached to village offices li

11. CPI protests fuel price hike in Chittoor

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/andhra-pradesh/cpi-protests-fuel-price-hike-in-chittoor/article70983424.ece>

■ **Summary:**

The Communist Party of India (CPI) staged a protest against the increase in petrol, diesel, and commercial LPG cylinder prices at the Gandhi Bomma Centre in Chittoor on Friday (May 15, 2026). CPI district secretary S. Nagaraju said that the rising fuel and gas prices had overburdened the middle-class and poor families, who were already struggling with the increasing cost of living. Nagaraju said the hike in commercial LPG cylinder prices had badly affected small hotels, tea stalls, and roadside eateries. As a result, the prices of common food items such as idli, dosa, and tea has also increased, he said. Criticising the NDA government's "double standards" on fuel price hike, the CPI leader said that it was a betrayal of the people.

The Centre, which kept the prices under control during the election period, hiked them after the polling ended. CPI activists demanded that the Centre immediately roll back the fuel and LPG price hike.

12. West Bengal Assembly proceedings to be telecast live: CM Suvendu Adhikari

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The New Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/west-bengal/2026/May/15/west-bengal-assembly-proceedings-to-be-telecast-live-cm-suvendu-adhikari>

■ **Summary:**

KOLKATA: West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Friday said proceedings of the West Bengal Assembly will be telecast live so that people know what is happening inside the House. Addressing the newly constituted 18th West Bengal assembly after the Speaker election process today, Suvendu said the House would play a key role in "fulfilling the aspirations of the people". He added that it would function in accordance with the Constitutional principles and established rules. "We will move the Assembly forward, keeping the dignity of the Constitution in mind," the CM said. BJP MLA Rathindra Bose was elected unopposed as the Speaker of the Bengal assembly, becoming the first legislator from the northern part of the state to hold the post. The Chief Minister also stressed the need for a strong Opposition in the House.

13. 'Obnoxious statement': Sibal slams Hosabale for referring to attacks by Pakistan as 'pinpricks' - The Tribune

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Tribune

■ **URL:** <https://www.tribuneindia.com/news/india/obnoxious-statement-sibal-slams-hosabale-for-referring-to-attacks-by-pakistan-as-pinpricks/>

■ **Summary:**

Rajya Sabha member Kapil Sibal on Friday attacked the RSS-BJP over Sangh functionary Dattatreya Hosabale's recent remarks on Pakistan, saying it was an "obnoxious statement" as it referred to terror attacks by Pakistan such as in Pahalgam and Mumbai as mere "pinpricks". Sibal said now that Hosabale has advocated for dialogue with Pakistan, he will not be called anti-national for voicing similar views. "If I had said this, I would have been called anti-national or pro-Pakistan. If Hosabale says it then it is right," the former Union minister told a press conference. "What is most obnoxious about this statement is that he calls the attack on Parliament, the 26/11 attack, the Pahalgam attack, as pinpricks. Our sovereignty is attacked and according to the RSS, it is only a pinprick," Sibal said. "The government functions on his (Hosabale) directives. Pakistan has said it is a positive development. So, Hosabale is being equated with India. Who is Hosabale? What kind of politics is this," the Independent MP asked. There would be something behind this, Sibal added. "We can also say that there should be a dialogue with Pakistan, I support it," he said. On Hosabale backing Prime Minister Narendra Modi's appeal for spending wisely to meet the challenges posed by the West Asia conflict, Sibal said such steps should be first taken by the government and the RSS themselves. On Hosabale's comments about Sanatan Dharma, Sibal said the RSS should practise what they preach. "They don't know th

14. "ECI must appear independent": Supreme Court flags executive dominance in selection panel

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** NORTHEAST NOW

■ **URL:** <https://nenow.in/national/eci-must-appear-independent-supreme-court-flags-executive-dominance-in-selection-panel.html>

■ **Summary:**

Guwahati: The Supreme Court urged the Union government, on Thursday, to seriously consider concerns over its strong influence in the appointment of Chief Election Commissioners and Election Commissioners, noting that an independent Election Commission of India is essential for ensuring free and fair elections. During the proceedings, the Bench remarked that the selection panel appears to lack a completely neutral member. It raised concerns over the presence of a Cabinet Minister in the committee, noting that it is unlikely such a member would act independently of the Prime Minister. The judges also questioned whether the role of the Leader of the Opposition in the panel carried meaningful influence, suggesting that decisions may still go through even without consensus. The case relates to a set of petitions challenging the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023. According to the petitioners, the 2023 legislation overrides an earlier Constitution Bench ruling in Anoop Baranwal vs Union of India, which had proposed a selection panel consisting of the Prime Minister, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, and the Chief Justice of India. The new law replaced the Chief Justice with a Union Cabinet Minister appointed on the Prime Minister's recommendation. The court observed that the earlier judgment reflected judicial restraint, but the 2023 law appears to increase executive control over

15. CM-Designate VD Satheesan SLAMS 'Hate Campaigns'

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Asianet News Network Pvt Ltd

■ **URL:** <https://newsable.asianetnews.com/india/cm-designate-vd-satheesan-condemns-hate-campaigns-videoshow-8aha3r7>

■ **Summary:**

Kerala CM-designate V. D. Satheesan strongly defended the secular identity of the state amid rising political tensions. He accused opponents of spreading hate campaigns and said the election result proved Kerala's commitment to secularism. Satheesan also reacted to NEET concerns, BJP criticism, fuel price rise, and clarified that Ramesh Chennithala is 'not upset.'

16. SC Cautions Uddhav Thackeray Faction Over Public Comments On Pending Shiv Sena Split Pleas | Nation

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Ommcom News

■ **URL:** <https://ommcomnews.com/india-news/sc-cautions-uddhav-thackeray-faction-over-public-comments-on-pending-shiv-sena-split-pleas/>

■ **Summary:**

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Friday warned the Uddhav Thackeray-led faction against making public statements suggesting that the apex court was delaying the hearing of petitions relating to the Shiv Sena split. A bench of Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi was hearing a petition challenging the Election Commission of India's decision to recognise the Eknath Shinde camp as the official Shiv Sena, along with a petition filed by Sunil Prabhu challenging the previous Maharashtra Assembly Speaker's refusal to disqualify members of the then Shinde faction. When counsel for the Uddhav Thackeray-led side requested an early hearing, the CJI-led bench said: "First, you stop your people from going to the media and making irresponsible statements saying that the Supreme Court is not deciding." "You seek a date here and then say that the Supreme Court is not deciding. We are issuing a warning. Be careful when using your words. I am not a person who will accept this kind of conduct," CJI Surya Kant said. Senior advocate Devdatt Kamat, appearing for the petitioner side, said his side was ready to argue whenever the top court could allocate sufficient time. "Whenever your lordships have a couple of hours' time for each side, your lordships may fix it," he said, adding that the petitioners were anxious as "for three years, they have been waiting". "We expect cooperation from both sides," the CJI bench observed, adding that "whatever delay has happened at an

17. Kerala CM-Designate Satheesan Faces Challenging Times As Race For Cabinet Berths Begins | Nation

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Ommcom News

■ **URL:** <https://ommcomnews.com/india-news/kerala-cm-designate-satheesan-faces-challenging-times-as-race-for-cabinet-berths-begins/>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram: With V. D. Satheesan now firmly seated in the driver's seat of Kerala politics, the celebration within the Congress camp is quickly giving way to the far more complicated and politically explosive exercise of cabinet formation. And if choosing the Chief Minister itself required 10 days of intense negotiations and delicate balancing, the battle for ministerial berths now threatens to become an even tougher test for both Satheesan and the Congress high command. The Congress-led UDF may have stormed to power with a commanding 102 seats in the 140-member Assembly, but the arithmetic of power sharing is already casting long shadows over the victory celebrations. Out of the 102 seats, the Congress alone accounts for an impressive 63 legislators. Yet, despite the numbers, the party cannot accommodate even a fraction of its ambitious faces. With the constitutional cap restricting the Kerala cabinet to a maximum of 21 members, including the Chief Minister, the Congress is expected to secure only around a dozen positions once seats are apportioned among coalition partners and the Speaker's post is set aside. That is where the real turbulence begins. As always in Kerala's coalition politics, cabinet-making is not merely about seniority or performance. Every berth is weighed against a complex matrix of regional representation, caste equations, religious balance, community influence, and factional compulsions. And this time, the queue outside the ministerial gates is e

18. From 20 Vehicle Convoys To Minimal Escort, Kerala CM-Designate Satheesan Opts To Go Simple | Nation

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Ommcom News

■ **URL:** <https://ommcomnews.com/india-news/from-20-vehicle-convoys-to-minimal-escort-kerala-cm-designate-satheesan-opts-to-go-simple/>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram: Even before formally taking oath as Kerala's next Chief Minister, V. D. Satheesan has moved swiftly to send out a vital political message -- that the era of intimidating VIP convoys, massive traffic blocks, and fortress-style security may soon become a thing of the past. The incoming Chief Minister's instructions to police officials on Friday to drastically trim his security arrangements are being widely seen not merely as an administrative decision, but as a carefully calibrated political statement aimed at preserving the goodwill he built while leading the Opposition. For nearly a decade, the security arrangements surrounding then Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan had repeatedly come under sharp public criticism. Particularly during the latter years of his tenure, Vijayan's movement often involved convoys stretching to 20 vehicles, including pilot cars, multiple escort vehicles, jammer units, armed police teams, and even an ambulance trailing behind. Roads were routinely blocked far in advance, police personnel lined entire stretches of highways, and commuters were frequently stranded for long periods as the convoy passed through cities and towns. The aggressive crowd control measures adopted during protests, especially the intense scrutiny over black masks, black clothes and black flags, had also triggered widespread debate on whether Kerala was witnessing an excessive expansion of VIP security culture. Both inside the Assembly and outside, the then Congr

19. Transport Minister Ponnampalath slams BJP for revising fuel prices

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Telangana Today

■ **URL:** <https://telanganatoday.com/transport-minister-ponnam-slams-bjp-for-revising-fuel-prices>

■ **Summary:**

Transport Minister Ponnam Prabhakar accused the BJP-led Centre of misleading people by raising fuel prices soon after Assembly elections in four States. He said the government had assured voters there would be no hike, but reversed its stance once results were declared, citing the West Asia conflict as justification. Hyderabad: Transport Minister Ponnam Prabhakar criticised that the BJP had deceived people by increasing fuel prices soon after the Assembly elections in four States concluded. He said the BJP-led Union government hiked fuel prices even before the newly elected Chief Ministers assumed office. According to him, the Centre had assured people before the elections that there would be no increase in fuel prices, but went back on its assurance after the results were declared. Speaking to media persons at BRKR Bhavan in Hyderabad on Friday, the Minister said Prime Minister Narendra Modi's recent appeal for austerity measures had already triggered concerns among people over a possible rise in fuel prices. Prabhakar said Union Ministers had earlier maintained that the country had adequate fuel stocks to meet demand for six months. Despite this, the Centre cited the conflict in West Asia as the reason for the hike in prices. He pointed out that the conflict had been continuing for a few weeks and was not an overnight development. The Minister also referred to statements made before the elections by Union Ministers G Kishan Reddy and Bandi Sanjay Kumar, who had assured the

20. Election deepfake laws spread across US ahead of 2026 midterms | Biometric Update

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Biometric Update

■ **URL:** <https://www.biometricupdate.com/202605/election-deepfake-laws-spread-across-us-ahead-of-2026-midterms>

■ **Summary:**

States are moving faster than Congress to regulate synthetic media in political campaigns Maryland has become the 30th U.S. state to enact election deepfake legislation, as lawmakers race to address AI-generated political deception ahead of the 2026 midterms. Gov. Wes Moore signed SB 141 after the bill passed the Maryland Senate in February and the House in April. The measure was approved by the governor and takes effect June 1, 2026. The Maryland General Assembly's bill summary says the law requires and authorizes the state administrator of elections to act after receiving a credible report that election misinformation, election disinformation, or a deepfake has been or is being communicated, disseminated, or distributed. It also requires the administrator to publicly communicate correct information and prohibits a person from knowingly or with reckless disregard creating, using, or disseminating a deepfake to produce materially false information. The signing gives Maryland election deepfake protections at a time when lawmakers across the country are trying to respond to increasingly realistic synthetic audio, images, and video that can depict candidates saying or doing things they did not say or do. Public Citizen, which tracks state election deepfake legislation, says the danger is especially acute when deceptive content is released days or hours before voting, leaving little time for campaigns, journalists, election officials, or voters to verify it. Public Citizen, which

21. BJD MP Patra seeks error-free SIR process in Odisha

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** newKerala.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.newkerala.com/news/a/bjds-sasmit-patra-urges-ec-transparent-error-free-sir-853.htm>

■ Summary:

He raised concerns over approximately 9.8 lakh voters identified for deletion during the state's pre-SIR exercise and sought stronger safeguards to prevent wrongful exclusion of genuine electors. Referring to Odisha's inclusion in Phase III of the nationwide SIR exercise covering around 3.34 crore electors, Patra reiterated the concerns raised in his earlier letters and emails to the Election Commission. He emphasised the need for strong safeguards, accurate field verification, full transparency and accessible grievance redressal mechanisms to ensure that no genuine elector is inadvertently excluded from the electoral rolls during the large-scale revision process. In his letter, Patra stated, "At the outset, I wish to respectfully draw your attention to my earlier representations concerning issues observed during the preparatory phase of the SIR exercise in Odisha, particularly in relation to the approximately 9.8 lakh voter deletions identified during the Pre-SIR exercise... In today's PIB release issued by the Election Commission of India regarding Phase III of the SIR exercise, Odisha has been specifically included among the States where the exercise will be undertaken. The release notes that Odisha has approximately 3,34,33,659 electors and that around 38,123 Booth Level Officers (BLOs) and 8,391 Booth Level Agents (BLAs) will be associated with the exercise in the State. Given the scale of the exercise, the need for procedural accuracy, transparency, and robust safeguard

22. Kerala CM-Designate Satheesan Opts for Simple Security

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** newKerala.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.newkerala.com/news/a/from-20-vehicle-convoys-minimal-escort-kerala-cm-designate-265.htm>

■ Summary:

The incoming Chief Minister's instructions to police officials on Friday to drastically

trim his security arrangements are being widely seen not merely as an administrative decision, but as a carefully calibrated political statement aimed at preserving the goodwill he built while leading the Opposition. For nearly a decade, the security arrangements surrounding then Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan had repeatedly come under sharp public criticism. Particularly during the latter years of his tenure, Vijayan's movement often involved convoys stretching to 20 vehicles, including pilot cars, multiple escort vehicles, jammer units, armed police teams, and even an ambulance trailing behind. Roads were routinely blocked far in advance, police personnel lined entire stretches of highways, and commuters were frequently stranded for long periods as the convoy passed through cities and towns. The aggressive crowd control measures adopted during protests, especially the intense scrutiny over black masks, black clothes and black flags, had also triggered widespread debate on whether Kerala was witnessing an excessive expansion of VIP security culture. Both inside the Assembly and outside, the then Congress-led UDF Opposition repeatedly targeted the Vijayan government over what he termed the harassment of ordinary citizens in the name of security. On several occasions, they accused the Vijayan administration of turning the state machinery into an instrument of fear and inconvenience for com

23. Uttarakhand Electoral Roll Revision: All Set for Phase-III

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** newKerala.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.newkerala.com/news/a/all-preparations-completed-uttarakhand-additional-ceo-sir-phase-iii-967.htm>

■ **Summary:**

This comes after the Election Commission of India (ECI) on Thursday announced the conduct of Special Intensive Revision (SIR) Phase-III of electoral rolls across 16 States and three Union Territories, covering over 36 crore electors in a phased manner. The exercise has been planned in coordination with the ongoing house

listing component of the Census to ensure efficient use of field-level machinery. Speaking to ANI here, Jogdande said the Election Commission of India has announced the Special Intensive Revision campaign for 19 states in its third phase, and all preparations for the exercise in Uttarakhand have been completed under the supervision of Chief Electoral Officer BVRC Purushottam. "The Election Commission of India has announced the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) campaign for 19 states in the third phase. In Uttarakhand, the SIR process will be carried out based on the qualifying date of July 1, 2026. Under the guidance of Chief Electoral Officer Dr. B.V.R.C. Purushottam, all preparations for the SIR exercise have been completed," he said. He further detailed the schedule for the revision process, stating that printing of enumeration forms and training of officials will take place from May 29 to June 7, 2026. "From June 8 to July 7, 2026, Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will carry out door-to-door distribution and collection of enumeration forms. The draft electoral roll will be published on July 14, 2026," he said. The official added that the claims and objections pr

24. Odisha CEO Holds Key Meeting with Political Parties on SIR of Voter Lists

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Pragativadi: Leading Odia Dailly

■ **URL:** <https://pragativadi.com/odisha-ceo-holds-key-meeting-with-political-parties-on-sir-of-voter-lists/>

■ **Summary:**

In a significant push to strengthen electoral integrity, Odisha's Chief Electoral Officer R.S. Gopalan on Thursday chaired a high-level meeting with senior representatives of all seven recognised political parties to fine-tune the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of voter lists. The closed-door discussion, held under the CEO's chairmanship, focused on executing the SIR process efficiently and transforming the state's electoral

rolls into a model of accuracy and transparency. With the goal of including every eligible voter while removing ineligible names, the meeting underscored the vital partnership between the Election Commission and political parties in safeguarding democracy. Gopalan highlighted the indispensable role political parties play in this democratic exercise. "In a vibrant democracy, political parties are not just participants but active partners in ensuring that only genuine voters find a place in the electoral roll," he said, stressing the need for collective efforts to maintain the purity of the voter list. He urged all parties to immediately appoint Booth Level Agents (BLAs) at every polling station to monitor the revision process on the ground and extend full cooperation to election officials. The CEO also threw light on the technical and administrative roadmap of the SIR drive, urging prompt action on key issues. Representatives from the parties actively shared their suggestions and concerns. The discussions revolved around streamlining the registration of

25. India News | RSS Leader Criticises Hijab Ban Withdrawal in Karnataka Schools, Demands Uniform Dress Code | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/india-news-rss-leader-criticises-hijab-ban-withdrawal-in-karnataka-schools-demands-uniform-dress-code-7431768.html>

■ **Summary:**

Chikkodi (Karnataka) [India], May 15 (ANI): Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh RSS North Zone executive member Arvind Deshpande on Friday criticised the move of the Karnataka state government allowing hijab beyond the rules, calling it a strategy to divide society. Speaking to ANI, Deshpande said, "The government's withdrawal of the ban on hijab is not right. There should be a uniform code in schools and colleges. Wearing a hijab makes it difficult to identify. He has expressed concern that this will create confusion as to whether a person is male or female." Also Read | 'Shekhar

Tonite' Premiere Episode 1 Features Nitin Gadkari in Candid Chat With Shekhar Suman, Minister Talks About How the Emergency Affected Him (Watch Full Video). Reacting sharply to the state government's decision, Deshpande said the move was "wrong" and argued that schools must strictly follow a uniform dress code without any religious symbols. "This decision of the government is wrong. There should be a uniform code in schools. There should be neither saffron nor hijab. How can you identify someone if they wear a hijab? You will not know whether they are male or female. Hijab is dividing society into two. The government is doing this just to appease minorities," he said. Also Read | Nagpur Man Arrested for Planting Fake Bomb in Pune Hospital Over INR 7 Lakh Medical Bill Dispute. Deshpande alleged that it was aimed at appeasing a particular community and calling for restrictions on attire that conceals facial

26. World News | US' Treatment of India Has Been Racist: Ex CIA Analyst | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/world-news-us-treatment-of-india-has-been-racist-ex-cia-analyst-7431815.html>

■ **Summary:**

Get latest articles and stories on World at LatestLY. Johnson, in an interview with ANI, said that India ought to have a permanent seat in the United Nations Security Council. New Delhi [India], May 15 (ANI): Former CIA Analyst, Larry Johnson, on Friday said that the US' actions with respect to India were racist on the economic front. Johnson, in an interview with ANI, said that India ought to have a permanent seat in the United Nations Security Council. Also Read | US Woman Shoots Husband Dead for Being 'Too Annoying' While She Recovered From Heart Surgery. "It's also a direct challenge that the countries are going to be expected to buy US treasuries in

order to fund US spending, which is out of control. United States over the last 30 years, instead of being a good leader to show we want to collaborate, we have become a bully. And, you know, India has experienced it as well. We've threatened India; it's racist. It's condescending," he said. Johnson added that the US treated India as if it were a token of Great Britain. Also Read | Sinking AI Stocks Knock Wall Street off Its Records as Stocks Drop Worldwide on Inflation Worries. "India is the one country that ought to have a seat at the national security, at the UN Security Council, a permanent seat, because of its size, because of its importance. But no, it still gets treated like it's some token that belongs to Great Britain...That was reflected in how the United States dealt with you, recently, how Trump dealt with you, de

27. 2020 Election Looms Large in Georgia Secretary of State GOP Primary | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/2020-election-looms-large-in-georgia-secretary-of-state-gop-primary-7431764.html>

■ **Summary:**

ATLANTA (AP) -- The specter of the 2020 election -- when President Donald Trump refused to accept his loss to Democrat Joe Biden -- continues to haunt Georgia and casts a long shadow over the Republican primary for candidates vying to be the state's top election official. Georgia's current secretary of state, Brad Raffensperger, became a household name when he defended the state's election results against Trump's false claims about widespread voter fraud and resisted the president's urging to help "find" enough ballots to win the race. Now that Raffensperger is stepping down to run for governor, election oversight is a key issue in the race to replace him. Some Republican candidates are endorsing the same distortions that Trump did six years ago. The president has stocked the federal government with people who echo his

conspiracy theories, and election denial has spread through state offices as well. Also Read | Trump Says China Will Buy 200 Planes from Boeing, with a Possibility of Expanding the Order. The race comes at a time when lawmakers have made a contradictory mess of state law governing how votes are counted. Gov. Brian Kemp on Wednesday called lawmakers into special session on June 17 for redistricting but also to address a looming deadline on voting. Georgia's touch-screen voting machines print a paper ballot that includes a human-readable list of voters' selections and a QR code that a scanner reads to count votes. Lawmakers two years ago passed a law saying QR co

28. Trump Says China Will Buy 200 Planes from Boeing, with a Possibility of Expanding the Order | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/trump-says-china-will-buy-200-planes-from-boeing-with-a-possibility-of-expanding-the-order-7431762.html>

■ **Summary:**

President Donald Trump said aircraft manufacturer Boeing has a deal to sell at least 200 planes to China Aircraft manufacturer Boeing will make its first major sale to China in nearly a decade with an order for 200 planes, President Donald Trump told reporters on Air Force One on Friday, a deal he said had been made during his summit with China's President Xi Jinping this week and that could grow to as many as 750 planes. The White House has not released details of the deal, and the company itself has not commented. Boeing CEO Kelly Ortberg had joined Trump for the trip to Beijing, one of a large group of CEOs seeking to sell products and services to China. For Boeing, the deal would mark a significant breakthrough in a market that was once central to its long-term growth. Trump also said the deal would benefit General Electric, which he said would supply 400 to 450 engines. General Electric did not

immediately comment on the agreement. Also Read | Starbucks Cuts 300 Corporate Jobs, Shuts Some US Offices in Turnaround Push. Last month, Ortberg signaled confidence that any broader U.S.-China agreement would include aircraft purchases, telling investors he expected Trump's meeting with Xi to be a "meaningful opportunity" for Boeing. Ortberg took over in 2024, a calamitous year for Boeing as it came under intensifying scrutiny over production and quality failures and faced mounting financial pressure. In January 2024, a panel known as a door plug blew off a 737 Max shortly after

29. After NEET aspirant deaths, Rahul Gandhi says 'corrupt system' is killing students - The Tribune

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Tribune

■ **URL:** <https://www.tribuneindia.com/news/india/after-neet-aspirant-deaths-rahul-gandhi-says-corrupt-system-is-killing-students/>

■ **Summary:**

Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Friday held the Narendra Modi-led BJP government responsible for repeated examination paper leaks and recruitment scams, alleging that students across the country were being "destroyed by a corrupt system" that had failed to ensure accountability despite hundreds of exam fraud cases over the last decade. Reacting to the death of 21-year-old NEET aspirant Ritik Mishra from Uttar Pradesh's Lakhimpur Kheri and another student in Goa, Congress MP Gandhi said the country's youth were not losing to examinations but were being crushed by systemic corruption and repeated exam scandals. "These children didn't lose to the exams -- they were killed by a corrupt system. This isn't suicide -- it's murder by the system," Rahul said. Referring to Ritik Mishra, who was appearing for NEET for the third time, Rahul said the student broke down after the examination was cancelled. "'No more competitive exams now' were his last words,"

Rahul said. The Congress leader cited figures to attack the Centre over alleged failures in handling examination frauds, claiming that between 2015 and 2026, the country witnessed 148 exam scams, leading to cancellation of 87 examinations and affecting nearly nine crore students. According to Rahul, only one case out of the 148 scams resulted in punishment. He claimed that while the CBI investigated 17 cases and the Enforcement Directorate (ED) took up 11, "no one was punished". Targeting the government over medical

30. Making Bengal a magnet for industry | West Bengal's Suvendu Adhikari

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** India Today

■ **URL:** <https://www.indiatoday.in/magazine/mandate-2026/story/20260525-making-bengal-a-magnet-for-industry-west-bengals-suvendu-adhikari-2912182-2026-05-15>

■ **Summary:**

Suvendu Adhikari could not have ushered in the new era in Bengal politics on a better day -- May 9, 2026, the 165th birth anniversary of poet laureate Rabindranath Tagore. And the new chief minister and his Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) made the most of it, from the portrait of Tagore on the stage and Rabindra Sangeet during the swearing-in ceremony to Suvendu's visit to Jorasanko Thakurbari, Tagore's ancestral home, where he paid floral tributes to the 'kabiguru' and recited his poem, 'Chitto jetha bhoy shunyo (where the mind is without fear)'. 'Bhoy' (fear), he echoed Union home minister Amit Shah's words, had now given way to 'Bhorosha' (trust).

31. From screenplay to statecraft | Tamil Nadu's C. Joseph Vijay

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** India Today

■ **URL:** <https://www.indiatoday.in/magazine/mandate-2026/story/20260525-from-screenplay-to-statecraft-tamil-nadus-c-joseph-vijay-2912181-2026-05-15>

■ **Summary:**

In his very arrival, C. Joseph Vijay wrought change on Tamil Nadu's polity -- in a tense few days marked by both sparks of confrontation and gestures of rapprochement. That duality was guaranteed by the very nature of his victory. A euphoric one, but at 108 seats, his Tamizhaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) was 10 short of majority. He could no longer be the Outsider to the political system. He needed its support. The ensuing chain of events threatened to strain harmony across the board. Each party that came forward to back him had to endure discord to do so. The Congress had to decide to ditch long-time ally Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK); the Left and the Viduthalaï Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) took time to shed their reluctance and, finally, even a sizeable chunk of the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) defied the party whip and cross-voted in the TVK's floor test on May 13. Tamil politics is braced for aftershocks, while 'Thalapathy' Vijay got a comfortable buffer of 144 MLAs in a 234-member House. The uncertainty behind him, one of the first major statements the new chief minister made was to accuse the previous DMK regime of leaving Tamil Nadu with an "empty treasury" and a mountain of debt. The DMK hit back almost immediately, with former chief minister and party president M.K. Stalin responding that the "money was therewhat was required was efficiency and the political will to deliver". Ordinarily, such an exchange would have set rolling a phase of acrimony. Ins

32. Tackling debt, job drought | Kerala's V.D. Satheesan

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** India Today

■ **URL:** <https://www.indiatoday.in/magazine/mandate-2026/story/20260525-tackling-debt-job-drought-keralas-vd-satheesan-2912180-2026-05-15>

■ **Summary:**

The decision came in pretty late, but it had the stamp of public approval. Ten days after the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) won a resounding victory in the Kerala assembly election, winning 102 of the 140 seats, the Congress high command finally announced leader of the Opposition (LoP) in the outgoing assembly, V.D Satheesan, 61, as the state's new chief minister on May 14. He was chosen over two other party veterans -- AICC general secretary and Alappuzha MP K.C. Venugopal, a strong contender who reportedly had the backing of a majority of the newly-elected MLAs; and former state home minister and Haripad MLA, Ramesh Chennithala. Satheesan is expected to take oath as CM on May 18.

33. 'MVA Must Form Task Force To Prevent Voter Exclusion In Maharashtra Electoral Roll Revision,' Says SP MLA Rais Shaikh

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Free Press Journal

■ **URL:** <https://www.freepressjournal.in/mumbai/mva-must-form-task-force-to-prevent-voter-exclusion-in-maharashtra-electoral-roll-revision-says-sp-mla-raish-shaikh>

■ **Summary:**

Mumbai: A day after the Election Commission announced a Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Maharashtra, Samajwadi Party MLA Rais Shaikh on Friday called upon leaders of the Maha Vikas Aghadi (MVA) to immediately establish a state-level task force to oversee the process and prevent alleged

large-scale voter exclusion. Letter warns of Bihar, West Bengal-like situation In a letter addressed to Maharashtra Congress president Harshvardhan Sapkal, Shiv Sena MP Sanjay Raut, and NCP (SP) state president Shashikant Shinde, Shaikh warned that Maharashtra could witness a situation similar to Bihar and West Bengal if opposition parties failed to act swiftly. Shaikh alleged that similar revision exercises in Bihar and West Bengal had resulted in the alleged exclusion of large numbers of voters, particularly tribals, Dalits, minorities and other vulnerable communities. He claimed that nearly 68 lakh voters in Bihar and 91 lakh in West Bengal were left out during such exercises. Door-to-door BLO visits from June 30 to July 29 The MLA said booth-level officers (BLOs) would conduct door-to-door visits between June 30 and July 29 as part of the SIR exercise. He stressed that voters would require assistance regarding documentation, addition of new names and procedures for filing objections. Shaikh proposed that the MVA task force should train booth-level agents of all alliance parties and coordinate with the Election Commission and the state Chief Electoral Officer to ensure

34. Karnataka SIR Drive To Cover Over 5.55 Crore Voters; Over 59,000 BLOs To Be Deployed

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Ommcom News

■ **URL:** <https://ommcomnews.com/india-news/karnataka-sir-drive-to-cover-over-5-55-crore-voters-over-59000-blos-to-be-deployed/>

■ **Summary:**

Bengaluru: The Chief Electoral Officer, Karnataka V. Anbukumar, has stated that 59,050 Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will be involved in the revision process across the State. The Special Intensive Revision is expected to cover approximately 5,55,74,064 electors in Karnataka as of May 12, 2026. The Chief Electoral Officer's office has appealed to voters to cooperate fully with BLOs during the house-to-house verification

exercise. It may be noted that the Election Commission of India (ECI) has directed the conduct of a Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Karnataka as part of a nationwide revision exercise covering 16 States and three Union Territories. According to a statement issued by the Office of the Chief Electoral Officer, Karnataka, the revision in the State will be undertaken with reference to the qualifying date of October 1, 2026, as notified by the ECI on May 14, 2026. The revision process in Karnataka will commence with preparation, training, and printing activities from June 20 to June 29, 2026. House-to-house visits by Booth Level Officers (BLOs) for the distribution and collection of enumeration forms will be carried out from June 30 to July 29, 2026. The rationalisation of polling stations will be completed by July 29, while the draft electoral roll will be published on August 5, 2026. The period for filing claims and objections has been scheduled from August 5 to September 4, 2026. The notice phase and disposal of claims and objections will co

35. Beijing Scan

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ORF

■ **URL:** <https://www.orfonline.org/research/beijing-scan>

■ **Summary:**

Beijing Scan is ORF's fortnightly insight on China, analysing crucial political, economic, foreign policy, and military developments. China's gross domestic product (GDP) grew faster than expected at 5 percent year-on-year in the first quarter of 2026, surpassing the economists' expectations of around 4.8 percent. This figure marks the first release of official GDP figures since Beijing reduced its annual economic growth target last April to a range of 4.5 percent-5 percent, the lowest since 1991. What made it a significant achievement was that it came despite the conflict in the Middle East, which started on 28 February, severely disrupting global energy supplies. Image 1: China's GDP Year-on-Year Growth Source: China Daily Experts

believe the full impact of the Iran War on the Chinese economy is yet to be visible and may have a larger impact in subsequent quarters. It is also important to note that Q1 2026's 5.0 percent is actually a step down from Q1 2025's 5.4 percent, so while the quarter-on-quarter acceleration looks positive, the year-on-year trend is still gradually softening. Meanwhile, China's industrial sector posted strong profit growth in the first quarter of 2026. Profits of China's major industrial firms -- those with annual revenues greater than 20 million yuan (US\$2.93 million) -- increased 15.5 percent year-on-year to reach 1.696 trillion yuan (about US\$247.3 billion) during the January-March period, the fastest rate since September. The strong performance c

36. All-party meeting on Jharkhand voter roll revision on 22 May

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Statesman

■ **URL:** <https://www.thestatesman.com/india/all-party-meeting-on-jharkhand-voter-roll-revision-on-22-may-1503594380.html>

■ **Summary:**

Jharkhand Chief Electoral Officer K Ravi Kumar has convened an all-party meeting on May 22 regarding the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls scheduled to begin in the state from June 30. The meeting will discuss preparations related to the special intensive revision of voters and training of Booth Level Agents (BLAs), officials said on Friday. Advertisement The Chief Electoral Officer said a video conference meeting with district election officers and deputy election officers of all districts would also be held to review preparedness for the exercise. As part of the process, the list of all unmapped voters along with names and contact numbers of Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will be published at polling stations on May 23. According to the Election Commission of India, door-to-door voter verification across Jharkhand will be conducted from June 30 to July 29. A total of 29,571 BLOs will be deployed for verification of 2,64,89,777 voters in the state. Election Commission data showed that

21,644 BLAs nominated by political parties are also expected to play a key role in the revision exercise. Officials said training programmes for BLAs would be conducted by the Election Commission. As per the schedule issued by the Commission, revision of polling stations will be completed by July 29, while the draft publication of electoral rolls will take place on August 5. Claims and objections regarding the voter list can be submitted between August 5 and September 4. Disposal

37. 'Bhajan Lal Sharma will be remembered as a successful CM': Rajnath praises Raj development model

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Statesman

■ **URL:** <https://www.thestatesman.com/india/bhajan-lal-sharma-will-be-remembered-as-a-successful-cm-rajnath-praises-raj-development-model-1503594383.html>

■ **Summary:**

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh highly praised Rajasthan Chief Minister Bhajan Lal Sharma for his zeal, dedication, and tireless efforts toward the state's rapid development, predicting he will be a successful CM in times to come. Addressing a public meeting in Jodhpur after unveiling the statue of former Vice President late Bhairon Singh Shekhawat on Thursday afternoon, Singh said, "I have observed the Chief Minister's functioning since his election as leader of the BJP legislature party. I attended the maiden meeting as a central observer in December 2023. However, the party's newly-elected MLAs summarily elected him as the leader leaving the observer no choice but to declare him elected." Advertisement "I do feel that he has been resolutely working on Antyodaya, the yojana envisioned and launched by the late VP Shekhawat Sa'ab half a century ago. He added, "I am sure that he would succeed in realising Shekhawat's dreams about the welfare of the most deprived stratum of society." "About Sharma's work during the past two years, I can confidently say that under his leadership, Rajasthan has been marching on the path of progress scaling

all parameters of development," Singh said. The Chief Minister himself and through the BJP cadres and government paraphernalia reaching out to people down to the village Chaupals, interacting with people at grass root levels. His government's initiatives and governance have brought changes to the lives of the deprived ones, particularly in the r

38. Mayawati slams SP for its statement against Brahmin community

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Statesman

■ **URL:** <https://www.thestatesman.com/india/mayawati-slams-sp-for-its-statement-against-brahmin-community-1503594366.html>

■ **Summary:**

Bahujan Samaj Party supremo Mayawati has slammed the Samajwadi Party for the widespread outrage and condemnation surrounding the recent vulgar, indecent, and offensive remarks and statements made by a prominent national spokesperson of the party against the Brahmin community. "Despite the police filing a case, the matter remains unabated. However, the silence of the SP leadership, which practices narrow caste-based politics, is further escalating the situation. As a result, the situation is becoming increasingly tense. In any case, the SP spokesperson's irresponsible statement has seriously hurt the Brahmin community's dignity and self-respect. It would be appropriate for the SP chief to take immediate cognisance of the matter and apologise and express remorse to the Brahmin community," she said in a social media post on Friday. Advertisement The BSP supremo further said that this latest incident has proved that the SP's casteist tactics and character, especially against the Brahmin community, much like their attitude towards Dalits, most backward classes, and Muslims, have not changed, but have only deepened. She added that, along with this, the strong resentment within the Brahmin community regarding the attitude of the

present government towards the Brahmin community is also not hidden from anyone. "It is well known that like all other communities, the BSP has given full respect and honour to the Brahmin community in the party and the government, ensuring their proper repr

39. SP hurt Hindu sentiments by opposing PM, Brahmins, Sanatan culture: BJP UP chief Chaudhary

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/sp-hurt-hindu-sentiments-by-opposing-pm-brahmins-sanatan-culture-bjp-up-chief-chaudhary/2932451/>

■ **Summary:**

Lucknow, May 15 (PTI) BJP Uttar Pradesh unit president Pankaj Chaudhary on Friday launched a scathing attack on the Samajwadi Party (SP), alleging that its leaders had from time to time opposed symbols of faith such as Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the Brahmin community, Sanatan culture and the Ram temple, thereby hurting Hindu sentiments. In a post on social media platform X, Chaudhary wrote, "The language of abuse reflects flawed intentions, and the public is now ready to respond through votes." In the same post, he said, "Samajwadi Party leaders have continuously used undignified language against Prime Minister Narendra Modi ji and from time to time opposed symbols of faith such as the Brahmin community, Sanatan culture and the Ram temple, thereby hurting Hindu sentiments." Chaudhary said that the politics of "divide castes and capture power" now stood completely exposed before the public.

40. Karnataka electoral roll SIR exercise to begin from June 20

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/karnataka-electoral-roll-sir-exercise-to-begin-from-june-20/2932445/>

■ **Summary:**

The rationalisation of polling stations is scheduled to be completed by July 29. The draft electoral roll will be published on August 5, following which claims and objections can be filed between August 5 and September 4. The notice phase and disposal of claims and objections will continue from August 5 to October 3, and the final electoral roll will be published on October 7, it said. Addressing a press conference here, CEO Kumar said that in Karnataka, the Office of the Chief Electoral Officer is fully prepared to proceed with the SIR of electoral rolls. As part of this exercise, we have successfully mapped 86.46 per cent of our voters, he said. "The primary objective of this entire exercise is to ensure that every eligible voter is enrolled, while simultaneously ensuring that no ineligible individuals are included in the voter list. Therefore, I seek the support and cooperation of all the voters of Karnataka, all political parties, and our friends from the media," he added. According to the statement issued by the CEO's office, 59,050 BLOs will be involved in the SIR of the electoral roll in the state. The exercise will cover approximately 5,55,74,064 electors in the state as of May 12. The SIR is a participative and transparent exercise involving electors, political parties and the election machinery. During the revision process, BLOs will undertake house-to-house visits for the distribution and collection of enumeration forms, the statement said. Stating that there are c

41. Karnataka SIR drive to cover over 5.55 crore voters; over 59,000 BLOs to be deployed - Mangalorean.com

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Mangalorean.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.mangalorean.com/karnataka-sir-drive-to-cover-over-5-55-crore-voters-over-59000-blos-to-be-deployed/>

■ **Summary:**

Bengaluru: The Chief Electoral Officer, Karnataka V. Anbukumar, has stated that 59,050 Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will be involved in the revision process across the State. The Special Intensive Revision is expected to cover approximately 5,55,74,064 electors in Karnataka as of May 12, 2026. The Chief Electoral Officer's office has appealed to voters to cooperate fully with BLOs during the house-to-house verification exercise. It may be noted that the Election Commission of India (ECI) has directed the conduct of a Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Karnataka as part of a nationwide revision exercise covering 16 States and three Union Territories. According to a statement issued by the Office of the Chief Electoral Officer, Karnataka, the revision in the State will be undertaken with reference to the qualifying date of October 1, 2026, as notified by the ECI on May 14, 2026. The revision process in Karnataka will commence with preparation, training, and printing activities from June 20 to June 29, 2026. House-to-house visits by Booth Level Officers (BLOs) for the distribution and collection of enumeration forms will be carried out from June 30 to July 29, 2026. The rationalisation of polling stations will be completed by July 29, while the draft electoral roll will be published on August 5, 2026. The period for filing claims and objections has been scheduled from August 5 to September 4, 2026. The notice phase and disposal of claims and objections will co

42. SC closes plea of Goa Cong leader against cancellation of bypoll after he dies of snakebite

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/sc-closes-plea-of-go-a-cong-leader-against-cancellation-of-bypoll-after-he-dies-of-snakebite/2932439/>

■ **Summary:**

Bhatikar (38) died when he was on his way to Dandeli village in Karnataka. Advocate Abhishek Jebraj, appearing for the deceased leader, requested that the bench leave the larger question of law open, and close the proceedings. The bench recorded the submissions of both sides and closed the proceedings on the plea. Bhatikar, who was the opposition party's Congress candidate for the Ponda assembly seat, had filed a plea challenging the Bombay High Court's order which cancelled the bypoll on April 8. "Bhatikar had got down at Karmal Ghat on the Goa-Karnataka border for some reason, when a snake bit him. He was rushed to the Primary Health Centre in Dharbandora, Goa, where doctors declared him brought dead," a police official said. The bypoll, necessitated by the death of sitting BJP MLA Ravi Naik on October 15 last year was to take place on April 9. The high court's Goa bench on April 8 had quashed the Election Commission of India's notification for the byelection, citing violation of the Representation of the People Act, as the legislature's term is set to expire in less than a year. Two registered voters in the constituency had moved the high court challenging the validity of the notification on the ground that less than one year of the current Goa legislative assembly's term was left. The term will expire on March 14, 2027. The high court had agreed with the contention, noting that as the result would have been declared on May 4, the winning candidate would have got only about

43. UDF says full Cabinet to take oath on May 18, ministerial list to be finalised shortly

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/udf-says-full-cabinet-to-take-oath-on-may-18-ministerial-list-to-be-finalised-shortly/2932426/>

■ Summary:

It was the first formal meeting of the UDF after it secured a thumping victory in the Assembly elections, the results of which were announced on May 4. Senior Congress leader Ramesh Chennithala did not attend the meeting. "It was only a formal UDF meeting. We will meet again on Saturday and make decisions. Preparations for the swearing-in ceremony on Monday are underway. Along with the CM-designate, we are looking to provide an opportunity for other UDF leaders to take the oath," Prakash said. "Our intention is that the full Cabinet should take the oath on Monday itself. We will disclose details of the full Cabinet on Saturday," he said. Prakash said discussions with various UDF leaders would continue, and decisions on ministerial berths would be taken soon. Communist Marxist Party (CMP) leader C P John also said the full Cabinet was likely to be sworn in on Monday, and further discussions would be held on Saturday. "It was the first formal meeting after the election victory. During the meeting, the KPCC president conveyed the party's decision, and all endorsed it. It was largely a formality," he said. He added that discussions on portfolio allocation were still ongoing. When asked whether he would be a minister, John said, "It can happen." IUML leader P K Kunhalikutty said CM-designate V D Satheesan had left for Ernakulam, and other UDF leaders were also on their way. "There will be no decision today. The discussions will continue on Saturday. This was only a formal meeting,

44. Border fence push gains momentum in Bengal after political change

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <https://www.uniindia.com/~border-fence-push-gains-momentum-in-bengal-after-political-change/States/news/3844364.html>

■ Summary:

Siliguri, May 14 (UNI) District administrations across West Bengal's border areas have started coordination meetings with the Border Security Force (BSF) and state authorities to expedite the process of acquiring land for barbed wire fencing along the Indo-Bangladesh boundary in line with directions issued by Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari. A high-level meeting on the issue was held at the Malda district magistrate's office on Thursday. Chaired by the District Magistrate Rajanvir Singh Kapur, the meeting was attended by Officials of the BSF, the state land acquisition department, as also police and district administration representatives. According to officials, discussions focused on acquiring the required land in accordance with the alignment of the proposed border fencing in sensitive stretches along the Indo-Bangladesh border in Malda district. Speaking to mediapersons after the meeting, Kapur said the discussions were "positive and constructive" and expressed hope that long-pending land-related complications could be resolved within 45 days, following the state government's directive. He also said regular coordination meetings among the district administration, BSF and police would now be revived to strengthen border management and address issues related to security and trans-border crimes. Administrative sources said during the tenure of the previous state government, coordination meetings between district authorities and the BSF had become irregular and, in several cas

45. Kerala CM-designate Satheesan's emotional meet with late mentor's wife: 'CM shouldn't cry like this'

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** India TV News

■ **URL:** <https://www.indiatvnews.com/news/india/kerala-cm-designate-satheesans-emotional-meet-with-late-mentors-wife-2026-05-15-1041299>

■ Summary:

Satheesan also met senior Congress leader Chennithala amid reports that the latter was not unhappy with the party high command for not being named as the CM candidate in Kerala. Speaking with reporters after the meeting, Satheesan said Chennithala is his leader and he came to seek his blessings. A heartwarming scene was witnessed on Friday when Kerala CM designate VD Satheesan met family members of his mentor late Congress stalwart G Karthikeyan in Thiruvananthapuram. Satheesan couldn't hold back his tears while meeting Karthikeyan's wife, who could be seen consoling him saying "a CM shouldn't cry like this." Satheesan meets Chennithala Satheesan also met senior Congress leader Chennithala amid reports that the latter was not unhappy with the party high command for not being named as the CM candidate in Kerala. Speaking with reporters after the meeting, Satheesan said Chennithala is his leader and he came to seek his blessings. "I met Ramesh Chennithala to seek his blessings. He was my leader when I was a student. He has always been my leader. Even now, he is my leader. It was simply a meeting. He blessed me for taking up this post. His blessings and support will always be with me. I am sure it was nothing more than a meeting between two brothers," he said. Satheesan's meeting with former CM Vijayan The Kerala CM designate also met LDF leader and former Kerala CM Pinarayi Vijayan at the latter's residence in Thiruvananthapuram. "Pinarayi Vijayan is the most senior leader in K

46. Balagopal challenges Antony over Kerala's fiscal health

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kerala/balagopal-challenges-antony-over-keralas-fiscal-health/article70982916.ece>

■ **Summary:**

Outgoing Finance Minister K.N. Balagopal has called senior Congress leader A.K. Antony's claim that Kerala is a bankrupt State utterly baseless, and said it should be viewed as a tactical move by the incoming United Democratic Front (UDF) government to backtrack on their promises and deceive the public. Remarking that the veteran leader's long absence from active regional politics might have led to these misconceptions, Mr. Balagopal, addressing a press meet here on Friday, extended an invitation to personally meet Mr. Antony and present the official government data, State budgets, and Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) reports to verify the State's robust fiscal health. "UDF leaders like V.D. Satheesan confidently formulated their election manifesto with five prominent guarantees precisely because they were well aware of the State's sound financial position," he said. He also observed Mr. Antony's statements as a pre-emptive defense mechanism, as Congress-ruled States like Himachal Pradesh, Karnataka, and Telangana are currently struggling to pay salaries and pensions on time. "If A.K. Antony is trying to take preemptive bail, assuming that the financial distress experienced in Congress-ruled States might occur here as well, he is free to do so. However, he must not shift the blame onto the shoulders of the Left Democratic Front government's ten-year administration," he said. Expenditure figures To substantiate the State's financial health, Mr. Balagopal detailed the expe

47. Odisha Voter List Revision Starts May 20

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** newKerala.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.newkerala.com/news/a/odisha-launch-sir-process-may-20-says-ceo-498.htm>

■ **Summary:**

Addressing the media, the CEO said that all eligible citizens who attain 18 years of age by July 1, 2026, and fulfil other required qualifications, will be included in the electoral rolls during the revision process. According to the schedule announced by the Election Commission, preparatory activities, including training programmes and printing work, will be conducted from May 20 to May 29. Door-to-door verification by Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will commence from May 30 and continue till June 28. The rationalisation of polling stations is also scheduled to be completed by June 28. The draft electoral roll will be published on July 5. The period for filing claims and objections has been fixed from July 5 to August 4, while the disposal of claims and objections will continue till September 2. The final electoral roll will be published on September 6. The CEO informed that once the SIR process is completed, the number of polling booths across the state is set to increase to 45,255 with the addition of 7132 new ones, with each booth catering to nearly 1,200 voters on average. He said an equal number of Booth Level Officers (BLOs), around 45,255, will be engaged in electoral management activities. Gopalan said as many as 27,723 Booth Level Agents have been appointed by seven recognised political parties across the state, appealing to the parties to appoint agents for the remaining booths as well. He further stated that Odisha currently has over 3.34 crore voters enrolled in the

48. EC Data: Voter Surge in Assam, Bengal, TN, Kerala, Puducherry 1951-2026

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** newKerala.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.newkerala.com/news/a/from-1951-2026-ec-tracks-voter-surge-turnout-524.htm>

■ **Summary:**

The data highlights a sharp rise in voter strength over the decades, along with consistently high polling participation across these regions. The Election Commission of India (ECI) released the data under the theme "Chunav Ka Parv, Matdata Ka Garv", highlighting how the electorate in these four states and the Union Territory has multiplied several times over the decades, while voter turnout has remained among the highest in the country. Among all the states, West Bengal has recorded the highest latest polling percentage at 93.71 per cent in the Assembly polls, the highest since Independence. The state's electoral participation graph shows a steady climb from the early decades after Independence, when polling remained below 50 per cent in the 1950s, to consistently crossing the 75 per cent mark from the late 1970s onwards in both the Lok Sabha and Assembly polls. The number of voters in the state has surged from nearly 76 lakh in 1951 to over 6.38 crore ahead of the 2026 Assembly election. Assam has also shown a remarkable rise in electoral participation in the just-concluded Assembly elections. The latest turnout figure stands at 86.33 per cent. The voter base in the state has expanded sharply from around 24 lakh voters in 1951 to more than 2.16 crore voters in 2026. However, the Election Commission also points to a sharp drop in voters in the 1983 Assembly election, which was held amid the peak of violence in the state. The polling percentage was nearly 32 per cent. Several

49. Great Nicobar Project: The global propaganda to obstruct the venture

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** OpIndia

■ **URL:** <https://www.opindia.com/2026/05/great-nicobar-project-the-global-propaganda-to-obstruct-the-venture/>

■ **Summary:**

Rahul Gandhi and the Indian National Congress have started promoting ideas like "wealth redistribution," concepts that are directly influenced by Marxist ideology over past many years. In the current age, conflicts are no longer exclusively conducted at borders with military tanks and weaponry. Instead, wars are now fought on mobile devices, featured on the front pages of global publications and within the offices of Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs) that operate under the pretence of advocating for human rights. This phenomenon is referred to as "Hybrid Warfare" or "Asymmetric Warfare." The main goal is to ensnare a rising power in domestic strife to the point where it cannot reach its full potential. Whenever India embarks on a significant initiative, whether it be a nuclear facility, a major port or a mining project, why do "human rights outfits" and "environmental activists" from around the world suddenly spring into action? One might presume that these individuals are simply safeguarding nature, a seemingly commendable pursuit. However, is this an authentic passion for the environment, or is there a meticulous geopolitical and ideological strategy at play aimed specifically at diminishing India's growing influence? Today, we will explore the intricacies of this very "Hybrid Warfare" where traditional weapons such as missiles and guns are replaced by narratives, information warfare, misinformation and fabricated news. We will examine the Great Nicobar Integrated Devel

50. Rush Hour: HC says disputed Bhojshala a temple, Centre accepts 'breach' in NEET command chain & more

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Scroll.in

■ **URL:** <https://scroll.in/latest/1092891/rush-hour-hc-says-disputed-bhojshala-a-temple-centre-accepts-breach-in-neet-command-chain-more>

■ **Summary:**

Sugar-free products with sugar. 'Real' juices with artificial ingredients. Misleading food ads are fuelling a public health crisis in India. Help Scroll expose the systemic failure. Support our investigation. The Madhya Pradesh High Court held that the disputed Bhojshala-Kamal Maula mosque complex in Dhar district is a temple of the Hindu deity Saraswati. The bench quashed a 2003 order of the Archaeological Survey of India, which allowed Hindus to perform prayers on the premises on Tuesdays and Muslims to offer namaz in the complex on Fridays. It also allowed the Muslim side to seek alternative land in the district to build a mosque. The court said it arrived at its decision on the basis of the precedent laid down by the Supreme Court in the Ram Janmabhoomi-Babri Masjid case. Read on. From Babri to Gyanvapi, how India's courts have helped escalate Hindutva claims on mosques, explains Umang Poddar

Opposition leaders questioned whether the Narendra Modi government had entered into a quid pro quo arrangement, under which the United States was reportedly planning to drop charges against Adani Group chairperson Gautam Adani in a fraud case. "The compromised PM has not struck a trade deal, but a bargain for Adani's release," claimed Congress leader Rahul Gandhi. This came a day after The New York Times reported that the US was planning to drop charges against Adani for allegedly orchestrating a \$265 million fraud scheme to bribe officials in India for solar energy contracts, and th

51. BJP's New Chief Ministers: Defectors, Not Cadre (2026)

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Frontline

■ **URL:** <https://frontline.thehindu.com/newsletter/poll-vault-anand-mishra/bjp-chief-ministers-defectors-democracy/article70978365.ece>

■ Summary:

Dear Reader, Watching the swearing-in of Suwendu Adhikari as the BJP's first Chief Minister of West Bengal last week, I was struck by the contrast offered by the massive show of strength that was mounted at Kolkata's Brigade Parade Grounds and the comparatively austere oath-taking that had marked Bihar's first BJP Chief Minister, Samrat Chaudhary, a month earlier. What stood out on the dais in Kolkata was the line-up of BJP Chief Ministers from the east and north-east -- Assam's Himanta Biswa Sarma, Bihar's Samrat Chaudhary, Arunachal Pradesh's Pema Khandu, and Tripura's Manik Saha. The common thread among them: none is a traditional, lifelong, dyed-in-the-wool saffron politician. Over two decades of covering politics, I recall that BJP Chief Ministers were once assessed by their RSS roots and years in the party, while their caste came only thereafter. Is that conventional approach to leadership changing, as parties like the BJP increasingly elevate leaders from outside their core ranks, most often leaders they have poached from rival parties? Adhikari became West Bengal's BJP Chief Minister within six years of formally joining the party in December 2020, after 22 long years in the Trinamool and an earlier association with the Congress. His back-to-back defeats of Mamata Banerjee in Assembly contests -- Nandigram in 2021 and Bhabanipur in 2026 -- his ability to expand the BJP's vote and worker base, and his intimate knowledge of Trinamool's organisational machinery appear to

52. Supreme Court Closes Plea After Goa Congress Leader Dies

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Rediff.com India Ltd.

■ **URL:** <https://www.rediff.com/news/report/sc-closes-plea-after-go-a-leader-dies-of-s-nakebite/20260515.htm>

■ Summary:

The Supreme Court has closed the case filed by Goa Congress leader Ketan

Bhatikar, who tragically died from a snakebite, regarding the cancelled Ponda assembly by-election. Key PointsGoa Congress leader Ketan Bhatikar died after a snakebite.The Supreme Court closed Bhatikar's plea challenging the cancellation of the Ponda assembly bypoll.The Bombay High Court had cancelled the bypoll due to the legislature's term expiring in less than a year.Bhatikar was the Congress candidate for the Ponda assembly seat. A day after Goa Congress leader Ketan Bhatikar died after being bitten by a snake, the Supreme Court on Friday closed his plea challenging the Bombay High Court order to cancel the Ponda assembly bypoll. A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta abated the proceeding on his plea after it was informed of Bhatikar's death on Thursday night due to a snakebite. Details of Ketan Bhatikar's Death Bhatikar (38) died when he was on his way to Dandeli village in Karnataka. Advocate Abhishek Jebraj, appearing for the deceased leader, requested that the bench leave the larger question of law open, and close the proceedings. The bench recorded the submissions of both sides and closed the proceedings on the plea. Background on the Ponda Bypoll Case Bhatikar, who was the opposition party's Congress candidate for the Ponda assembly seat, had filed a plea challenging the Bombay High Court's order which cancelled the bypoll on April 8. "Bhatikar had got down at Karmal Ghat on the Goa

53. SC raps politicians over 'irresponsible' remarks in Shiv Sena symbol row

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Rediff.com India Ltd.

■ **URL:** <https://www.rediff.com/news/report/sc-raps-politicians-over-irresponsible-remarks-in-shiv-sena-symbol-row/20260515.htm>

■ **Summary:**

The Supreme Court has strongly criticised politicians for their "irresponsible statements" concerning the Shiv Sena symbol row case, cautioning against

undermining the judicial process. IMAGE: A view of the Supreme Court of India. Photograph: ANI Photo Key Points The Chief Justice of India warned against politicising court proceedings through media statements. The court is hearing pleas related to the Election Commission's decision to allot the 'bow and arrow' symbol to the Eknath Shinde faction. The Uddhav Thackeray faction has challenged the Election Commission's order and the Maharashtra Speaker's decision. The Supreme Court has scheduled the next hearing for the Shiv Sena symbol case on July 30. The Supreme Court on Friday expressed strong displeasure over "irresponsible statements" of some politicians alleging non-hearing of the Shiv Sena symbol row case in the top court, and cautioned that they should be careful as such conduct can't be accepted. A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi observed that parties before it had sought dates in the matter and then statements were being made that the apex court was not deciding the case. "We will fix the date but first you stop your people from going to the media and making irresponsible statements saying that the Supreme Court is not deciding," an visibly anguished CJI told the counsel appearing for the Uddhav Thackeray-led faction. "You seek dates here and then say that the court is not deciding the mat

54. Homoeopathic doctor killed by brother over land dispute in Odishas Kendrapara

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** News18

■ **URL:** <https://www.news18.com/agency-feeds/homoeopathic-doctor-killed-by-brother-over-land-dispute-in-odishas-kendrapara-10093714.html>

■ **Summary:**

Kendrapara (Odisha), May 15 (PTI) A homoeopathic doctor was killed allegedly by his elder brother and other family members over a property dispute in Odisha's Kendrapara district, police said on Friday. The deceased has been identified as

Golakh Chandra Nauri (42) of Baradanga village within Mahakalapada police station limits. Police said a quarrel broke out between the two brothers over a land dispute on Thursday night, during which the accused allegedly attacked Nauri with a wooden plank, critically injuring him. He was first taken to the community health centre at Mahakalapada and later shifted to the district headquarters hospital at Kendrapara, where doctors declared him dead, police said. Police arrested the deceased's elder brother Abhaya Chandra Nauri (44), his daughter Kandhei Nauri (23), and daughter-in-law Jasmini Nauri (27) in connection with the murder. Another accused, Jitendra Nauri (30), son of Abhaya Chandra Nauri, is absconding. "We are conducting raids to nab Jitendra," Mahakalpada police station inspector-in-charge Manas Kumar Mallick said. A case has been registered under Section 103 (murder) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS). The deceased, who was also associated with the Communist Party of India, had unsuccessfully contested the 2014 Assembly election from Mahakalapada constituency as a CPI candidate. He was running two clinics at Mahakalpada and Paradip. PTI COR AAM AAM MNB

55. World News | US Lawmakers Push Bill to Block China from Accessing American Research Funds | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/world-news-us-lawmakers-push-bill-to-block-china-from-accessing-american-research-funds-7431726.html>

■ **Summary:**

Get latest articles and stories on World at LatestLY. John Moolenaar, chairman of the United States House Select Committee on Strategic Competition between the United States and the Chinese Communist Party, and Jim Banks unveiled the "Securing Innovation and Research from Adversaries Act". Washington DC [US], May 15 (ANI): Two senior Republican lawmakers have introduced new legislation aimed at

preventing China from gaining access to federally funded American research, warning that Beijing has systematically exploited US academic openness to strengthen its military and technological capabilities. John Moolenaar, chairman of the United States House Select Committee on Strategic Competition between the United States and the Chinese Communist Party, and Jim Banks unveiled the "Securing Innovation and Research from Adversaries Act". The proposed legislation seeks to prohibit the use of US federal research funding in collaborations involving entities or individuals linked to China's military, intelligence services, or blacklisted organisations. Also Read | Cannes 2026: Alia Bhatt All Smiles As She Meets F1 Star Charles Leclerc After Carlos Sainz at French Riviera (Watch Viral Video). The lawmakers argued that American taxpayer-funded research has become vulnerable to exploitation by the Chinese Communist Party (CCP) through academic partnerships, technology exchanges, and scientific cooperation programs. "The CCP should not get a single dime, directly or indirectly, of American re

56. India News | Delhi: Massive Blaze Engulfs Parked Vehicles in Shahdara | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/india-news-delhi-massive-blaze-engulfs-parked-vehicles-in-shahdara-7431700.html>

■ **Summary:**

Shahdara (New Delhi) [India], May 15 (ANI): A massive fire broke out in several vehicles parked at a parking lot near the railway line in Bihar Colony under the Farsh Bazar police station area of Shahdara district on Friday. No casualties or injuries have been reported so far. Also Read | IndiGo Flight Crew Denies Diabetic Passenger Washroom Access on Raipur-Delhi Flight, Airline Responds. According to initial information, multiple cars parked in the parking area caught fire, and blasts were

heard from the vehicles during the incident. Several fire tenders rushed to the spot, and efforts were underway to control the blaze. Also Read | Delhi Shocker: 21-Year-Old Woman Found Hanging in Azadpur Days After Appearing for Cancelled NEET UG 2026 Exam. More details awaited. (ANI) (The above story is verified and authored by ANI staff, ANI is South Asia's leading multimedia news agency with over 100 bureaus in India, South Asia and across the globe. ANI brings the latest news on Politics and Current Affairs in India & around the World, Sports, Health, Fitness, Entertainment, & News. The views appearing in the above post do not reflect the opinions of LatestLY)

57. UDF says full Cabinet to take oath on May 18, ministerial list to be finalised shortly

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Economic Times

■ **URL:** <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/elections/assembly-elections/kerala/udf-says-full-cabinet-to-take-oath-on-may-18-ministerial-list-to-be-finalised-shortly/articleshow/131118793.cms>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram: The entire Cabinet of the new Kerala government is expected to be sworn in on Monday, with the list of ministers likely to be finalised soon, UDF convenor Adoor Prakash said on Friday. Leaders of UDF allies-the Congress, Indian Union Muslim League (IUML), Kerala Congress (KEM), Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP), and other parties-held a meeting at Cantonment House in

Thiruvananthapuram this evening. It was the first formal meeting of the UDF after it secured a thumping victory in the Assembly elections, the results of which were announced on May 4. Also read: Kerala Congress govt to take oath on May 18, says CM-designate Satheesan Senior Congress leader Ramesh Chennithala did not attend the meeting. "It was only a formal UDF meeting. We will meet again on

Saturday and make decisions. Preparations for the swearing-in ceremony on Monday are underway. Along with the CM-designate, we are looking to provide an opportunity for other UDF leaders to take the oath," Prakash said. "Our intention is that the full Cabinet should take the oath on Monday itself. We will disclose details of the full Cabinet on Saturday," he said. Prakash said discussions with various UDF leaders would continue, and decisions on ministerial berths would be taken soon. Communist Marxist Party (CMP) leader C P John also said the full Cabinet was likely to be sworn in on Monday, and further discussions would be held on Saturday. "It was the first formal meeting after the election victory.

58. Dissolve NTA, hand over NEET 2024 probe to CBI too: Ashok Gehlot - Mangalorean.com

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Mangalorean.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.mangalorean.com/dissolve-nta-hand-over-neet-2024-probe-to-cbi-too-ashok-gehlot/>

■ **Summary:**

Dissolve NTA, hand over NEET 2024 probe to CBI too: Ashok Gehlot Jaipur: Former Rajasthan Chief Minister, Ashok Gehlot, on Friday launched a sharp attack over the alleged NEET paper leak controversy, demanding the dissolution of the National Testing Agency (NTA) and a comprehensive CBI investigation into both the 2024 and 2025 examinations. Reacting to reports suggesting irregularities and possible paper leaks in NEET-2025, Gehlot alleged that exam papers had been leaked "in one form or another" on multiple occasions and accused the authorities of repeatedly failing students. Speaking to the media, Gehlot said that incidents linked to alleged paper leaks in 2024, 2025 and 2026 should all be investigated together. "If they truly have the courage, they should order a comprehensive enquiry into all these exams. The case should be handed over to the CBI. Once the incidents from the previous dates

are also included in the investigation, the truth will come out automatically," he said. Gehlot claimed that many people had benefited from earlier leaks and suggested that the same network may have been active again in 2025. "The people involved earlier are the same people involved now. Whenever such scams happen under their watch, whether paper leaks or OMR sheet tampering, their approach shows complete indifference towards the public," he claimed. The senior Congress leader also questioned the credibility of the National Testing Agency (NTA), saying repeated controversies surrounding

59. Bihar Govt Transfers 18 IAS Officers in Major Reshuffle

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** newKerala.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.newkerala.com/news/a/major-bureaucratic-reshuffle-bihar-as-sa-mrat-choudhary-govt-260.htm>

■ **Summary:**

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary has carried out a major administrative reshuffle, transferring 18 IAS officers and reassigning key responsibilities across departments. The move is being viewed as an effort to further strengthen governance and streamline administrative functioning in the state. Among the key changes, 1996-batch IAS officer K. Senthil Kumar has been shifted from the Sugarcane Industry Department and appointed as Additional Chief Secretary of the Labour Resources and Migrant Workers Welfare Department. He has also been given additional charge of the Backward Classes and Extremely Backward Classes Welfare Department. Consequently, H.R. Srinivasan (1996 batch) has been relieved of this additional responsibility. At the divisional level, Prem Singh Meena (2000 batch), Commissioner of Munger Division, has been given additional charge of Bhagalpur Division. Rajesh Kumar, a 2001-batch IAS officer and Divisional Commissioner of the Kosi range, has been transferred and appointed as Principal Secretary of the Public

Health Engineering Department (PHED). In the departmental reshuffle, 2002-batch IAS officer Pankaj Kumar Pal has been appointed Secretary of the Road Construction Department, while Abhay Kumar Singh (2006 batch) has been posted as Secretary of the Information Technology Department and will continue to hold additional charge of BELTRON. Dharmendra Singh (2006 batch) has been assigned charge of the Sugarcane Industry Department along with the Cooperation

60. FBI Offers \$200K for Ex-US Air Force Specialist Accused of Spying for Iran | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/fbi-offers-200k-for-ex-us-air-force-specialist-accused-of-spying-for-iran-7431697.html>

■ **Summary:**

WASHINGTON (AP) -- The FBI is offering a \$200,000 reward for information leading to capture and prosecution of a former U.S. Air Force counterintelligence specialist who defected to Iran in 2013 and was later charged with revealing classified information to the Tehran government. Monica Elfriede Witt, who is in her 40s, was indicted by a federal grand jury in February 2019 on charges of espionage, including transmitting national defense information to the government of Iran. She remains at large. Witt "allegedly betrayed her oath to the Constitution more than a decade ago by defecting to Iran and providing the Iranian regime National Defense Information and likely continues to support their nefarious activities," Daniel Wierzbicki, special agent in charge of the FBI Washington Field Office's Counterintelligence and Cyber Division, said in a news release Wednesday. Also Read | A Traveling Meetup for Tall People is Drawing Huge Crowds. "The FBI has not forgotten and believes that during this critical moment in Iran's history, there is someone who knows something about her whereabouts." It wasn't immediately known why the FBI was bringing attention to

Witt's case. The United States and Iran have been at war since Feb. 28. Witt served in the Air Force between 1997 and 2008, where she was trained in the Farsi language and was deployed overseas on classified counterintelligence missions, including to the Middle East. She later found work as a Defense Department contractor. Also Rea

61. How a Philippine war crimes suspect thwarted arrest (for now)

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/world/how-a-philippine-war-crimes-suspect-thwarted-arrest-for-now/2932420/>

■ **Summary:**

The chaos involved different government forces: Senate security led by an official with ties to former President Rodrigo Duterte's camp and the National Bureau of Investigation overseen by an appointee of President Ferdinand Marcos Jr. It was the second run-in involving dela Rosa in a week, after the senator escaped NBI agents in a cat-and-mouse chase. The political drama has engulfed the archipelago for months, pitting the ruling Marcos against the camp of Duterte's daughter and current Vice-President Sara Duterte as the ICC pursues accountability for a drug crackdown that killed thousands. Dela Rosa, a 64-year-old former police chief, is unrepentant about his role in the drug war and previously said he would happily accompany Duterte to The Hague where the former leader faces a trial for crimes against humanity. On Monday, dela Rosa emerged from months of hiding to cast a crucial vote in a Senate leadership election expected to help shield the vice-president from a pending impeachment trial. The government, which denies sending forces to arrest dela Rosa during Wednesday's chaos, says it is investigating whether the shooting was staged to allow his escape. Nobody was harmed. "Duterte told me they would find it very hard to take Bato," Duterte's former lawyer Nicholas Kaufman told Reuters, referring to the senator by his Filipino nickname meaning "rock" and saying he enjoyed support among security forces. "Gunshots in a national assembly are unheard of. It points to a deep c

62. Major Bureaucratic Reshuffle In Bihar As Samrat Choudhary Govt Transfers 18 IAS Officers | Nation

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Ommcom News

■ **URL:** <https://ommcomnews.com/india-news/major-bureaucratic-reshuffle-in-bihar-a-s-samrat-choudhary-govt-transfers-18-ias-officers/>

■ **Summary:**

Patna: Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary has carried out a major administrative reshuffle, transferring 18 IAS officers and reassigning key responsibilities across departments. The move is being viewed as an effort to further strengthen governance and streamline administrative functioning in the state. Among the key changes, 1996-batch IAS officer K. Senthil Kumar has been shifted from the Sugarcane Industry Department and appointed as Additional Chief Secretary of the Labour Resources and Migrant Workers Welfare Department. He has also been given additional charge of the Backward Classes and Extremely Backward Classes Welfare Department. Consequently, H.R. Srinivasan (1996 batch) has been relieved of this additional responsibility. At the divisional level, Prem Singh Meena (2000 batch), Commissioner of Munger Division, has been given additional charge of Bhagalpur Division. Rajesh Kumar, a 2001-batch IAS officer and Divisional Commissioner of the Kosi range, has been transferred and appointed as Principal Secretary of the Public Health Engineering Department (PHED). In the departmental reshuffle, 2002-batch IAS officer Pankaj Kumar Pal has been appointed Secretary of the Road Construction Department, while Abhay Kumar Singh (2006 batch) has been posted as Secretary of the Information Technology Department and will continue to hold additional charge of BELTRON. Dharmendra Singh (2006 batch) has been assigned charge of the Sugarcane Industry Department along with the Coope

63. Vijay Drops British-Era 'VIP Culture', Removes White Towel Tradition From CM Chair

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** News18

■ **URL:** <https://www.news18.com/india/vijay-drops-british-era-vip-culture-removes-white-towel-tradition-from-cm-chair-ws-l-10093633.html>

■ **Summary:**

Climate activist Licypriya Kangujam appealed to Tamil Nadu CM Vijay to put an end to the long-followed "towel culture" seen on VIP chairs in government offices. Climate activist Licypriya Kangujam on Thursday appealed to Tamil Nadu minister Joseph Vijay to put an end to the long-followed "towel culture" seen on VIP chairs in government offices. Within 24 hours of the appeal, Vijay appeared to act on the suggestion quietly, removing the traditional white towel from his chair without any official announcement or publicity around the move. In her post on X, Kangujam had urged Vijay to lead by example, arguing that the practice of placing white towels on chairs is widely followed not only by ministers and bureaucrats but even by lower-level officials. She appealed to the Tamil Nadu leader to initiate a symbolic change by discarding the practice. Neither Vijay nor the Tamil Nadu government publicly responded to her post on X. However, photographs released from recent official meetings indicated a visible change. On May 14, during a review meeting of the Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce Department held at the Secretariat, images shared by the Chief Minister's Office showed Vijay seated on a chair covered with the customary white towel. But in photographs released on Friday from Vijay's meeting with Mallika Srinivasan, Chairperson and Managing Director of TAFE, and Vice-Chairperson Dr Lakshmi Venu, the towel was noticeably absent from the Chief Minister's chair. The qui

64. Balagopal rebuts AK Antony's 'bankrupt Kerala' claim, says Left govt left ■4,000 cr in Treasury

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** OnManorama

■ **URL:** <https://www.onmanorama.com/news/kerala/2026/05/15/balagopal-rebuts-ak-antony-s-bankrupt-kerala-claim-says-ldf-left-4000-cr-in-treasury.html>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram: Former Finance Minister K N Balagopal strongly rejected senior Congress leader A K Antony's claim that Kerala had been left "bankrupt," calling the statement factually incorrect and made without understanding the state's financial position. In a Facebook post, Balagopal said the outgoing LDF government had responsibly fulfilled 95 per cent of the promises made in its election manifesto, with all related expenditure met through the state treasury without disruption. "The new government has been handed over a treasury capable of handling all financial challenges," Balagopal said, adding that the outgoing government left office with a treasury balance of ■4,000 crore. He said Kerala's average annual expenditure over the last five years stood at ■1.72 lakh crore, while expenditure in the 2025-26 financial year alone crossed ■2 lakh crore. Drawing comparisons with previous administrations, Balagopal said the state's average annual expenditure was around ■70,000 crore during the Oommen Chandy government and ■1.15 lakh crore during the first Pinarayi Vijayan government. "Despite financial constraints caused by what he described as repeated restrictions imposed by the Union government, the state treasury was never shut even for a day," he said, adding that salaries and pensions of government employees were paid without interruption. He also claimed that when the second Pinarayi Vijayan government demitted office, there were no pending welfare pension dues, and all

65. Kerala politics highlights: Satheesan meets Pinarayi Vijayan, calls on senior leaders in Thiruvananthapuram

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/elections/kerala-assembly/kerala-politics-highlight-s-kerala-congress-udf-cm-vd-satheesan-ramesh-chennithala-may-15-2026/article70981485.ece>

■ **Summary:**

Kerala Chief Minister-designate V.D. Satheesan met his predecessor Pinarayi Vijayan at the latter's residence here on Friday (May 15, 2026). The Congress leadership continued its efforts to placate senior leader Ramesh Chennithala amid reports of his displeasure over the AICC naming Mr. Satheesan as Kerala's Chief

Minister-designate. Also read | V.D. Satheesan: From fiery Leader of Opposition to Chief Minister The All India Congress Committee (AICC) on Thursday (May 14, 2026) announced Congress leader V.D. Satheesan as its pick for the post of Kerala Chief Minister, putting an end to the high drama and suspense that lasted all of ten days after the declaration of the State Assembly election results on May 4. Also read | CPI(M) picks Pinarayi Vijayan as Leader of Opposition in Kerala Assembly With the announcement, Congress will proceed to form the government in the State, ending days of speculation as the top leaders tussled among themselves for the post. This live is now closed V.D. Satheesan has emerged as the unquestionable leader of Kerala. He has proved that he is no longer dependent on the Congress; it is the Congress that is dependent on him. In the immediate term, this will mean that Congress MLAs and Ministers will have little consequence or influence. The rise of Satheesan: What it means for the Congress, Muslim League and Kerala State politics Explore V.D. Satheesan's rise as a pivotal leader in Kerala politics, reshaping Congress and the Muslim League dynamics. Ke

66. Kerala Government: Full Cabinet Expected To Be Sworn In On Monday

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Rediff.com India Ltd.

■ **URL:** <https://www.rediff.com/news/report/kerala-cabinet-to-take-oath-on-may-18/20260515.htm>

■ **Summary:**

Kerala's new government is set to be sworn in on Monday, with the full Cabinet expected to take office, marking a significant step after the UDF's victory in the recent Assembly elections. Key Points The new Kerala government's full Cabinet is expected to be sworn in on Monday. UDF allies, including Congress and IUML, held a meeting to discuss the swearing-in ceremony. Discussions on ministerial berths and portfolio allocation are ongoing among UDF leaders. The swearing-in ceremony for CM-designate V D Satheesan and other ministers is scheduled for Monday at 10 am. The entire Cabinet of the new Kerala government is expected to be sworn in on Monday, with the list of ministers likely to be finalised soon, UDF convenor Adoor Prakash said on Friday. Leaders of UDF allies-the Congress, Indian Union Muslim League (IUML), Kerala Congress (KEM), Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP), and other parties-held a meeting at Cantonment House in Thiruvananthapuram this evening. UDF Meeting After Assembly Election Victory It was the first formal meeting of the UDF after it secured a thumping victory in the Assembly elections, the results of which were announced on May 4. Senior Congress leader Ramesh Chennithala did not attend the meeting. "It was only a formal UDF meeting. We will meet again on Saturday and make decisions. Preparations for the swearing-in ceremony on Monday are underway. Along with the CM-designate, we are looking to provide an opportunity for other UDF leaders to take the oath,

67. Amid both camps claiming legitimacy, Jittery AIADMK rebels blink first, plead EPS to call them for rapprochement

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <http://www.uniindia.com/amid-both-camps-claiming-legitimacy-jittery-aiadmk-rebels-blink-first-plead-eps-to-call-them-for-rapprochement/south/news/3844270.html>

■ **Summary:**

Chennai, May 15 (UNI) Apprehensive of losing the membership of the House under the anti-defection law for following voting in favour of the confidence motion of Tamil Nadu Chief Minister and TVK president Joseph Vijay, in violation of the party whip, the AIADMK rebels on Friday pleaded party general secretary Edappadi K Palaniswami (EPS) to call them for a dialogue to settle the differences. Of the total 47 MLAs, 25 rebels voted in favour of the government, while the 22 MLAs of EPS group voted against it in the confidence vote, which Vijay won rather comfortably securing 144 votes in his support, with 22 Opposing and five abstaining, with a total of 171 members present in the House at the time of voting (the main Opposition DMK having 59 members and its ally DMDK-one) walking out bringing down the strength from 231, facilitating an easy victory for the government. Of the total 234 members in the House, one seat was vacated by Vijay following his victory in two seats, one MLA of TVK was restrained by High Court in attending trust vote and the other being the Speaker, who can cast his vote in the event of a tie, making the strength to 231. The rebel camp, blinking first, comes in the wake of EPS submitting a petition last evening to Speaker JCD Prabhakar, seeking their disqualification for violating the party diktat in the trust vote. Another petition was also submitted to the Governor's office. Moreover, the rebels witnessed desertion from their ranks, with former minister KC

68. 25 Foreign Nationals arrested for illegally voting in TN polls

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <http://www.uniindia.com/25-foreign-nationals-arrested-for-illegally-voting-in-tn-polls/south/news/3844139.html>

■ Summary:

Chennai, May 15 (UNI) In a shocking incident, about 25 foreign citizens have been arrested or detained so far for allegedly casting votes illegally in the April 23 Tamil Nadu Assembly elections. The foreign nationals are from Sri Lanka, Britain, Indonesia, and Canada citizens having their country's passport. They were arrested or detained at Chennai and Madurai airports after immigration authorities found their indelible ink affixed on their left index finger and a perusal of documents showed they were not holding any Indian passports to provide their Indian identity. They were charged with illegally voting by fraudulently obtaining identity documents in the elections. Though cases were registered in other airports like Madurai and other cities where the arrests were also made, a release from the Greater Chennai Police Commissionerate here on Friday said 10 foreign nationals, including four women, were arrested by the immigration authorities at the Anna International airport here while they were about to board a flight to return to their respective countries. Of the 10 arrested foreign nationals seven were from Sri Lanka, and one each from England, Indonesia and Canada. The investigations revealed that they were holding Foreign citizenship and that they have voted illegally without holding any valid proof/documents that they were Indian citizens. All the 10 arrested foreign Nationals were handed over the Chennai city police, booked a total of nine cases against them under the B

69. Major IAS Reshuffle in Bihar, several top bureaucrats reassigned

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <http://www.uniindia.com/major-ias-reshuffle-in-bihar-several-top-bureaucrats-reassigned/east/news/3844188.html>

■ Summary:

Patna, May 15 (UNI) Bihar government on Friday transferred several senior IAS officers and reassigned responsibilities across departments to streamline governance. According to the official notification, K. Senthil Kumar (1996 batch) has been transferred from the Sugarcane Industry Department and appointed as Additional Chief Secretary of the Labour Resources and Migrant Workers Welfare Department. He will also hold additional charge of the Backward and Extremely Backward Classes Welfare Department. H.R. Srinivas (1996 batch), who was holding additional charge of the same department, has been relieved of that responsibility. Rajesh Kumar (2001 batch), earlier Commissioner of Kosi Division, Saharsa, has been appointed as Principal Secretary of the Public Health Engineering Department. Pankaj Kumar Pal (2002 batch) has been made Secretary of the Road Construction Department. Abhay Kumar Singh (2006 batch) has been transferred as Secretary of the Information Technology Department and will continue to hold additional charge as Managing Director of Bihar State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (BELTRON). Dharmendra Singh (2006 batch), Secretary of the Cooperative Department, will hold additional charge of the Sugarcane Industry Department. Deepak Anand (2007 batch) has been appointed Secretary of the Food and Consumer Protection Department. Vinod Singh Gunjyal (2007 batch), Secretary of the Election Department and Chief Electoral Officer, has been given additional charge

70. A day after seeking time for restructuring, Vijay govt deposits Rs 1,000 for women household heads under DMK's KMUT scheme

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <http://www.uniindia.com/a-day-after-seeking-time-for-restructuring-vijay-govt-deposits-rs-1-000-for-women-household-heads-under-dmk-s-kmut-scheme/south/ne>

■ Summary:

Chennai, May 14 (UNI) A day after seeking time for restructuring it, the Tamil Nadu Government headed by Chief Minister and TVK Founder C Joseph Vijay on Friday deposited the May month amount of Rs 1,000 for women household heads under the KMUT scheme,, one of the flagship measures of the previous DMK regime.

Yesterday, the government launched continuance of one of the two flagship schemes of the previous regime, depositing Rs 1,000 to college students, while promising that a similar amount for women under the Kalaignar Magalir Urimai Thogai (KMUT) scheme will be credited in their bank accounts soon as the government needed some time to restructure the scheme. In line with his assurance that all good schemes launched by the previous governments would continue, Vijay ensured continuance of the monthly financial assistance of Rs 1,000 provided under the "Pudhumaipen Scheme" for girl students and "Tamil Pudhalvan" scheme for boys who have studied in government schools from Clases 6 to 12, to pursue their higher education, depositing the amount directly to their bank accounts. On the pioneering KMUT scheme under which Rs 1,000 are being deposited by 15th of every month, Vijay assured that the amount would be credited to women beneficiaries soon, Vijay said, and made it clear that his government would continue the monthly financial assistance for the time being, while reviewing the scheme introduced by the previous DMK regime. The Chief Minister directed officials to ensure that t

71. West Bengal CM Suvendu Adhikari resigns from Nandigram Assembly constituency, retains Bhabanipur

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** India Gazette

■ **URL:** <https://www.indiagazette.com/news/279052646/west-bengal-cm-suvendu-adhikari-resigns-from-nandigram-assembly-constituency-retains-bhabanipur>

■ Summary:

Kolkata (West Bengal) [India], May 15 (ANI): West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Wednesday resigned from the Nandigram Assembly constituency, retaining the Bhabanipur seat from where he defeated Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee by a margin of 15,105 votes. In accordance with the rules, which mandate that a resignation be submitted within 14 days, Suwendu Adhikari tendered his resignation to the new Speaker of the West Bengal Legislative Assembly, Rathindra Bose. Suwendu Adhikari contested the West Bengal election from Nandigram and Bhabanipur. Adhikari registered a comfortable victory in Nandigram, his home turf, defeating TMC's Pabitra Kar by a margin of 9,665 votes. He also challenged Mamata Banerjee at Bhabanipur and secured victory by 15,105 votes, a major factor behind his selection as West Bengal Chief Minister. Nandigram Assembly constituency will now go to bye-elections. The 2026 Assembly election results marked a decisive mandate for the BJP, registering a significant surge, winning 207 seats in the 294-member Assembly, a major shift in a state where it had earlier secured 77 seats in the previous election. The Trinamool Congress (TMC), which had won 212 seats in the last Assembly polls, finished a distant second with 80 seats. Calling it the beginning of a new chapter for the state, Adhikari, who was sworn in as the Chief Minister, said the 'Sonar Bangla' era had officially begun after the BJP's sweeping victory in the 2026 West Bengal Assembly el

72. "Mamata Banerjee trying to build her image, gain sympathy by presenting herself as lawyer": BJP's Arjun Singh

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** India Gazette

■ **URL:** <https://www.indiagazette.com/news/279052983/mamata-banerjee-trying-to-build-her-image-gain-sympathy-by-presenting-herself-as-lawyer-bjp-arjun-singh>

■ Summary:

Kolkata (West Bengal) [India], May 15 (ANI): BJP MLA Arjun Singh on Friday launched a sharp attack on former West Bengal Chief Minister and Trinamool Congress (TMC) chief Mamata Banerjee after her appearance at the Calcutta High Court in a lawyer's attire in connection with a post-poll violence-related PIL, alleging that she was attempting to build sympathy through 'strategic optics.' Reacting to Banerjee appearing in court wearing an advocate's robe, Singh said the move was politically motivated and would not succeed in influencing public perception. 'Mamata Banerjee is trying to build her image, presenting herself as a lawyer to gain sympathy. These are her strategies, but the people of Bengal have rejected her. She now has no place in Bengal, and her party is almost finished,' Arjun Singh told ANI. His remarks come after Mamata Banerjee appeared before the Calcutta High Court in connection with a PIL on alleged post-poll violence following the 2026 West Bengal Assembly elections. The petition was filed by advocate Sirsanya Banerjee, son of Trinamool Congress leader-cum-advocate Kalyan Bandopadhyay and also a TMC candidate from Uttarpara Assembly constituency. The petitioner alleged incidents of post-poll violence in several areas, including attacks on party offices and the displacement of workers. During the hearing, Banerjee urged the court for 'immediate protection of people,' alleging large-scale violence, arson and attacks on party workers after the election results. S

73. Bhim Army chief Chandrashekhar Azad wants to be UP's Vijay, plans statewide march to expand base

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/politics/bhim-army-chief-chandrashekhar-azad-wants-to-be-ups-vijay-plans-statewide-march-to-expand-base/2932321/>

■ Summary:

Dalits -- Azad's core voters -- constitute 21 percent of the state's population. This section of the electorate has traditionally supported the Bahujan Samaj Party but that base has steadily eroded over the years. Once a formidable force in Uttar Pradesh politics with its strong social engineering model, the BSP's share of the vote in the 2022 assembly elections came down to just about 13 percent, a decline by over nine percentage points from the previous polls that translated into a lone seat in the 403-strong House. Other political parties, including the ASP, have been vying for this crucial votebank. Speaking to mediapersons last week, Chandrashekhar said that new faces have got an opportunity in Tamil Nadu. "If a party formed just two years ago can come to power there, why can't the Aazad Samaj Party achieve the same in Uttar Pradesh? We just need to put in the strength and effort. One day, power in the state will be ours," he said. Chandrashekhar has also indicated that his party is likely to contest the elections independently. Speaking to ThePrint, the ASP chief said, "All these so-called big parties act badly when it comes to seat-sharing in alliances. My experience in the 2022 Assembly polls was not good. That is why I contested independently in 2024 and won, because the people of Nagina were looking for an alternative to the BJP, and I emerged as that alternative. Similarly, people across the state want change. Whoever emerges as a strong alternative will get public

74. 'A CM shouldn't cry like this': VD Satheesan's emotional visit to late mentor's home | Watch

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Hindustan Times

■ **URL:** <https://www.hindustantimes.com/india-news/a-cm-shouldnt-cry-like-this-vd-satheesans-emotional-visit-to-late-mentors-home-kerala-101778847999698.html>

■ Summary:

Greeted by Karthikeyan's wife MT Sulekha and son, Congress leader K

Sabarinadhan, Satheesan could not hold back his emotions. This prompted Karthikeyan's wife to offer an affectionate rebuke: "A CM shouldn't cry like this." He smiled through tears. Also read | How VD Satheesan edged out KC Venugopal for Kerala's top post Speaking to reporters after the visit, Satheesan was candid remembered the bond he shared with the veteran leader who died in 2015. "I am someone who had actually moved away from student and youth politics. When I returned, it was he who insisted that I contest for the assembly in 1996 and 2001," Satheesan said. Satheesan described Karthikeyan's family as his own, and called the late leader the man who truly brought him into mainstream politics. Satheesan, who led the UDF opposition bloc through years of battles against the CPM-led Left Democratic Front, had a packed day of outreach as CM-designate.

75. Shiv Sena row: SC irked over irresponsible statements by politicians, warns them to be careful - CNBC TV18

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** cnbctv18.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.cnbctv18.com/india/shiv-sena-row-sc-irked-over-irresponsible-statements-by-politicians-warns-them-to-be-careful-ws-l-19907002.htm>

■ **Summary:**

The Supreme Court on Friday expressed strong displeasure over "irresponsible statements" of some politicians alleging nonhearing of the Shiv Sena symbol row case in the top court, and cautioned that they should be careful as such conduct can't be accepted. A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi observed that parties before it had sought dates in the matter and then statements were being made that the apex court was not deciding the case. The Supreme Court on Friday expressed strong displeasure over "irresponsible statements" of some politicians alleging non-hearing of the Shiv Sena symbol row case in the top court, and cautioned that they should be careful as such conduct can't be accepted. A

bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi observed that parties before it had sought dates in the matter and then statements were being made that the apex court was not deciding the case. "We will fix the date but first you stop your people from going to the media and making irresponsible statements saying that the Supreme Court is not deciding," an visibly anguished CJI told the counsel appearing for the Uddhav Thackeray-led faction. "You seek dates here and then say that the court is not deciding the matter. We are issuing a warning. Be careful in using your words. I am not a person who will accept this conduct," the CJI said. The bench, which said it expects cooperation from both the sides, questioned why some politicians were making such st

76. From landslide to slide: How Keir Starmer became so unpopular so soon

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/explained-global/how-starmer-became-unpopular-so-soon-10691408/>

■ **Summary:**

In the United Kingdom for the past few years, the more things change, the more they remain the same. The country is in a leadership crisis again, with ministers resigning and Prime Minister Starmer's future looking uncertain, even though the cast of characters has undergone a dramatic change. And like with most geopolitical upheavals in the world right now, UK's current political troubles too have the shadow of US President Donald Trump over them. The unravelling UK's Labour party swept to power in 2024 with a landslide win, ending a 14-year-period on the Opposition benches. Less than two years later, several ministers have resigned and nearly 90 Labour MPs have asked Prime Minister Sir Keir Starmer to step down, as the government's popularity ratings slide. Starmer, ever the hard worker, has vowed to keep calm and carry on, though no one seems very enthused by that. The signs of much of what is happening today could be read in the nature of his poll victory itself. Winner, not necessarily popular The 2024 elections were held in a Britain that was, like much of the Western world today, grappling with a changing society and a surge of nationalist sentiment. The Labour Party won 411 seats in the 650-seat House of Commons. This was one of the best election results for Labour in over a century, though with a vote share of only 34% -- the lowest for a ruling party in the UK. The latter lost a staggering 244 seats, winning about 24% of the vote share, down from 40% in 2019. The gai

77. Congress Urges Chief Electoral Officer To Conduct SIR In Phases In Telangana

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Deccan Chronicle

■ **URL:** <https://www.deccanchronicle.com/southern-states/telangana/cong-urges-chief-electoral-officer-to-conduct-sir-exercise-in-phases-in-telangana-1956914>

■ **Summary:**

Hyderabad: The ruling Congress in Telangana on Friday urged the chief electoral officer to conduct the SIR process in phases over 1.5 to two years, noting that no major elections are scheduled in the state during the next two to three years. The Election Commission on May 14 rolled out phase 3 of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls across 16 states, among them Telangana, and three union territories, covering 36.73 crore voters in a staggered manner beginning May 30. State Congress president B Mahesh Kumar Goud, who met the chief electoral officer here to convey the party's concerns and suggestions, said that if the SIR exercise were carried out hastily within two to three months, it could lead to "undesirable consequences" and "prove disastrous." He alleged that the large-scale deletion of voters during the SIR process altered the electoral outcome in West Bengal. While 90 lakh names were deleted from the electoral rolls in the eastern state, only 30 lakh were added, he claimed. "What we understand from this is that the votes of secular-minded voters were removed. We submitted a memorandum to the chief electoral officer to prevent such a situation in Telangana," Goud told reporters. "As no major elections are scheduled in the next two to three years, the SIR process may suitably be spread over a period of 1.5 to two years. Adequate time would facilitate the resolution of objections, reduce public apprehensions, and lessen administrative pressure," he said in a memo

78. Unemployed 'youngsters like cockroaches' become media, activists; attack system: CJI

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Economic Times

■ **URL:** <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/india/unemployed-youngsters-like-e-cockroaches-become-media-activists-attack-system-cji/articleshow/131117711.cms>

■ **Summary:**

New Delhi: Likening some unemployed youngsters to cockroaches, Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant on Friday said they go on to "become" media, social media and RTI activists and start attacking the system. The comments came while a bench of CJI Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi was pulling up a lawyer for "pursuing" a senior advocate designation. It said there were already "parasites" in society who attack the system and asked the petitioner whether he wanted to join hands with them. Also read: Supreme Court mandates virtual hearings, WFH amid war-driven fuel conservation push "The entire world may be eligible to become senior (advocate), but at least you are not entitled," the bench told the petitioner lawyer. A visibly anguished CJI observed that if the Delhi High Court would confer senior advocate designation upon the petitioner, the apex court would set that aside seeing his professional conduct. The CJI also referred to the kind of language used by the petitioner on Facebook. "There are already parasites of society who attack the system and you want to join hands with them?" he said. "There are youngsters like cockroaches, who don't get any employment or have any place in profession. Some of them become media, some of them become social media, RTI activists and other activists and they start attacking everyone," he said. The bench also asked the petitioner whether he did not have any other litigation. "Is this the conduct of a person who seeks to be designated as a s

79. No Melania, no problem? So Trump flew to Beijing with three female aides instead; everyone asking who these women are

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Economic Times

■ **URL:** <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/international/us/no-melania-no-problem-so-trump-flew-to-beijing-with-three-female-aides-instead-everyone-asking-who-these-women-are/articleshow/131116980.cms>

■ **Summary:**

President Donald Trump is on a high-stakes visit to China, accompanied by three key female aides: Anna Kelly, Natalie Harp, and Margo Martin. While Melania Trump remains in the US, these aides play crucial roles in communications and social media management, often staying out of the spotlight but deeply involved in the president's public image and outreach. President Donald Trump's latest China visit has sparked attention not only for its political significance, but also for the people traveling alongside him. While First Lady Melania Trump stayed back in the United States, three women from Trump's inner communications circle quietly became part of the high-profile delegation heading to Beijing. ALSO READ: Quote of the Day by Hermann Hesse: 'If you hate a person, you hate something in him that is...'- Author of Siddhartha's powerful words on hatred, self-awareness and the parts of ourselves we refuse to confront The visit marks the first time a sitting US president has met with China's leader since Trump's previous trip to Beijing in 2017. Alongside cabinet officials and business leaders, these three women have emerged as some of the most talked-about members of the delegation. Donald Trump landed in China on Wednesday for what has been described as a major diplomatic visit centered around trade and political negotiations with Xi Jinping. The president is expected to push for increased Chinese purchases of American products, including food and aircraft, during the meetings, a

80. Congress eyes comeback in Shillong Lok Sabha seat

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/meghalaya/congress-eyes-comeback-in-shillong-lok-sabha-seat/article70983170.ece>

■ **Summary:**

A beleaguered Congress is hoping to put its electoral debacle in Assam behind it and get back to winning ways in the Northeastern region, once its happy hunting ground. On Thursday (May 14, 2026), the Meghalaya Pradesh Congress Committee approved the name of its president, Vincent H. Pala, as the party's candidate for the upcoming by-election to the Shillong Lok Sabha seat. Mr. Pala represented the constituency for 15 years before Ricky Andrew J. Syngkon of the Voice of the People Party (VPP) defeated him in the 2024 polls by a margin of more than 3.71 lakh votes. The seat fell vacant following Syngkon's death on February 19, after collapsing while playing football on the outskirts of Shillong. Shillong MP Ricky Andrew J. Syngkon passes away Expected by August Chief Electoral Officer B.D.R. Tiwari said that his department was prepared and waiting for the schedule to be announced by the Election Commission. The by-election is expected by August. "The district and block-level leaders have proposed my name as the candidate. The proposal will be sent to our party's central leadership for a final decision," Mr. Pala said, hoping to wrest the Shillong seat where Congress enjoyed a 26-year run from 1998 to 2024. An engineer-turned-politician, he served as a Union Minister from 2009 to 2012. The VPP has named academician Batskhem Myrboh as its candidate for the constituency. At the same time, Chief Minister Conrad K. Sangma's National People's Party (NPP) has nominated scholar and pre

81. RG Kar Case: Family Hails Suspension Of IPS Officers

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Rediff.com India Ltd.

■ **URL:** <https://www.rediff.com/news/report/rg-kar-case-parents-see-hope-after-bengal-govt-move/20260515.htm>

■ **Summary:**

The suspension of three IPS officers in the RG Kar rape-and-murder case has revived the victim's family's hope for justice, marking a potential turning point in the investigation. Key Points West Bengal government widens investigation into the RG Kar rape-and-murder case. Three senior IPS officers suspended in connection with the RG Kar case. Victim's parents express renewed hope for justice following the suspensions. Allegations of police officers offering money to the victim's family to be investigated. Family alleges discrepancies in the initial investigation of the RG Kar incident. Hailing the West Bengal government's decision to widen the investigation into the RG Kar rape-and-murder case and suspend three senior IPS officers, the victim's parents on Friday said the move revived their hopes for justice and could lead to more arrests in the case that shook the nation. The victim's mother, Ratna Debnath, now the BJP MLA from Panihati, said the latest developments marked the beginning of a renewed judicial process. "I believe this is the beginning of a fresh phase in the pursuit of justice. More people will now be arrested," Debnath said, thanking Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari for ordering action. Key Suspensions in the RG Kar Case Earlier in the day, Adhikari announced the suspension of former Kolkata Police Commissioner Vineet Goyal, ex-Deputy Commissioner of Police (Central) Indira Mukherjee and former DC North Abhishek Gupta, while asserting that the investigation would al

82. 'Ink marks on index fingers': 25 foreign nationals held over alleged illegal voting in Tamil Nadu election | Today News

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** mint

■ **URL:** <https://www.livemint.com/news/india/ink-marks-on-index-fingers-25-foreign-nationals-held-over-alleged-illegal-voting-in-tamil-nadu-election-11778844061686.html>

■ **Summary:**

Around 25 foreign nationals, including Sri Lankans and others, were detained in Tamil Nadu for allegedly voting illegally in recent elections. Around 25 foreign nationals, including citizens of Sri Lanka, the United Kingdom, Indonesia, and Canada, have been detained or arrested at the Chennai and Madurai airports for allegedly voting illegally in the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections, according to media reports. According to a report by Deccan Herald citing officials, the individuals, all holding foreign passports, were stopped by immigration authorities and later taken into custody after indelible ink marks were discovered on their index fingers, indicating they had voted. Legal action has been initiated against them under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, the Representation of the People Act, 1950, and other relevant provisions, the report stated. Investigators further noted that most of the accused are believed to be Sri Lankan nationals. Investigations found that the accused, despite holding foreign citizenship and no longer being an Indian citizen, had allegedly stayed in different parts of the state to cast votes illegally, according to a PTI report citing a police statement. Investigators suspect that several more foreign nationals who entered the country during the election period may have voted and remained in India, aware that authorities were verifying passengers' credentials at airports during departure checks. Based on intelligence inputs that some foreigners were t

83. Assam Governor administers oath to Chandra Mohan Patowary as Pro-tem Speaker

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Shillong Times

■ **URL:** <https://theshillongtimes.com/2026/05/15/assam-governor-administers-oath-to-chandra-mohan-patowary-as-pro-tem-speaker/>

■ **Summary:**

Guwahati, May 15: Assam Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya on Friday administered the oath of office to senior BJP leader Chandra Mohan Patowary as the Pro-tem Speaker of the 16th Assam Legislative Assembly at a function held at Lok Bhavan in Guwahati. Patowary was sworn in under Clause (1) of Article 180 of the Constitution of India during a ceremony organised at the conference hall of Lok Bhavan. Before the commencement of the proceedings, Secretary of the Assam Legislative Assembly Dulal Pegu sought the Governor's permission to initiate the programme. Commissioner and Secretary to the Governor S.S. Meenakshi Sundaram, along with other senior officials of Lok Bhavan and the Assembly, were also present on the occasion. As Pro-tem Speaker, Patowary will preside over the initial sittings of the newly constituted Assembly and administer oath to the newly elected members before the election of the full-time Speaker. The assembly session will be held from May 21 and it will end on May 26. The budget session of the assembly is scheduled to happen in the first week of July. Earlier on Thursday, Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya approved the allocation of portfolios to the newly inducted members of the Council of Ministers in the Himanta Biswa Sarma-led government, according to an official communication issued from the Raj Bhavan. As per the notification, senior BJP leader Rameswar Teli has been allocated the departments of Transformation and Development, Labour Welfare, and Tea Tribes

84. UK health secretary quits cabinet, says PM Starmer lacks vision and direction

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Times of India

■ **URL:** <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/world/uk/uk-health-secretary-quits-cabinet-says-pm-starmer-lacks-vision-and-direction/articleshow/131116724.cms>

■ **Summary:**

TOI correspondent from London: UK health secretary Wes Streeting resigned from the cabinet on Thursday with a scathing letter telling UK PM Keir Starmer he had lost faith in his leadership. "Where we need vision, we have a vacuum. Where we need direction, we have drift," Streeting said in a blistering resignation letter, paving the way for a leadership challenge. Streeting, in his letter, called for a leadership election, a "battle of ideas", but stopped short of triggering one himself, though it is thought he does have the backing of 81 Labour MPs needed to do so. Downing Street said Starmer would fight any leadership challenge mounted against him. The PM's official spokesman said the "position hasn't changed since he set that out on Monday". Streeting is the first full cabinet minister to resign in the wake of disastrous local election results. Four junior ministers quit earlier in the week. Streeting revealed in the letter that he had told Starmer earlier in the week that he had lost confidence in his leadership and as a result it was "dishonourable and unprincipled" to remain in post. He criticised Starmer for not taking responsibility for his failures and allowing others to "fall on their swords", and for not listening to Labour colleagues. He said the reason for Labour's dismal performance in those elections was the "unpopularity of this govt", citing as reasons the winter fuel allowance cuts and Starmer's controversial "Island of Strangers" speech, which was compared to En

85. Democrats test a new red state strategy: Back independents over their own nominees

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Times of India

■ **URL:** <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/world/us/democrats-test-a-new-red-state-strategy-back-independents-over-their-own-nominees/articleshow/131115940.cms>

■ Summary:

NEW YORK: Democratic leaders, desperate to compete in red states where their party brand is toxic, are embracing something new this midterm season, i.e., not backing Democrats. In states like Nebraska and Alaska, Democratic officials are, in some cases, looking past their own party's candidates while subtly encouraging, or even openly promoting, independent candidates they hope can outperform the Democratic label. The Democratic National Committee and some of its allies in Washington are quietly supporting the new strategy. Meanwhile, some of the independent candidates are chatting in a group text about their approach as they plot a path that could shake up Congress, which is consumed by partisan gridlock. Nebraska Democrats this week chose a nominee for US Senate, Cindy Burbank, who said a major campaign priority was to ensure a Democrat wouldn't be on the fall ballot to pull support from independent Dan Osborn. Shortly after polls closed, Burbank reiterated her plan to drop out in the coming weeks during a private conversation with a party official, according to state Democratic chair Jane Kleeb. Democratic leaders believe Osborn, who came within 7 percentage points of winning a Senate seat in 2024, has the best chance to defeat Republican Sen. Pete Ricketts. Democrats' pivot toward independents is part of an intentional strategy in some places, and something closer to a wink and a nod in others, that covers a handful of high-profile Senate and House and even statehouse contests

86. Inside Trump's Beijing summit: \$100B+ Boeing and soybean deals sealed, but 'tough' realities over Taiwan and Jimmy Lai remain

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/world/trump-xi-jinping-beijing-summit-taiwan-boeing-trade-deal-iran-sanctions-10691311/>

■ Summary:

US President Donald Trump on Friday wrapped up a high-profile visit to Beijing with a series of wide-ranging remarks touching on Taiwan, trade, Iran, fentanyl, denuclearisation and economic ties with China after holding extensive talks with Chinese President Xi Jinping. The two leaders met during a closely watched summit in the Chinese capital that combined an elaborate diplomatic ceremony with discussions on some of the most sensitive issues shaping US-China relations. Trump later told reporters that Taiwan had figured prominently in his conversations with Xi, though he insisted he did not believe there was an imminent conflict over the island. "I made no commitment on Taiwan," Trump said, while adding that he and Xi had "talked a lot about Taiwan." Taiwan, security and denuclearisation discussions Trump also said, "I don't think there's a conflict on Taiwan," comments likely to be closely analysed in both Washington and Beijing amid continuing tensions in the Indo-Pacific region. Must Read | Trump-Xi Summit LIVE: Beijing being 'very pragmatic' on Iran, says top US official, as Trump and Xi meet for final day of summit The US President said he discussed denuclearisation with Xi during the summit but declined to reveal details of the conversation. On Iran, Trump said he would support an arrangement in which Tehran suspended its nuclear programme for 20 years, provided the commitment was genuine and enforceable. Trump further revealed that he was considering lifting sanctions

87. How Bengal's Landslide Pattern Helped BJP Secure a Massive Mandate

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Frontline

■ **URL:** <https://frontline.thehindu.com/politics/bjp-win-bengal-development-over-identity-election-trends/article70982658.ece>

■ Summary:

The BJP's landslide victory in West Bengal has surprised many. While a section did believe that the party would win, what seems to have surprised several others is the extent of the victory -- 207 seats with a 45.8 per cent vote share. The landslide victory, however, should not be a surprise. Since the 1972 Assembly election, Bengal has had a history of giving landslide victories to the winning party, barring a few exceptions. The winning party has always won by a substantial margin both in terms of seats and vote share. If we look at Assembly election data since 1972, we see that the proportion of seats won by the ruling party has mostly been above 50 per cent, barring the 2001 election when the Communist Party of India (Marxist), or CPI(M), won 49 per cent of the seats. The 1972 election, which was held for 280 seats, saw the highest percentage of seats won by the Congress at 77 per cent (Table 1). Since then, the victory sweep was in the 50-60 per cent range until the 2016 Assembly election. Since 2016, the percentage of seats won has been in the 70 per cent range, with 72 per cent in 2016 and 73 per cent in 2021, both won by the All India Trinamool Congress. Now, we have the BJP with 70 per cent seats in the 2026 Assembly election. The pattern points to a long-standing tendency in Bengal's politics towards decisive electoral mandates. How did the BJP manage to secure such a massive victory and nearly match the previous government in terms of the proportion of seats won? T

88. India News | Delhi CM Rekha Gupta Hands over Job Letters to Kin of Deceased NDMC Employees | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/india-news-delhi-cm-rekha-gupta-hands-over-job-letters-to-kin-of-deceased-ndmc-employees-7431620.html>

■ Summary:

Get latest articles and stories on India at LatestLY. CM Rekha Gupta congratulated the officials and employees involved in making the initiative possible and said that jobs provided on compassionate grounds would offer significant support to affected families. New Delhi [India], May 15 (ANI): Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Friday attended the distribution programme of compassionate appointment letters to NDMC employees and Medical Cards to contractual employees in Delhi. Speaking on the occasion, CM Rekha Gupta congratulated the officials and employees involved in making the initiative possible and said that jobs provided on compassionate grounds would offer significant support to affected families. Also Read | Meerut Blue Drum-Like Murder in Maharashtra: Woman Kills Lover With Husband and Brother's Help, Stuffs Body in Green Drum (Videos). "I would like to congratulate the whole team for making this possible. This job that you have gained on compassionate grounds will be very helpful for your family... It is not easy to get a job under compassionate grounds," she said. The Chief Minister also appreciated the inclusion of contractual employees under the health mission through the distribution of Medical Cards, stating that the initiative would support families during health-related emergencies. Also Read | Who Is Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar? All You Need To Know As Kalyan Banerjee Replaces Her As TMC Chief Whip in Lok Sabha. "The facilities provided to the contractual employee

89. 'Sorry ... ': Shashi Tharoor to miss Kerala CM swearing in ceremony

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Times of India

■ **URL:** <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/sorry-shashi-tharoor-to-miss-kerala-cm-swearing-in-ceremony/articleshow/131116829.cms>

■ Summary:

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Shashi Tharoor will skip the oath taking ceremony of Kerala's newly designated chief minister VD Satheesan on May 18. Announcing the decision on Friday on his X handle, Tharoor said that he will be in Boston, US to deliver the commencement address at the graduation ceremony of his alma mater, the Fletcher School of Law and Diplomacy at Tufts University."I'm sorry to be missing the swearing-in ceremony of my Congress Kerala colleague and new CM of Kerala VD Satheesan. I am in Boston this weekend to deliver the Commencement address at the graduation ceremony of my alma mater, the Fletcher School of Law & Diplomacy at Tufts University and also to participate in the 50th anniversary reunion of my graduating class! An occasion for celebrating the past in the US even as I look forward to the future in Kerala," he wrote. VD Satheesan was nominated on Thursday, a week after the Congress-led United Democratic Front swept back to power in Kerala, ending the second consecutive term of the Left Democratic Front-led by Pinarayi Vijayan. The decision was finalised by the Congress leadership after discussions within the party's top brass, including Mallikarjun Kharge, Rahul Gandhi and Sonia Gandhi. Satheesan won the 2026 Kerala assembly election from the Paravur constituency, marking his sixth consecutive term as an MLA. He secured 78,658 votes and defeated CPI candidate E T Taison Master by a margin of 20,600 votes. He has represented Paravur for 25 years, having f

90. SIR In Karnataka To Begin On June 30, Over 50,000 BLOs To Be Deployed For Massive Voter Roll Revision

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Republic World

■ **URL:** <https://www.republicworld.com/india/sir-in-karnataka-to-begin-on-june-30-over-50000-blos-to-be-deployed-for-massive-voter-roll-revision-2026-05-15-124380>

■ Summary:

New Delhi: Karnataka is set to begin a statewide Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls from June 30 in what will be one of the biggest voter verification exercises in the state ahead of future elections. The Chief Electoral Officer of Karnataka announced that Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will begin door-to-door verification across the state after a preparatory and training phase scheduled between June 20 and June 29. More than 59,000 BLOs will be deployed for the exercise, which will involve verifying voter details, distributing enumeration forms and updating electoral rolls at the grassroots level. As of May 12, 2026, Karnataka has over 5.55 crore registered voters. Under the revision process, BLOs will visit households between June 30 and July 29 to verify voter information and distribute forms to residents. Election officials said each voter will receive two copies of the enumeration form. One copy can be retained by the voter for reference, while the other will be submitted for verification purposes. Further, voters will be allowed to either sign the form or provide a thumb impression. If a person is unavailable during the visit, an adult member of the family can complete the process on their behalf. Officials said voters will have to provide any one document from a list of 12 approved identification documents during verification. The Election Commission also indicated that individuals whose names were not part of the 2002 Special Intensive Revision database

91. Mamata Banerjee Drops Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar as Chief Whip: Who Is the Veteran TMC Leader?

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** NewsX

■ **URL:** <https://www.newsx.com/?p=219592>

■ **Summary:**

Mamata Banerjee has appointed Kalyan Banerjee as the new Chief Whip of TMC in the Lok Sabha, replacing senior leader Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar in a key parliamentary change. The move is being seen as a strategic step to strengthen the party's aggressive and coordinated approach amid rising political pressure in West Bengal. While Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar remains a Lok Sabha MP, her removal from the post has sparked talks of internal power shifts within the party. The decision has drawn mixed reactions -- some call it a strong organisational move, while others see it as a sign of changing equations inside the TMC. Mamata Banerjee has brought about a major reshuffle in the All India Trinamool Congress parliamentary leadership and removed Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar from the post of Chief Whip in the Lok Sabha and appointed Kalyan Banerjee as her successor. The move has sparked a heated political debate in West Bengal especially as Kakoli was considered one of Mamata Banerjee's long-time loyalists and a trusted face in Parliament. Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar was appointed as the Trinamool Congress Chief Whip in August 2025 and served in the post for just about nine months before being replaced. Her sudden ouster is being viewed as more than a routine organisational reshuffle with political analysts seeing it as part of a bigger strategy by the TMC leadership to overhaul its parliamentary functioning and improve internal coordination after recent electoral setbacks in West Bengal. Who Is Kakoli Gho

92. 'Look Forward To Future In Kerala': Shashi Tharoor To Miss VD Satheesan's Swearing-In As CM; Here's Why

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** News18

■ **URL:** <https://www.news18.com/india/look-forward-to-future-in-kerala-shashi-tharoor-to-miss-vd-satheesans-swearing-in-as-cm-heres-why-10093492.html>

■ **Summary:**

The Thiruvananthapuram MP, whose name was also being touted at one point as a possible CM candidate, clarified his position on X The 'Battle for the Throne' in Kerala may have reached its logical conclusion with the Congress finally picking VD Satheesan as Chief Minister, but the impending absence of one of the party's most visible global faces at the swearing-in ceremony has ensured that the embers of internal friction remain warm. On May 18, while the Lok Bhavan in Thiruvananthapuram prepares for a historic transition of power, Dr Shashi Tharoor will be precisely 8,112 miles away -- celebrating a half-century of personal history in the United States. Academics and Anniversaries Taking to X to clarify his absence, the Thiruvananthapuram MP, whose name was also being touted at one point as a possible CM candidate, revealed he is in Boston this weekend for a dual milestone at his alma mater, the Fletcher School of Law & Diplomacy at Tufts University. Tharoor is slated to deliver the prestigious commencement address and participate in the 50th anniversary reunion of his graduating class. "An occasion for celebrating the past in the US even as I look forward to the future in Kerala," Tharoor posted. On the surface, the reason is unassailable; a keynote address at one's alma mater after five decades is a rare, career-defining honour that few politicians would decline. Optics in Focus However, in the hypersensitive theatre of Kerala Congress politics, timing is rarely seen as a me

93. Who is Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar? Veteran TMC parliamentarian replaced in key Lok Sabha role- Moneycontrol.com

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** MoneyControl

■ **URL:** <https://www.moneycontrol.com/news/politics/who-is-kakoli-ghosh-dastidar-ve-teran-tmc-parliamentarian-replaced-in-key-lok-sabha-role-13920598.html>

■ **Summary:**

TMC faces internal tensions after Assembly election setbacks Former Chief Minister of West Bengal and TMC supremo, Mamata Banerjee, on Thursday, replaced senior MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar as the party's chief whip in the Lok Sabha, bringing back Kalyan Banerjee to the post during a meeting of party MPs at Kalighat. The reshuffle comes at a politically sensitive moment for the TMC after the party's setback in the West Bengal Assembly elections and amid growing signs of internal unease within the organisation. Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar, one of the senior-most women leaders in the party, currently serves as the national president of the All India Trinamool Mahila Congress, the women's wing of the TMC. A doctor by profession, she entered politics through the Congress student movement and has shared a long political association with Mamata Banerjee dating back to the 1970s. Soon after being removed from the parliamentary post, Kakoli appeared to express disappointment in a cryptic Facebook post. "Acquainted since 1976, walking together since 1984. Today I was rewarded for four decades of loyalty," she wrote. The remark has been widely interpreted within political circles as an expression of hurt over her removal from the key parliamentary position. Kakoli and Mamata first met when both were active in Congress-backed student politics in Kolkata. Kakoli was associated with student politics at Kolkata Medical College, while Mamata was active at Jogamaya Devi College. Their political relati

94. top news of the day | may 15 2026

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/news/top-news-of-the-day-may-15-2026/article70983075.ece>

■ **Summary:**

NTA announces NEET-UG re-exam on June 21 Medical entrance exam NEET-UG, which was cancelled following allegations of irregularities in the examination process, will be re-conducted on June 21, the National Testing Agency (NTA) announced on Friday (May 15, 2026). The exam was earlier conducted on May 3. The NTA had on Tuesday (May 12, 2026) announced the cancellation of NEET-UG and said the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) would carry out a comprehensive inquiry into the alleged irregularities linked to the exam. Bhojshala-Kamal Maula complex declared as temple by Madhya Pradesh High Court The Madhya Pradesh High Court on Friday (May 15, 2026) declared that the disputed Bhojshala complex in Dhar is a temple dedicated to Goddess Saraswati, adding that the Muslim community may approach the State government for allotment of separate land in the district for construction of a mosque. Petrol, diesel prices hiked by ■3 across all variants In response to price and supply pressures due the West Asia crisis, oil-marketing companies on Friday (May 15, 2026) hiked the prices of petrol and diesel by ■3 per litre across all variants. That is, the latest price hikes extend to both the regular variants of petrol and diesel alongside the premium and high-octane products. Rathindra Bose, a Chartered Accountant and BJP north Bengal MLA, elected Speaker of Bengal Assembly Rathindra Bose, Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MLA from the Cooch Behar Dakshin Assembly seat, was on Friday (May 15, 2026

95. No reports of post-poll violence yet, says CM Adhikari amid TMC protest

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Rediff.com India Ltd.

■ **URL:** <https://www.rediff.com/news/report/no-reports-of-post-poll-violence-yet-says-cm-adhikari-amid-tmc-protest/20260515.htm>

■ **Summary:**

The West Bengal government, led by Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari, said that there is no information on such incidents, promising action only after thorough verification. IMAGE: West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari meets the newly elected Speaker of the West Bengal Legislative Assembly Rathindra Bose, in Kolkata, May 15, 2026. Photograph: ANI Photo Key Points Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari assures verification and action on genuine cases of violence. Opposition TMC alleges post-poll violence and displacement of people in West Bengal. BJP MLA Rathindra Bose elected unopposed as Speaker of the West Bengal assembly. Government emphasises constructive opposition and adherence to constitutional principles in the assembly. West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Friday said his government has no information on incidents of post-poll violence as alleged by the opposition TMC, and asserted that action would be taken after proper verification of such charges. He was responding to the allegations of post-poll violence raised by Leader of the Opposition Sobhandeb Chattopadhyay in the West Bengal assembly. Chattopadhyay, speaking during the first session of the newly constituted assembly, alleged that several people had been forced to flee their homes due to violence across the state after the assembly elections. TMC alleges post-poll violence, demands action "Violence has been taking place in several places. Many people are homeless now. The government should take strict

96. Salman Sagar on JKNC's Post-2019 Strategy: Statehood First, Article 370 Later

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Frontline

■ **URL:** <https://frontline.thehindu.com/interviews/jknc-committed-restoring-kashmir-powers-after-august-revocation/article70982083.ece>

■ **Summary:**

The senior leader says the sentiment is that powers must be reclaimed. Statehood must come first, and after that, special protections from the Government of India. In the latest episode of The Kashmir Notebook, host Gowhar Geelani speaks with Salman Sagar, senior Jammu and Kashmir National Conference leader and MLA from Hazratbal, on the growing political debates shaping Jammu and Kashmir after 2019. The conversation covers reservation policy controversies, Articles 370 and 35A, restoration of statehood, the National Conference's manifesto promises, the Lieutenant Governor's powers, governance challenges, Waqf administration, press freedom, and the future of Kashmir's political identity. Salman Sagar also responds to criticism from opposition parties, including the PDP and People's Conference, while defending the Omar Abdullah government's performance and long-term political roadmap. Edited excerpts: We have been meaning to speak with you on various issues, especially because you are part of the ruling government with over 40 MLAs. The first question I would like to ask is about what has happened in West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, and Assam. There has been something of a political earthquake in West Bengal, with the BJP coming to power with a thumping majority. In Assam, the result was expected, but Tamil Nadu has thrown a surprise by giving its mandate to a film actor, Vijay. Are these developments a concern for you, that something similar could happen in Kashmir in the future? I t

97. LDF accepts poll defeat, will be constructive opposition: MV Govindan

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Asianet News Network Pvt Ltd

■ **URL:** <https://newsable.asianetnews.com/india/ldf-accepts-poll-defeat-will-be-constructive-opposition-mv-govindan-articleshow-39bagt6>

■ **Summary:**

CPI(M) State Secretary MV Govindan announced that the LDF will not boycott the new CM's swearing-in and will function as a constructive opposition after its major election setback, ending its decade-long rule in Keralam. Keralam Communist Party of India (Marxist) State Secretary MV Govindan on Friday said the Left Democratic Front (LDF) will not boycott the swearing-in ceremony of Chief Minister-designate VD Satheesan, adding that the alliance would function as a constructive opposition. He said the party leadership had held detailed discussions on the recent election defeat, terming the outcome a major setback for the LDF and acknowledging that multiple factors contributed to the loss. Add Asianet Newsable as a Preferred Source A day earlier, Congress officially named Satheesan as the next Chief Minister of Keralam following the UDF's sweeping victory in the 2026 Assembly elections. Satheesan is scheduled to take oath as Chief Minister on May 18 at 10 am at Lok Bhavan. Speaking to the reporters in Kannur, Govindan said, "The LDF would not boycott the swearing-in ceremony as the UDF had done earlier and would instead function as a constructive opposition. The party leadership had discussed the election defeat in detail." "The discussions held at the state leadership level are not yet complete, and the matter would be further examined across all party units," he said. UDF Ends LDF's Decade-Long Rule The Congress-led UDF secured a decisive mandate in the 140-member Keralam Asse

98. Mamata Banerjee treats visual politics like a contact sport. Her lawyer avatar is proof

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/opinion/mamata-banerjee-lawyer-avatar-visual-politics-bengal-elections-bjp-tmc/2932322/>

■ **Summary:**

Then came the perfect second act. As spicy as the Bengal election season was this year, extra masala was thrown in the meat by the Bar Council of India, which stepped in to essentially ask Mamata: 'One minute, Didi, documents please?' The whole thing was so perfectly Mamata that Bengal practically wrote the punchlines itself. For years, Mamata treated visual politics like a full-contact sport. She and Narendra Modi have that (and much more) in common. She built an entire political identity around being visually unmistakable but she did it with unremarkable clothing. The simple cotton sarees, durable rubber chappals, hair tied down and glasses -- became her public uniform. But with this almost stereotypical politician's outfit, she wore brazen confidence on her sleeve. She claimed that she can speak in several languages, she (barely) paints, writes (supposed) poems, sings, dances, even jogs backwards. She -- Mamata says so herself -- can do it all. So of course, she can fight her own case, just like she did a few months ago when she presented arguments in the Supreme Court in the SIR case. She is the permanent street fighter, always ready for the next punch, even after a knockout. But this 'don't care' attitude comes curated for visual politics. From her infamous image atop Jayaprakash Narayan's car's bonnet during the Emergency to her wheelchair campaign during the last election, Didi has always instinctively understood and used the camera well. Her 26-day hunger strike durin

99. Opaqueness around Rahul's foreign trips worrisome, violation of rules: Rijju

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hans India

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehansindia.com/news/national/opaqueness-around-rahuls-foreign-trips-worrisome-violation-of-rules-rijju-1075902>

■ Summary:

New Delhi: Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju on Friday backed the BJP's demands for clarity on the "funding" of Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi's foreign trips as well as the "unaccounted" income that was being spent on facilitating the same. Speaking to the media, Rijiju also stated the 'opaqueness' around certain foreign visits by the Congress MP was worrisome as it amounted to a violation of Parliamentary protocols. "The questions being raised are serious because if any member of Parliament travels abroad, he or she must inform the Secretariat of the Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha, three weeks in advance," the Union Minister said, outlining the rules that every lawmaker must adhere to, purportedly for security reasons. Rijiju's remarks come on the back of controversy around 'money trail' pertaining to Rahul Gandhi's foreign tours, which highlights a glaring mismatch between his declared income and expenses on foreign tours, in the past two decades, while abroad. On Thursday, BJP MP Sambit Patra, in a scathing charge at Rahul, claimed that the declared income of Congress MP has been Rs 11 crores but he has spent about Rs 60 crore in the 54 foreign trips undertaken across continents, including Europe, the Middle-East, and also questioned from where the LoP was drawing funds for such trips. Rijiju said that if Rahul's expenses abroad exceed the income declared in his election affidavit, it becomes a matter of concern for the Income Tax department. Whether th

100. From 'Panna Pramukh' to 'booth sevak': Cong to adopt BJP-style poll strategy in Punjab

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Times of India

■ **URL:** <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/city/chandigarh/from-panna-pramukh-to-booth-sevak-cong-to-adopt-bjp-style-poll-strategy-in-punjab/articleshow/131115868.cms>

■ Summary:

Chandigarh: With its eyes set on the 2027 Punjab assembly elections, the Congress has taken inspiration from national rival BJP's election playbook of booth-level management. In an emulation of the saffron party's 'Panna Pramukh' strategy, the Congress has decided to appoint 'booth sevaks' across the state. The Congress, which has been positioning itself as the principal challenger to the AAP govt, will appoint sevaks at every booth, with each being assigned the responsibility of managing one page of the voter list containing around 30 voters. BJP had introduced the 'Panna Pramukh' system in the 2007 Gujarat assembly elections and later implemented it nationally during the 2014 Lok Sabha polls. The structure is now being adopted by the Congress to strengthen ground-level voter outreach and mobilisation. Booth sevaks will directly connect with voters assigned to them and mobilise them during elections. Punjab Pradesh Congress president Amrinder Singh Raja Warring said the party had decided to appoint booth sevaks as part of a detailed strategy to engage directly with voters at the grassroots and strengthen the organisation booth by booth across Punjab. The party has also decided to install nameplates outside the homes of booth sevaks to give them recognition and help voters identify their local point of contact. A strategy is also being prepared to reach out to different voter groups and ensure mobilisation on polling day. All booth-level activities will be monitored and coordin

101. 94.64% Voters Mapped: All You Need To Know About SIR Of Electoral Rolls In Odisha

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ODISHA BYTES

■ **URL:** <https://odishabytes.com/94-64-voters-mapped-all-you-need-to-know-about-sir-of-electoral-rolls-in-odisha/>

■ Summary:

Bhubaneswar: The Election Commission is conducting a Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Odisha to ensure the voter list is accurate and up-to-date ahead of future elections. The process involves extensive door-to-door verification and aims to include eligible voters while removing ineligible or deceased entries. Key Timeline For SIR 2026 Door-to-Door Verification: May 30 to June 28, 2026 Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will visit households to distribute and collect enumeration forms. Qualifying Date: July 1, 2026 Individuals who turn 18 on or before this date will be eligible for inclusion in the voter list. Draft Electoral Roll Publication: July 5, 2026 A draft list will be published, followed by a nearly month-long window for filing claims, objections, and corrections. Final Publication: September 6, 2026 The final, updated voter list will be published after completing verification, corrections, and grievance redressal. What Did The CEO Say Speaking to the media, Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) R S Gopalan said that preparatory activities will begin from May 20-May 29 during which training will be conducted and enumeration forms for 3.34 crore electors will be printed. Registration of polling stations will be completed by May 28. The main field exercise will begin on May 30 and continue till June 28 during which BLOs will go house-to-house to collect information. The draft electoral roll will be published by July 5 and claims/objections will be accepted till

102. AAP Suffers Setback in Mohali

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** 5 Dariya News

■ **URL:** <http://www.5dariyanews.com/news/489195-AAP-Suffers-Setback-in-Mohali>

■ Summary:

The Aam Aadmi Party received a major setback in Mohali politics when State Gau Seva Commission member Amit Jain joined the Congress party. Former minister Balbir Singh Sidhu formally inducted Amit Jain into Congress today and handed him

the responsibility of Ward No. 22. Speaking on the occasion, Balbir Singh Sidhu said that the Congress party is continuously growing stronger and people from different sections of society are joining the party after being influenced by its policies. He expressed confidence that Amit Jain's entry into the party would further strengthen Congress in Ward 22. After joining Congress, Amit Jain said that he took the decision keeping in mind public service and the development of the area. He assured that the issues of Ward 22 residents would be raised on priority and development works would be accelerated. Congress workers and supporters showed great enthusiasm during the event. Party leaders welcomed Amit Jain and claimed that Congress would contest the upcoming Municipal Corporation elections with full strength.

103. Americans would rather live near nuclear plants than AI data centres, survey finds

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Firstpost

■ **URL:** <https://www.firstpost.com/tech/americans-would-rather-live-near-nuclear-plants-than-ai-data-centres-survey-finds-14011567.html>

■ **Summary:**

The rapid expansion of artificial intelligence infrastructure in the United States is running into an unexpected obstacle: local communities. A new poll by Gallup has found that most Americans are uncomfortable with the idea of AI data centres being built close to where they live. In fact, respondents were more accepting of nearby nuclear energy facilities than large-scale AI computing sites. The findings highlight the growing tension between the tech industry's demand for massive computing power and increasing public concern over the real-world impact of the infrastructure needed to support it. Environmental anxiety becomes a major flashpoint. According to the survey, 71 per cent of Americans oppose the construction of AI-focused data centres in their local area, including nearly half who said they are strongly against such

projects. By comparison, opposition to nuclear power plants stood lower, at 53 per cent. Only one in five respondents said they supported nearby data centre development, while a very small percentage expressed strong support. Much of the resistance appears linked to environmental concerns. Seven in 10 respondents said they were worried about the effect data centres could have on local ecosystems and resources. Among the biggest worries was the enormous amount of electricity and water these facilities consume. Some respondents specifically pointed to the pressure data centres place on power grids and freshwater supplies, both of which are already under stra

104. Mahila Morcha protests target UDF over free KSRTC bus ride poll promise

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** metrovaartha.com

■ **URL:** <https://english.metrovaartha.com/news/kerala/mahila-morcha-protests-target-udf-over-free-ksrtc-bus-ride-poll-promise>

■ **Summary:**

Mahila Morcha, the women's wing of the BJP, staged protests across Kerala demanding free travel for women in KSRTC buses, as promised by the UDF during the Assembly election Thiruvananthapuram | Mahila Morcha, the women's wing of the BJP, on Friday staged protests across Kerala demanding free travel for women in KSRTC buses, as promised by the UDF during the Assembly election. Mahila Morcha leaders and activists boarded Kerala State Road Transport Corporation (KSRTC) buses from depots across the state and refused to take tickets. In Kozhikode, around 20 Mahila Morcha activists boarded a KSRTC bus from the main bus stand and refused to pay the fare. "The UDF had said during the election that free bus travel would be implemented from May 15. So we will not take tickets. We will not allow people to be cheated with false promises," a leader told reporters. However, when

KSRTC workers informed them that the new UDF government was yet to assume office and no directive had been issued on free travel, the protesters deboarded the bus.

105. Jharkhand CEO calls all-party meet on voter revision

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <https://www.uniindia.com/~/jharkhand-ceo-calls-all-party-meet-on-voter-revision/States/news/3844163.html>

■ **Summary:**

Ranchi, May 15 (UNI) Jharkhand Chief Electoral Officer K Ravi Kumar has convened an all-party meeting on May 22 regarding the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls scheduled to begin in the state from June 30. The meeting will discuss preparations related to the special intensive revision of voters and training of Booth Level Agents (BLAs), officials said on Friday. The Chief Electoral Officer said a video conference meeting with district election officers and deputy election officers of all districts would also be held to review preparedness for the exercise. As part of the process, the list of all unmapped voters along with names and contact numbers of Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will be published at polling stations on May 23. According to the Election Commission of India, door-to-door voter verification across Jharkhand will be conducted from June 30 to July 29. A total of 29,571 BLOs will be deployed for verification of 2,64,89,777 voters in the state. Election Commission data showed that 21,644 BLAs nominated by political parties are also expected to play a key role in the revision exercise. Officials said training programmes for BLAs would be conducted by the Election Commission. As per the schedule issued by the Commission, revision of polling stations will be completed by July 29, while the draft publication of electoral rolls will take place on Aug 5. Claims and objections regarding the voter list can be submitted between Aug 5 and Sept 4. Disposal of

106. Major IAS Reshuffle in Bihar, several top bureaucrats reassigned

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <https://www.uniindia.com/~major-ias-reshuffle-in-bihar-several-top-bureaucrats-reassigned/States/news/3844188.html>

■ **Summary:**

Patna, May 15 (UNI) Bihar government on Friday transferred several senior IAS officers and reassigned responsibilities across departments to streamline governance. According to the official notification, K. Senthil Kumar (1996 batch) has been transferred from the Sugarcane Industry Department and appointed as Additional Chief Secretary of the Labour Resources and Migrant Workers Welfare Department. He will also hold additional charge of the Backward and Extremely Backward Classes Welfare Department. H.R. Srinivas (1996 batch), who was holding additional charge of the same department, has been relieved of that responsibility. Rajesh Kumar (2001 batch), earlier Commissioner of Kosi Division, Saharsa, has been appointed as Principal Secretary of the Public Health Engineering Department. Pankaj Kumar Pal (2002 batch) has been made Secretary of the Road Construction Department. Abhay Kumar Singh (2006 batch) has been transferred as Secretary of the Information Technology Department and will continue to hold additional charge as Managing Director of Bihar State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (BELTRON). Dharmendra Singh (2006 batch), Secretary of the Cooperative Department, will hold additional charge of the Sugarcane Industry Department. Deepak Anand (2007 batch) has been appointed Secretary of the Food and Consumer Protection Department. Vinod Singh Gunjiyal (2007 batch), Secretary of the Election Department and Chief Electoral Officer, has been given additional charge

107. Beyond Trending: What is Thucydides Trap?

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/upsc-current-affairs/upsc-essentials/beyond-trending-what-is-thucydides-trap-10691250/>

■ **Summary:**

As US President Donald Trump wraps up his two-day visit to China, an ancient feud - the Peloponnesian War - referred to by Chinese President Xi Jinping has become a common refrain to interpret the evolving ties between the two major powers. In his opening remarks ahead of a closed-door meeting with Trump, Xi asked, "Can China and the United States transcend the so-called 'Thucydides Trap' and forge a new paradigm for major-power relations? What is Thucydides Trap? The term Thucydides Trap is traced to the work of Greek historian Thucydides, The History of the Peloponnesian War, which tells the history of a war between the Athenian Empire and Sparta and its allies fought between 431 and 404 BC. Graham Allison's book, Destined for War: Can America and China Escape Thucydides (2017), is often credited with popularising the term in 21st century international politics. It is widely understood to refer to the power transition, wherein the rise of a great power threatening an established one often results in war. Thus, in the context of the power transition, reference to Thucydides trap by transition power theorists is no less obvious. Also Read | Beyond Trending: What is strategic ambiguity? In addition, the Melian Dialogue mentioned in Thucydides' book, where Athenians assert that "the strong do what they can and the weak suffer what they must" became a reference point for defining power politics in international relations. Realists, who see power as the defining feature of anarch

108. SDPO suspended for taking gold jewellery from shop without paying in Odisha's Aska

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** KalingaTV

■ **URL:** <https://kalingatv.com/odisha/sdpo-suspended-for-taking-gold-jewellery-from-shop-without-paying-in-odishas-aska/>

■ **Summary:**

Berhampur: The sub-divisional police officer (SDPO) of Aska, Santosh Kumar Jena, has been suspended for allegedly taking gold jewelry from a shop without paying in Odisha's Ganjam district. SDPO Santosh Kumar Jena was suspended on Tuesday following a complaint by the owner of the jewellery shop at Aska. The complaint was registered around three months ago. The jeweller alleged that Jena had taken gold ornaments from his shop but did not make the payment even after repeated requests. As all requests failed, the shop owner reportedly submitted complaints to the DGP and the Chief Minister's Grievance Cell. In addition, he had also uploaded a video related to the matter on Facebook, which he later deleted. Later, acting on the complaint, the senior officials of Home department conducted an investigation. During the investigation, they found that the allegations brought against the SDPO is true. Ganjam SP Suvendhu Kumar Patra also submitted a detailed report on the SDPO, which stated that there were also several fraud allegations against Jena. Following the investigation, the SDPO was suspended immediately under Rule 12(1) of the Odisha Civil Services (Classification, Control & Appeal) Rules, 1962. An official order of the Home department said, "Santosh Kumar Jena, OPS, SDPO, Aska is placed under suspension with immediate effect under Rule 12(1) of the Odisha Civil Services (Classification, Control & Appeal) Rules, 1962, pending drawal of disciplinary proceeding against him." Dur

109. LDF To Attend UDF Oath Ceremony, Vows To Be Responsible Opposition

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Rediff.com India Ltd.

■ **URL:** <https://www.rediff.com/news/report/ldf-to-attend-udf-oath-ceremony-govindan/20260515.htm>

■ **Summary:**

The LDF will attend the UDF oath-taking ceremony in Kerala, signalling a new approach to opposition politics and a commitment to responsible governance.

Photograph: ANI PhotoKey Points LDF to attend UDF oath-taking ceremony, marking a change in political approach. CPI(M) vows LDF will function as a responsible opposition in Kerala. Pinarayi Vijayan selected as opposition leader after Assembly poll results. LDF analysing reasons for defeat in Assembly polls and planning corrective measures. LDF rejects claims of diminishing influence in Kerala, expects a strong return. CPI(M) state secretary M V Govindan on Friday said that the opposition LDF will attend the oath taking ceremony of the UDF, unlike the Congress-led front, which had boycotted the event when the Left front formed the government in 2021. The swearing-in ceremony will be held on May 18. LDF's Role as a Responsible Opposition Govindan said that the Left will function as a responsible opposition by completely accepting what is right and strongly criticising what is wrong. "We will also support the government when it needs to correct itself to move forward," he told reporters here. Pinarayi Vijayan as Opposition Leader Regarding Pinarayi Vijayan's selection as opposition leader, he said that it was a unanimous decision. "As soon as the CM was announced, we announced the opposition leader. If there is no CM, there would be no opposition leader," he said. Analysing the Assembly Poll Defeat Govindan also said that detailed di

110. What to Expect in Louisiana's Primaries | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/what-to-expect-in-louisianas-primaries-7431561.html>

■ Summary:

WASHINGTON (AP) -- Louisiana voters will participate in a revamped and stripped-down state primary Saturday and decide the political fate of an embattled Republican U.S. senator targeted for defeat by President Donald Trump. Sen. Bill Cassidy is running for a third term but first must overcome a Republican primary field that includes state Treasurer John Fleming and U.S. Rep. Julia Letlow, who was endorsed by Trump in January. The primary is the president's latest opportunity to exact retribution from his perceived political enemies, including fellow Republicans he considers disloyal. Cassidy has been near the top of that list since his vote more than five years ago to convict Trump in his second impeachment trial following the insurrection by his supporters at the U.S. Capitol on Jan. 6, 2021. Trump was acquitted. Also Read | Russia-Ukraine War: Russia Launches Biggest Air Barrage Since Invasion, 24 Dead in Kyiv Apartment Attack. Louisiana is not among the states Democrats are targeting in their effort to retake the U.S. Senate. A Cassidy defeat in the primary would likely result in a Senate GOP caucus even more unified behind Trump and further demonstrate the strength of the president's grip on the party. Voters will also decide primary contests for state Supreme Court, Public Service Commission and state school board, along with five proposed state constitutional amendments. Louisiana's primaries for U.S. House were postponed after the U.S. Supreme Court struck down the st

111. Karnataka electoral roll SIR exercise to begin from June 20

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** News18

■ **URL:** <https://www.news18.com/agency-feeds/karnataka-electoral-roll-sir-exercise-to-begin-from-june-20-10093432.html>

■ Summary:

Bengaluru, May 15 (PTI) Karnataka will begin SIR of electoral rolls from June 20 as

part of a nationwide exercise covering 16 states and three Union territories, CEO Anbu Kumar said on Friday. The drive will cover more than 5.55 crore electors in the state, he said. As per the schedule notified by the Election Commission (EC), preparation, training and printing activities will be carried out from June 20 to June 29 and Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will conduct house-to-house visits from June 30 to July 29. The rationalisation of polling stations is scheduled to be completed by July 29. The draft electoral roll will be published on August 5, following which claims and objections can be filed between August 5 and September 4. The notice phase and disposal of claims and objections will continue from August 5 to October 3, and the final electoral roll will be published on October 7, it said. According to the statement issued by the CEO office, 59,050 BLOs will be involved in the SIR of electoral roll in the state. The SIR will cover approximately 5,55,74,064 electors in the state as of May 12. The SIR is a participative and transparent exercise involving electors, political parties and the election machinery. During the revision process, BLOs will undertake house-to-house visits for the distribution and collection of enumeration forms, the statement said. Stating that there are currently 25,284 Booth Level Agents (BLAs) appointed by recognised political parties, the CEO urged all

112. Who Is Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar? All You Need To Know As Kalyan Banerjee Replaces Her As TMC Chief Whip in Lok Sabha | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/india/news/who-is-kakoli-ghosh-dastidar-all-you-need-to-know-as-kalyan-banerjee-replaces-her-as-tmc-chief-whip-in-lok-sabha-7431534.html>

■ **Summary:**

Mamata Banerjee has reinstated Kalyan Banerjee as the Chief Whip of the All India

Trinamool Congress (TMC) in the Lok Sabha, replacing Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar in a significant organisational reshuffle that signals shifting loyalties within the party during one of its most challenging political phases. Mamata Banerjee has reinstated Kalyan Banerjee as the Chief Whip of the All India Trinamool Congress (TMC) in the Lok Sabha, replacing Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar in a significant organisational reshuffle that signals shifting loyalties within the party during one of its most challenging political phases. The announcement was made at Mamata Banerjee's residence in Kalighat during a meeting attended by all TMC Members of Parliament. The session served as a strategic regrouping exercise - combining performance assessment, morale boosting, and clear political messaging following the party's difficult electoral contest that ended its long uninterrupted tenure in power. Sujit Bose Arrested: ED Captured Former TMC Minister After 11-Hour Interrogation in Kolkata. Kalyan Banerjee had previously been removed from the chief whip position reportedly after a public disagreement with Krishnanagar MP Mahua Moitra. His reinstatement at a time when TMC is navigating significant political headwinds underscores his enduring importance within the party's inner circle. Abhishek Banerjee was retained as the party's Lok Sabha leader, while Shatabdi Roy continued as deputy leader. While no official reason was

113. "LDF will not boycott... as UDF did": MV Govindan on Keralam CM-designate VD Satheesan's oath-taking ceremony

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Asian News International (ANI)

■ **URL:** <https://www.aninews.in/news/national/politics/ldf-will-not-boycott-as-udf-did-mv-govindan-on-keralam-cm-designate-vd-satheesans-oath-taking-ceremony20260515170133/>

■ **Summary:**

Kannur (Keralam) [India], May 15 (ANI): Keralam Communist Party of India (Marxist)

State Secretary MV Govindan on Friday said the Left Democratic Front (LDF) will not boycott the swearing-in ceremony of Chief Minister-designate VD Satheesan, adding that the alliance would function as a constructive opposition. He said the party leadership had held detailed discussions on the recent election defeat, terming the outcome a major setback for the LDF and acknowledging that multiple factors contributed to the loss. A day earlier, Congress officially named Satheesan as the next Chief Minister of Keralam following the UDF's sweeping victory in the 2026 Assembly elections. Satheesan is scheduled to take oath as Chief Minister on May 18 at 10 am at Lok Bhavan. Speaking to the reporters in Kannur, Govindan said, "The LDF would not boycott the swearing-in ceremony as the UDF had done earlier and would instead function as a constructive opposition. The party leadership had discussed the election defeat in detail." "The discussions held at the state leadership level are not yet complete, and the matter would be further examined across all party units," he said. The Congress-led UDF secured a decisive mandate in the 140-member Keralam Assembly, winning 102 seats and ending the Left Democratic Front (LDF)'s decade-long rule in the state. Satheesan, who represented the Paravur constituency, secured his sixth consecutive Assembly victory in the 2026 polls, securing 78,658 votes and defeating C

114. Ballot Papers To Be Used In Punjab Local Polls, BJP Demands EVMs

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** NDTV

■ **URL:** <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/ballot-papers-to-be-used-in-punjab-local-polls-bjp-demands-evms-11500175>

■ **Summary:**

A sufficient number of EVMs are currently unavailable, said the Election Commission. ShowQuick Read Summary is AI-generated, newsroom-reviewed * Municipal

elections in Punjab will use ballot papers, not Electronic Voting Machines * Punjab BJP has demanded EVMs, alleging AAP fears defeat and wants to manipulate results * AAP has claimed the BJP lacks candidates and accused it of diverting public attention from issues Did our AI summary help? Let us know. Switch To Beeps Mode Chandigarh: With the announcement of municipal elections in Punjab, an intense political debate has kicked off over the planned use of ballot papers. The Punjab unit of the Election Commission has stated that the municipal corporation elections will be conducted using ballot papers, not Electronic Voting Machines, prompting the Bharatiya Janata Party to protest immediately. Punjab BJP President Sunil Jakhar-led delegation met with the State Election Commissioner and demanded that the elections be conducted using EVMs, as has been the practice in the past. The leader alleged the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government is implementing the ballot paper system out of fear of a potential defeat, with the intention of manipulating the vote count during the tabulation process. He further stated that this decision was taken without consulting any political parties. The ruling AAP claimed the BJP isn't able to find candidates for the upcoming polls. Punjab's Finance Minister Harpal Singh Cheema said in a statement that th

115. Marathi Co-Official Language Demand Reopens Goa Faultlines

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Frontline

■ **URL:** <https://frontline.thehindu.com/politics/goa-marathi-language-demand-polarisation/article70982437.ece>

■ **Summary:**

As elections get closer in Goa, political forces are sharpening their swords over caste, religion, and language. No matter the size or nature of the target community, the politics around an old or new purported grievance tends to succeed in polarisation.

That formula is now being applied again in India's small western coastal State. The demand to make Marathi a co-official language of the State government is dividing Goans, and all of it is aimed at the 2027 assembly elections. Subhash Velingkar, former Goa chief of the RSS who was dropped from the organisation in 2016, has kicked off the controversy this time. He has addressed multiple rallies in Ponda, Dicholim, and other locations under the banner of the Marathi Rajbhasha Nirdhar Samiti, demanding that Marathi be made a co-official language alongside Konkani. "For years, the Goan government has done injustice to Marathi and to people who speak Marathi. The government must announce it as co-official language. It will respect the indigenous culture of the Goan people," he said at his rallies. He has also threatened the Goan government that "the Marathi vote bank will be created through this protest and the BJP will have to face the consequences." The Goa Assembly election is scheduled for early 2027. The BJP has been ruling the State since 2012 and anti-incumbency is now considerable. On that backdrop, Velingkar raising the Marathi issue -- with explicit political implications -- has expectedly stirred things up. Velingkar's

116. SIR, farmers issues discussed in J'khand BJP office-bearers' meeting

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/sir-farmers-issues-discussed-in-jkhand-bjp-office-bearers-meeting/2932299/>

■ **Summary:**

The meeting was chaired by state BJP president Aditya Sahu and attended by the leader of opposition in the Jharkhand assembly Babulal Marandi among other senior leaders. "We know that the SIR exercise is set to begin in Jharkhand. We held a detailed discussion regarding it. The Election Commission has urged all political

parties to verify the names and photographs of their respective parties' booth-level agents (BLAs) and submit them to the district election office. The BJP has already completed this job," BJP state general secretary Ganesh Mishra said at a press conference here. The EC on Thursday announced the rollout of SIR in 16 states, including Jharkhand, and three Union territories in a phased manner beginning May 30. Nearly 2.64 crore voters of the state would be covered under the exercise through door-to-door verification from June 30, officials said. The final electoral rolls will be published on October 7. Mishra said, "We must carry out this (SIR) work properly because we know that the voter lists prepared here contain many names that are either not Indian citizens, or even if they are citizens, they do not actually reside in the state. Many of the names included in the list belong to deceased persons or people who are not present at all." "It is very important to remove or correct all such names through this SIR so that the upcoming elections are held with only genuine and pure voters," he said. The state BJP leader said they received information that a five-day

117. TMC slams fuel price hike; alleges 'vote loot', economic mismanagement by Centre

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/tmc-slams-fuel-price-hike-alleges-vote-loot-economic-mismanagement-by-centre/2932298/>

■ **Summary:**

"After looting the votes, you are now looting the purse of the ordinary citizen," Ghose said, describing the BJP-led government as a "dhokhebaaz (betrayal) government". She said cooking gas prices had already increased and the hike in petrol and diesel prices would further hurt common people and livelihoods. She also said the government failed to adequately prepare for fuel shortages and continued focusing on "event management" instead of addressing the crisis. "The bubble of Modi-nomics

has burst and the Modi government has cheated the people," she said. Ghose also raised concerns over India's economic indicators, claiming that the rupee had emerged as one of the worst-performing currencies among major economies in 2025 and 2026. She alleged that foreign institutional investors (FIIs) were "leaving India in droves" and claimed that net FII outflows in the current calendar year had reached USD 21 billion. She referred to the Economic Survey, saying it had flagged concerns over the falling value of the rupee and capital outflows. "India has been in a negative balance of payments situation for the last two years. This is the all-round failure of Modinomics," she said. The TMC leader also targeted the Centre over the cancellation of the NEET-UG 2026 examination amid allegations of paper leaks. She claimed there had been "70 to 90 major exam leaks since 2014" and questioned the functioning of the National Testing Agency (NTA). Ghose said she had written to Union Education Ministe

118. West Bengal CM Suvendu Adhikari resigns from Nandigram Assembly constituency, retains Bhabanipur

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** KalingaTV

■ **URL:** <https://kalingatv.com/nation/west-bengal-cm-suvendu-adhikari-resigns-from-nandigram-assembly-constituency-retains-bhabanipur/>

■ Summary:

Kolkata: West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Wednesday resigned from the Nandigram Assembly constituency, retaining the Bhabanipur seat from where he defeated Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee by a margin of 15,105 votes. In accordance with the rules, which mandate that a resignation be submitted within 14 days, Suvendu Adhikari tendered his resignation to the new Speaker of the West Bengal Legislative Assembly, Rathindra Bose. Suvendu Adhikari contested the West Bengal election from Nandigram and Bhabanipur. Adhikari registered a comfortable

victory in Nandigram, his home turf, defeating TMC's Pabitra Kar by a margin of 9,665 votes. He also challenged Mamata Banerjee at Bhabanipur and secured victory by 15,105 votes, a major factor behind his selection as West Bengal Chief Minister. Nandigram Assembly constituency will now go to bye-elections. The 2026 Assembly election results marked a decisive mandate for the BJP, registering a significant surge, winning 207 seats in the 294-member Assembly, a major shift in a state where it had earlier secured 77 seats in the previous election. The Trinamool Congress (TMC), which had won 212 seats in the last Assembly polls, finished a distant second with 80 seats. Calling it the beginning of a new chapter for the state, Adhikari, who was sworn in as the Chief Minister, said the "Sonar Bangla" era had officially begun after the BJP's sweeping victory in the 2026 West Bengal Assembly elections. Promptly after taking charg

119. Mayawati slams Akhilesh Yadav over Samajwadi Party spokesperson's 'anti-Brahmin remark'

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/uttar-pradesh/mayawati-slams-akhil-esh-yadav-over-samajwadi-party-spokespersons-anti-brahmin-remark/article70982519.ece>

■ **Summary:**

Bahujan Samaj Party chief Mayawati on Friday (May 15, 2026) questioned the Samajwadi Party (SP) chief Akhilesh Yadav's silence regarding the alleged objectionable remarks made against Brahmins by an SP spokesperson Rajkumar Bhati. She said the leadership silence is causing the matter to escalate and assume greater gravity. In a post on X in Hindi, Ms. Mayawati said, "The widespread outrage and vehement condemnation regarding the indecent, unseemly, and objectionable remarks directed at the Brahmin community made by a prominent national

spokesperson of the Samajwadi Party, are entirely natural. However, the silence of the SP leadership known for engaging in narrow, caste-based politics on this matter, is further exacerbating and significantly escalating the situation. The situation is also becoming increasingly tense." The BSP chief said, "Taking a serious note of the hurt inflicted upon the honour and self-respect of the Brahmin community by the irresponsible statement of the SP spokesperson, it would likely be appropriate for the SP chief to take immediate cognisance of the matter, offer an apology and express remorse to the Brahmin community." She said this recent episode has demonstrated to the public that the SP's casteist tactics and character -- hostile towards the Brahmin community, just as they are towards Dalits, the Most Backward Classes, and the Muslim community -- have not changed. "In fact, this attitude has only deepened. Moreover, the intense resentment current

120. Tell your 'petty politicians' not to blame the court for delay, CJI tells Thackeray-Shinde factions

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/tell-your-petty-politicians-not-to-blame-the-court-for-the-delay-cji-tells-thackeray-shinde-factions/article70982717.ece>

■ Summary:

The Supreme Court on Friday (May 15, 2026) turned livid at the "petty politicians" of warring Uddhav Thackeray and Eknath Shinde factions of Shiv Sena for accusing the court of delaying a final decision on their dispute over the party symbol 'bow and arrow' while seeking adjournments every time the case came up for hearing. "Stop your people from going to the media and making statements that the Supreme Court is not hearing... Why are these petty politicians making these statements?" Chief Justice of India Surya Kant lashed out when the parties sought an adjournment. Chief Justice Kant said he was not one who would put up with the slandering of the court by

politicians in the media. "You people seek a date every time the case comes up and then you go to the media and complain," the judge addressed the lawyers in the case. Shinde wanted Uddhav-Raj rapprochement before Shiv Sena split, claims RautIrresponsible: Rohatgi Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi, for the Shinde faction, agreed that such statements, if made, were "wholly irresponsible". Senior advocate Devadatt Kamat, for the Thackeray camp, said the case has been in court for almost three years now, and there was a lot of anxiety involved about the future, though he added that as a lawyer he condemned disparaging comments made in the media. "We know the pressure on the court. We are completely with Your Lordships on this... No litigant can say such things," Mr. Rohatgi said. Mr. Kamat said the court could spare two hours for

121. North Bengal Shows The Way Of Hindu Revival In Bengal

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Republic World

■ **URL:** <https://www.republicworld.com/opinion/north-bengal-shows-the-way-of-hindu-revival-in-bengal-2026-05-15-124368>

■ **Summary:**

The victory of BJP over TMC in the recently concluded assembly election in West Bengal is not only a triumph of Hindutva; it's also a victory of good over evil. This win is not only a victory for BJP, this is a conquest over the existential threat of all the Bengali Hindus living in West Bengal. Had TMC won this election, Bengali Hindus would have been eliminated from West Bengal. Through the victory of the BJP, the Hindus have saved themselves from Islamisation like what we witnessed in Bangladesh. They have also thwarted the idea of the Bangladeshi jihadis to convert West Bengal into West Bangladesh, or a part of Greater Bangladesh. North Bengal, the northern parts of West Bengal consisting of eight districts, namely Cooch Behar, Alipurduar, Jalpaiguri, Darjeeling, Kalimpong, North Dinajpur, South Dinajpur and Malda, has led the Hindu uprising in Bengal in the recently-concluded 2026 West Bengal Assembly elections winning 40 seats out of a total 54 assembly seats. This is not the first time that North Bengal has seen the Hindu revolution. In fact, Hindu revival in West Bengal started from North Bengal only. In the 2019 Lok Sabha elections, the BJP bagged seven of out of eight seats from North Bengal out of the 19 total seats the BJP secured in the state. In 2021 assembly elections, people of North Bengal remained with the BJP despite a dismal show in the state. Before the 2019 general elections BJP had never been a force to reckon with in West Bengal. Their party got only 3

122. Krishnaiah urges Telangana CM to fulfil promise of filling two lakh jobs

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <http://www.uniindia.com/krishnaiah-urges-telangana-cm-to-fulfil-promise-of-filling-two-lakh-jobs/south/news/3844121.html>

■ **Summary:**

Hyderabad, May 15 (UNI) Rajya Sabha member and National BC Welfare Association president R Krishnaiah has urged Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy to fulfil the Congress party's election promise of filling two lakh government jobs in Telangana. In a letter addressed to the Chief Minister, Krishnaiah said unemployment was one of the key reasons behind the Congress party's victory in the state and alleged that the previous BRS government lost power due to neglect of unemployed youth. He said the Congress leadership, including Revanth Reddy and Rahul Gandhi, had extensively campaigned on promises of filling vacant posts. Krishnaiah claimed that since coming to power, the government had filled only 69,000 jobs while a large number of vacancies still remained across departments. He pointed out that around 18,000 vacancies in the Police Department and nearly 30,000 posts in the Education Department, including government and Gurukul schools, were yet to be filled. He also expressed concern over vacancies in universities, stating that nearly 80 per cent of professor and lecturer posts remained vacant, affecting academic standards and research activities. The BC leader further said there was a need to fill 1,600 Group-I posts, 3,000 Group-II posts, and around 20,000 Group-III and Group-IV posts. He urged the government to sanction posts in newly created districts, mandals, municipalities, and other administrative units, stating that this could create nearly one lakh additional jobs. Krish

123. Ram Madhav writes: Is multipolarity dead in the age of Trump and Xi?

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/opinion/columns/is-multipolarity-dead-in-the-age-of-trump-and-xi-10691235/>

■ **Summary:**

The hype surrounding US President Donald Trump's visit to Beijing and the broad outcomes indicate that the politics of big power hyphenation is back. After the collapse of the communist regime in the Soviet Union in 1991, some strategic thinkers in the US dreamt of single-power dominance. Francis Fukuyama, the Stanford political scientist, called it the "end of history" and predicted that the American way of liberal democracy would be the only way forward for the world. His own guru, Samuel Huntington, a renowned Harvard professor, challenged the thesis through his famous book *The Clash of Civilisations* two years later in 1993, in which he predicted a civilisational conflict involving various regions that would challenge the US supremacy. Huntington was not far off the mark. Soon, the US ran into trouble with Islamic terrorists, culminating in the World Trade Centre attack in New York in 2001. Advertisement Also Read | Trump wants to dominate global energy. The hurdle: China The early 21st century also saw several middle powers and some minilateral groupings emerging as important players in the world. The phrase "multipolarity" came into vogue, indicating that the world was no longer "unipolar" and under US hegemony. Many believed that a multipolar set up, where regionalism and localism play a dominant role, will be a good model for international governance. Sceptics and American apologists, who saw any talk of multipolarity as a rejection of America's superpower status, dismissed

124. From domestic help to MLA: Starting new job, Kalita Maji says she knows pain of poor

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/cities/kolkata/kalita-maji-mla-west-bengal-ausgram-bjp-mla-domestic-help-inspiring-10691234/>

■ **Summary:**

Kalita Maji, the newly elected MLA from West Bengal's Ausgram, must get used to a different schedule. The 38-year-old, who worked as a domestic help before the polls, is set to start work as an elected public representative. "Now it is time to serve the people, all the people (in my constituency). So I will not be able to continue serving the few homes where I worked as a help. But they are close to me, and I will stay in touch with them. But now there is greater responsibility on my shoulders. I have to bring development to my constituency," Maji told The Indian Express over the phone. "I belong to a poor family. So I know the pain of the poor and their needs. People have blessed me, and I will work for them," she said. Platipal Patra lives in the Guskara municipality of Purba Bardhaman district and is among Maji's former employers. "We are happy and proud of her. She worked at my home for nearly a decade. We have big expectations of her. Obviously, she is an MLA and won't come to our house daily. We will miss her. But I think she will work for the people," Patra said. Chandrachur Patra is a relative of Platipal and a local resident. "We all know her and love her. In 2021, she contested as a BJP candidate and lost. But this time she has won. Since 2010, she has been working as a house help, cooking and washing utensils. Everyone loves her. Now she is our MLA, and we have high hopes. She is from an underprivileged background and will understand the needs of the poor." Maji's

125. Neo-Dravidianism and the 2026 Tamil Nadu electoral realignment

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/op-ed/neo-dravidianism-and-the-2026-tamil-nadu-electoral-realignment/article70982552.ece>

■ **Summary:**

The 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly election and the results may be interpreted as a significant electoral and institutional realignment within the State's long-standing Dravidian political framework. The emergence of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) as the single largest party reflects a measurable disruption in the bipolar political structure historically dominated by the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) and the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK). Beyond electoral arithmetic, the development indicates the rise of a new political and governance discourse tentatively identifiable as 'Neo-Dravidianism'. This framework attempts to combine the social justice foundations of the classical Dravidian movement with contemporary themes such as digital political mobilisation, inclusive secularism, welfare modernisation, and governance-driven federalism. The post-poll support extended to the TVK by parties across ideological lines -- including the Congress, the Viduthala Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK), the Left parties, and the Indian Union Muslim League -- suggests that the electoral outcome is being interpreted within broader constitutional and governance considerations rather than conventional coalition politics alone. Historical and ideological context The origins of the Dravidian movement are deeply connected to the social reform movements of the early 20th century. Periyar E.V. Ramasamy's Self-Respect Movement challenged caste hierarchy, social exclusion, and religious orthodoxy.

126. Will unite for state's important matters: Kerala CM-designate Satheesan

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Asianet News Network Pvt Ltd

■ **URL:** <https://newsable.asianetnews.com/india/will-unite-for-states-important-matters-kerala-cm-designate-satheesan-articleshow-x5rgvno>

■ **Summary:**

Kerala CM-designate VD Satheesan met outgoing CM Pinarayi Vijayan, vowing cooperation on state matters and assuring continuity of development projects. Satheesan, who led the UDF to victory, called Vijayan the most senior leader in Kerala politics. Kerala Chief Minister Designate VD Satheesan on Friday described outgoing Chief Minister and Leader of Opposition in the Assembly Pinarayi Vijayan as one of the most senior figures in Kerala politics and emphasised the need for cooperation beyond political differences. After meeting Vijayan at his residence in Thiruvananthapuram, Satheesan told reporters, "Pinarayi Vijayan is the most senior leader in Kerala politics. We may not be able to stand together on every issue, but we should be able to unite for matters that are important to the state. I hope that will be possible. The ongoing development projects will not be changed." Add Asianet Newsable as a Preferred Source He also stressed continuity in governance and ongoing development projects, stating that initiatives launched by previous governments would not be discontinued. "They are a continuation of previous governments. If one government scraps what another government introduced, how can Kerala progress? Pinarayi Vijayan has been invited to the swearing-in ceremony," he said. UDF's Sweeping Victory in 2026 Polls A day earlier, Congress officially named Satheesan as the next Chief Minister of Kerala following the UDF's sweeping victory in the 2026 Assembly elections. Sat

127. Bengal former food minister Rathin Ghosh appears before ED in civic recruitment scam case

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Telegraph

■ **URL:** <https://www.telegraphindia.com/west-bengal/bengal-former-food-minister-rathin-ghosh-appears-before-ed-in-civic-recruitment-scam-case/cid/2160695>

■ **Summary:**

Rathin Ghosh during campaign before Bengal assembly election in Khamarpara Anchal in Madhyamgram. X/@Rathingoshtmc Former West Bengal food minister Rathin Ghosh on Friday appeared before the ED in connection with the alleged civic recruitment scam case after skipping summons on five earlier occasions. The Trinamool Congress leader reached the ED office at the CGO Complex in Salt Lake around 10 am. "I do not know why I have been called. I will know once I go inside," he told reporters before entering the office. During the election period, the central agency had summoned him five times, but he did not appear, citing political engagements and campaign-related commitments. ED officials are expected to question him in connection with the ongoing probe into allegations of recruitment in civic bodies in exchange for money. Around 1,500 people were illegally recruited by different civic bodies in the state, according to the central agency. Rathin Ghosh had won the Madhyamgram assembly constituency for the TMC in the recently concluded Bengal Assembly elections with a margin of 2,399 votes against BJP candidate Anindya Banerjee. The development comes days after former fire services minister and Trinamool heavyweight Sujit Bose was arrested by the ED in the same case following prolonged questioning. Bose had also received multiple ED summonses from April 6 onwards, including during the Assembly election period. He had approached the Calcutta High Court seeking time, citing his involv

128. 'Compromised PM struck Adani release bargain': Opposition on report about US dropping fraud charges

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Scroll.in

■ **URL:** <https://scroll.in/latest/1092884/compromised-pm-struck-adani-release-bargain-opposition-on-report-about-us-dropping-fraud-charges>

■ **Summary:**

Opposition leaders on Friday questioned whether the Narendra Modi government has entered into a quid pro quo arrangement, under which the United States Department of Justice is reportedly planning to drop charges against Adani Group chairperson Gautam Adani. The New York Times reported on Thursday that the decision to drop the charges came after Gautam Adani hired a legal team led by Robert J Giuffra Jr, one of US President Donald Trump's personal lawyers. Commenting on the report, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi said on social media: "The compromised PM has not struck a trade deal, but a bargain for Adani's release." In a similar vein, Rashtriya Janata Dal MP Manoj Kumar Jha was quoted as saying by PTI: "...Whether you call it quid pro quo or something else, it now seems clear why we were demanding clarity on the trade deal." Jha said the Opposition had earlier pointed out that India's trade deal with the US "was unfair, lacked balance, and ignored India's interests". "Looking at the other side as well, the picture is now quite clear to me about what the reality behind the scenes was," said the MP. India and the US agreed on a framework for the interim trade deal on February 2. While the agreement has reduced US tariffs on Indian goods to 18% from 50%, Opposition parties have expressed concerns that the interests of farmers and small and medium enterprises may be jeopardised through the agreement. An Indian delegation had travelled to the United States in April for meetings with

129. RG Kar Rape-Murder Case: CM Suwendu Adhikari Suspends Ex-Top Cop Vineet Goyal, 2 IPS Officers Over 'Bribe Offer' To Victim's Kin; 23 Phones, SIMs Seized From Presidency Jail

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Republic World

■ **URL:** <https://www.republicworld.com/india/rg-kar-case-suvendu-adhikari-suspends-ex-kolkata-cp-vineet-goyal-2-ips-officers-over-bribe-offer-mishandling-allegations-23-phones-sims-seized-from-presidency-jail-2026-05-15-124369>

■ **Summary:**

RG Kar Case: West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Thursday announced the suspension of three senior IPS officers over alleged mishandling of the high-profile RG Kar rape-murder case that had triggered nationwide outrage. The suspended officers are former Kolkata Police Commissioner Vineet Goyal, former DCP Central Indira Mukherjee and former DCP North Abhishek Gupta. Addressing the media, Adhikari said the state government would initiate a departmental inquiry against the officers and examine whether there were procedural lapses, misconduct, abuse of authority, or attempts to influence the victim's family during the investigation. "The protectors themselves had become predators. There was a nexus, and a crackdown is underway against it," Adhikari said while announcing the action. According to the Chief Minister, the government received information from the victim's mother as well as media reports alleging that police officers had attempted to offer money to the victim's family during the investigation phase. Adhikari said these allegations would now be formally investigated. "We are examining whether the police did what they were supposed to do at that time. We received information from the victim's mother and from the media that two police officers had allegedly tried to offer money. These are matters for investigation," he said. He clarified that the departmental probe would not interfere with the ongoing CBI investigation into the rape and murder itself, but woul

130. UK government faces weeks of uncertainty over the prime minister's future

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Times of India

■ **URL:** <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/world/uk/uk-government-faces-weeks-of-uncertainty-over-the-prime-ministers-future/articleshow/131113945.cms>

■ **Summary:**

LONDON - The British government faces weeks of uncertainty as embattled Prime Minister Keir Starmer prepares for a leadership challenge from the popular mayor of Greater Manchester, Andy Burnham, who can't formally launch his bid until he finds a way back into Parliament. Burnham's path to Westminster is far from certain. He will first have to overcome a strong challenge from the anti-immigrant Reform UK party in a special election for the parliamentary seat that was vacated to make way for him. British government borrowing costs rose Friday and the pound weakened on investor concern about continued disarray at the heart of government. The pound has dropped 1.4% against the U.S dollar this week. Weeks of speculation about Starmer's future broke into open rebellion within the governing Labour Party on Thursday as Burnham declared his intention to seek the top job and two other senior members positioned themselves for their own bids. The pressure to replace Starmer increased after Labour posted disastrous results in last week's local elections, losing votes to Reform UK on the right and the Green Party on the left. Housing Secretary Steve Reed on Friday appealed to party members to step back from the brink of a divisive leadership contest that he said would prevent the government from tackling issues like the cost of living crisis and bolster the prospects of Reform UK. "This weekend people just need to take a breath, look at what's gone wrong this week, and come back next week ready

131. "We must unite for State's interest": Keralam CM-designate VD Satheesan after meeting Pinarayi Vijayan

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Asian News International (ANI)

■ **URL:** <https://www.aninews.in/news/national/general-news/we-must-unite-for-states-interest-keralam-cm-designate-vd-satheesan-after-meeting-pinarayi-vijayan20260515161015/>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram (Keralam) [India], May 15 (ANI): Keralam Chief Minister Designate VD Satheesan on Friday described outgoing Chief Minister and Leader of Opposition in the Assembly Pinarayi Vijayan as one of the most senior figures in Keralam politics and emphasised the need for cooperation beyond political differences. After meeting Vijayan at his residence in Thiruvananthapuram, Satheesan told reporters, "Pinarayi Vijayan is the most senior leader in Keralam politics. We may not be able to stand together on every issue, but we should be able to unite for matters that are important to the state. I hope that will be possible. The ongoing development projects will not be changed." He also stressed continuity in governance and ongoing development projects, stating that initiatives launched by previous governments would not be discontinued. "They are a continuation of previous governments. If one government scraps what another government introduced, how can Keralam progress? Pinarayi Vijayan has been invited to the swearing-in ceremony," he said. A day earlier, Congress officially named Satheesan as the next Chief Minister of Keralam following the UDF's sweeping victory in the 2026 Assembly elections. Satheesan is scheduled to take oath as Chief Minister on May 18 at Lok Bhavan. The Congress-led UDF secured a decisive mandate in the 140-member Keralam Assembly, winning 102 seats and ending the Left Democratic Front (LDF)'s decade-long rule in the state. Satheesan, who represen

132. Bengal govt to launch probe against former top cop of Kolkata Police, two others for 'lapses' in RG Kar case- [Moneycontrol.com](https://www.moneycontrol.com)

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** MoneyControl

■ **URL:** <https://www.moneycontrol.com/news/india/bengal-govt-to-launch-probe-against-former-top-cop-of-kolkata-police-two-others-for-lapses-in-rg-kar-case-13920477.html>

■ **Summary:**

Victim's mother Ratna Debnath won Panihati seat on BJP ticket West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari said the government has suspended three police officers for 'lapses' in the investigation of the RG Kar rape and murder case and will start a departmental probe against them. Addressing reporters on Friday, Adhikari said, "The Bengal government has suspended three police officers for 'lapses' in investigation in RG Kar rape-murder case. The government will start a departmental probe against ex-Kolkata Commissioner of Police Vineet Goyal and two other officers." Adhikari said the three officers were allegedly involved in the "mishandling" of the case, "offering money to the victim's parents as bribe" and addressing an "unauthorised press conference" in connection with the gruesome crime. The newly sworn in BJP Chief Minister said disciplinary proceedings and departmental inquiry would be spearheaded by the state home secretary under the guidance of the chief secretary. In August 2024, a 31-year-old postgraduate trainee doctor at R. G. Kar Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata was found dead inside the hospital campus after reportedly being sexually assaulted and strangled. Investigation later revealed that the medic was raped and murdered by a civic volunteer named Sanjay Roy. The brutality of the crime sparked nationwide outrage, protests by doctors, and major public debate about women's safety and workplace security in hospitals. At the time of the incident, Vineet Goy

133. World News | Will Not Rush Expansion of BRICS: Russian FM Lavrov, Says Need to Streamline Forum's Work | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/world-news-will-not-rush-expansion-of-brics-russian-fm-lavrov-says-need-to-streamline-forums-work-7431466.html>

■ **Summary:**

Get latest articles and stories on World at LatestLY. Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov on Friday said BRICS will not rush further expansion at the current stage, stressing the need to streamline the grouping's work following its recent enlargement. New Delhi [India], May 15 (ANI): Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov on Friday said BRICS will not rush further expansion at the current stage, stressing the need to streamline the grouping's work following its recent enlargement. Speaking at a press conference in India after the BRICS Foreign Affairs Meeting, Lavrov said there continues to be strong international interest in joining the bloc, which he described as "a model of the future multipolar world order". Also Read | Maldives Cave Diving Tragedy: 5 Italian Tourists Dead, Police Launch Investigation. "Some countries show interest, and there is also an understanding that BRICS is a model of the future multipolar world order," Lavrov said. He emphasised that BRICS was not aimed at isolating any part of the international community and instead sought inclusive dialogue between countries. Also Read | PM Narendra Modi Reaffirmed He Will Visit Russia This Year: Russian FM Sergey Lavrov, Says 'Open to Everything' Indian Partners Are Interested In. "No one is trying to shut us off from the global minority, from the rest of the world," he said, adding that BRICS seeks "business-like fair conversations" focused on balancing the interests of both the "global majority and global

134. Former Kolkata CP Vineet Goyal suspended along with 2 other IPS officers in Bengal for lapses in RG Kar doctor rape and murder probe

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <https://www.uniindia.com/~former-kolkata-cp-vineet-goyal-suspended-along-with-2-other-ips-officers-in-bengal-for-lapses-in-rg-kar-doctor-rape-and-murder-probe/States/news/3844052.html>

■ **Summary:**

Kolkata, May 15 (UNI) West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Friday suspended Vineet Goyal, the former commissioner of Kolkata Police, and two more IPS officers, including Indira Mukherjee and Abhishek Gupta, for alleged lapses in the RG Kar rape and murder. Goyal was the police commissioner in Kolkata when a 31-year-old postgraduate trainee was raped and murdered inside the RG Kar Medical College and Hospital on August 9, 2024. Mukherjee was then posted as the deputy commissioner central, and Gupta held the position of the deputy commissioner north. Adhikari said that these officers were suspended and a departmental enquiry will follow as "they were involved in offering a financial bribe to the family members of the victim and at least one officer held a press conference without any written order from the Kolkata Police or the home department." The rape and murder inside a state-run hospital had triggered widespread protests across the globe. In Kolkata, residents from all walks of life joined in street protests and night long vigils. A civic police volunteer, Sanjay Roy, 33, was arrested in connection with the case by the Kolkata Police before the case was handed over to the CBI. Announcing the decision, Chief Minister Adhikari said the action followed a review of the Kolkata police response to the incident, which he described as having been "seriously mishandled". Adhikari stated that, as he holds the portfolio of the home ministry, he had formed a fact finding co

135. With Haryana civic poll sweep, BJP tightens urban grip, deals another blow to Cong, Hooda

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/political-pulse/haryana-civic-poll-sweep-bjp-urban-blow-to-cong-hooda-10691183/>

■ **Summary:**

The 2024 Haryana Assembly elections had underlined how close the contest was, with the incumbent BJP edging past the principal Opposition Congress by just 0.85 percentage points in vote share and securing 48 seats against the latter's 37 in the 90-member House. The recent municipal polls seem to have reinforced the BJP's grip on the state's urban electorate. The results of the urban local body elections, declared on May 13, saw the BJP winning not only the three municipal corporations - in Panchkula, Ambala, and Sonipat - but also three smaller municipalities, leaving only Uklana where the Congress and Indian National Lok Dal (INLD)-backed independent Reema Soni defeated the BJP's candidate for the post of the civic body's president. Advertisement The margins in the mayoral contests were striking, ranging from 21,000 to 36,000 votes, and the BJP's dominance extended to the ward level as well, winning 17 seats in Panchkula, 16 in Ambala, and 17 in Sonipat, where the Congress was reduced to 1, 3, and 5, respectively. The INLD, led by Abhay Singh Chautala, and the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) fielded candidates but failed to secure any wins. The sweep in urban areas positions the BJP favourably for consolidating its rural support. "With development as their priority, the people of the state have chosen to establish a 'triple-engine government' in the urban local bodies," said Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini. The BJP now controls all 11 municipal corporations in Haryana, a symbolic and

136. Orban's media empire crumbles after Hungary election defeat - CNBC TV18

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** cnbctv18.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.cnbctv18.com/world/orbans-media-empire-crumbles-after-hungary-election-defeat-19906890.htm>

■ **Summary:**

The media empire built by former Hungarian Prime Minister Viktor Orban's government, a key pillar of the nationalist leader's 16 years in power, is swiftly unravelling following an election last month that abruptly ended his rule. Within weeks of the vote, which the centre-right opposition led by Peter Magyar won with a landslide, senior figures at some of the most prominent pro-Orban outlets have been pushed out and a flagship news programme was scrapped. The tone of public service media changed overnight, with more opposition voices appearing even before Magyar formally took power, while pro-Orban influencers have practically disappeared from social media. These are the first cracks in Orban's tightly controlled media system that is set to undergo a shake-up under the new government, sworn in earlier this week. Magyar, who called public service media a "factory of lies", has pledged to restore press freedom, create a new media law and a new media authority.

BRUSSELS WATCHING PROGRESS ON REFORM Veteran nationalist Orban was celebrated by conservatives in Europe and the U.S. as the mastermind of an "illiberal democracy", but voters grew weary of allegations of corruption and economic stagnation. In the April 12 election, Magyar's centre-right Tisza party ended Orban's 16-year rule and gained a two-thirds majority in parliament needed to undo Orban's constitutional overhaul. Leaders of the European Union are closely watching Hungary as a test case for restoring democratic chec

137. Who Is Rathindra Bose? First MLA From North Bengal To Become Assembly Speaker

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** News18

■ **URL:** <https://www.news18.com/india/who-is-rathindra-bose-first-mla-from-north-bengal-to-become-assembly-speaker-ws-l-10092974.html>

■ **Summary:**

Tapas Roy declared Rathindra Bose elected as the Speaker of the assembly after all 207 BJP lawmakers extended their support in his favour. West Bengal Assembly Speaker: BJP MLA from Cooch Behar, Rathindra Bose, was elected unopposed as the Speaker of the 18th West Bengal Assembly on Friday. His name was proposed in the House by Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari, following which pro tem Speaker Tapas Roy conducted a voice vote. With this, Bose has become the first legislator from the northern part of the state to hold the post. Roy declared Bose elected as the Speaker of the assembly after all 207 BJP lawmakers extended their support in his favour. Who Is Rathindra Bose? Bose, a chartered accountant by profession and a longtime RSS associate before entering active politics, was elected from the Cooch Behar constituency after defeating Trinamool Congress candidate Avijit De Bhowmik by 23,284 votes, or a margin of 11.4 percentage points. Bose created history by becoming the first MLA from north Bengal to be appointed Speaker of the West Bengal Assembly in the post-Independence era. The Chief Minister on Thursday announced Bose as the BJP's candidate for the Speaker's post in the newly constituted 18th West Bengal assembly, while the opposition TMC decided not to field a nominee. Congratulating him on the appointment, Adhikari said that Bose brings valuable administrative knowledge along with organisational experience to the position. Bose's election as Speaker became a certainty t

138. Blog | The Inescapable Curse Of Being A Woman Politician In India

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** NDTV

■ **URL:** <https://www.ndtv.com/opinion/the-curse-of-being-a-woman-politician-in-india-11499829>

■ **Summary:**

I know this is not an uncommon question, but it is an uncomfortable one. And that is precisely why it refuses to go away. There is something about powerful women in Indian politics that unsettles the public imagination. The discomfort rarely announces itself openly. Instead, it reveals itself slowly, through primetime ridicule, casual sexism disguised as humour, relentless commentary on appearance and temperament, and the tendency to scrutinise a woman's personality long before her politics are taken seriously. What makes this phenomenon particularly revealing is that it transcends party lines and ideology. India does not reserve this hostility for one kind of woman politician. Eventually, almost every woman in public life encounters it, regardless of where she stands politically. Looking at a few more prominent women politicians of India, the first name that inevitably comes to our mind is that of Indira Gandhi. There are many valid criticisms of her politics, and there always will be. The Emergency alone ensures that her legacy will remain complicated forever. But if you go back and really examine the public language around Indira Gandhi over the decades, you realise people were reacting not only to her decisions but also to the sheer fact that a woman leader was occupying that seat of power. India had elected a woman Prime Minister long before many countries that now lecture the world about progressiveness. Yet, there was always an undertone of discomfort around her author

139. What is Special Intensive Revision (SIR)? Full guide for voters

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** India Today

■ **URL:** <https://www.indiatoday.in/information/story/special-intensive-revision-sir-full-guide-for-voters-2912259-2026-05-15>

■ **Summary:**

The Election Commission of India (ECI) has started a large-scale voter verification exercise called the Special Intensive Revision, or SIR. The process has already been rolled out across several states and Union Territories and is expected to cover crores of voters. While many people are hearing the term for the first time, SIR is essentially a detailed clean-up of electoral rolls. The ECI says the exercise is needed because regular yearly revisions are no longer enough to fix duplicate, outdated or incorrect voter records that have built up over the years. SIR is a detailed revision of voter lists carried out by the Election Commission when routine summary revisions are considered insufficient. Unlike regular annual updates, this process involves house-to-house verification, pre-filled forms, online submissions and fresh checks of older voter data. The Election Commission gets the authority to conduct such revisions under Article 324 of the Constitution and Section 21 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950. According to the ECI, voter lists have collected errors over the past two decades because India has not had a nationwide house-to-house intensive revision since around 2002-2004. The revision aims to identify: The Election Commission says the goal is to create cleaner and more accurate electoral rolls before upcoming elections in several states. During SIR, Booth Level Officers (BLOs) visit homes and provide pre-filled enumeration forms to voters. These forms usual

140. Odisha Voter List Shake-Up: Over 9.8 Lakh Names Removed, Door-to-Door Verification From May 30

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Pragativadi: Leading Odia Dailly

■ **URL:** <https://pragativadi.com/odisha-voter-list-shake-up-over-9-8-lakh-names-removed-door-to-door-verification-from-may-30/>

■ **Summary:**

The Odisha government has launched a major voter verification exercise ahead of the upcoming electoral roll revision, with more than 9.8 lakh names already removed from the voter list, according to the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Odisha. Officials said the state currently has around 3.34 crore registered voters, while the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise will begin formally from May 30 with Booth Level Officers (BLOs) conducting door-to-door verification across Odisha. Door-to-Door Voter Verification From May 30 As part of the SIR process, BLOs will visit households across the state between May 30 and June 28 to verify voter details and ensure the electoral rolls remain accurate and updated. The Election Department has scheduled preparation, training and printing-related work between May 20 and May 29 before the field verification process begins. Authorities said the exercise aims to identify duplicate entries, incorrect information and ineligible voters. The Chief Electoral Officer also stated that individuals who are not Indian citizens will be removed from the voter list during the verification process. Claims and Objections Window Announced Citizens will get an opportunity to raise objections or submit claims regarding voter details during a special window from July 5 to August 4. After reviewing all claims and corrections, the final voter list will be published on September 9. Election officials have urged voters to cooperate with BLOs during the verificati

141. RG Kar rape-murder: Bengal CM Adhikari suspends three IPS officers for 'mishandling' case

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** India TV News

■ **URL:** <https://www.indiatvnews.com/west-bengal/news-rg-kar-rape-murder-bengal-cm-adhikari-suspends-three-ips-officers-for-mishandling-case-2026-05-15-1041271>

■ **Summary:**

Addressing a press conference at Nabanna, CM Adhikari alleged that the officers had attempted to bribe the victim's family and held a press conference without obtaining written authorisation. West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari has suspended three IPS officers over alleged mishandling of the RG Kar Medical College rape and murder case. A departmental inquiry has also been initiated against the officers. The suspended officers are Vineet Goyal, the then Kolkata Police Commissioner; Abhishek Gupta and Indira Mukhopadhyay. Addressing a press conference at Nabanna, CM Adhikari alleged that the officers had attempted to bribe the victim's family and held a press conference without obtaining written authorisation. About brutal rape and murder case RG Kar Medical College and Hospital in Kolkata became the center of national outrage in August 2024 after a 31 year old postgraduate trainee doctor was found raped and murdered inside the hospital. The case triggered widespread protests by doctors, students, and civil society groups demanding justice, safer workplaces, and accountability from hospital authorities and the West Bengal government. Allegations of evidence tampering, delayed police action, and institutional negligence intensified public anger. The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) later took over the inquiry following court intervention. Notably, the Bharatiya Janata Party raked up the issue during the election campaign in West Bengal and the victim's mother was ev

142. India News | Quick Arrest in Pune Hospital Bomb Scare: Suspect Nabbed at Nagpur Railway Junction | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/india-news-quick-arrest-in-pune-hospital-bomb-scare-suspect-nabbed-at-nagpur-railway-junction-7431444.html>

■ **Summary:**

Pune (Maharashtra) [India], May 15 (ANI): In a swift coordinated operation, the Maharashtra Anti-Terrorism Squad (ATS) and the Pune City Police Crime Branch arrested a man on Friday for allegedly planting an Improvised Explosive Device (IED) at a private hospital in Hadapsar. The suspect, identified as Shivaji Rathore, was apprehended at the Nagpur Railway Junction while reportedly attempting to flee. Also Read | PM Narendra Modi Reaffirmed He Will Visit Russia This Year: Russian FM Sergey Lavrov, Says 'Open to Everything' Indian Partners Are Interested In. The incident unfolded on Wednesday evening when a doctor at a private medical facility in the Hadapsar area noticed a suspicious object near a washroom. The device was described as having a digital clock-like attachment, visible wiring and components, and low-grade explosives, as later confirmed by investigators. Also Read | Kerala SSLC Result 2026 Declared: Check Scores Now at sslcexam.kerala.gov.in. The hospital staff immediately alerted the police control room, triggering an emergency evacuation and a large-scale security response. The Pune City Police Bomb Detection and Disposal Squad (BDDS) arrived on the scene shortly after the discovery. To ensure public safety, the team carefully recovered the device from the hospital premises, transported it to a secure, open location and successfully defused the IED without any casualties or property damage. Following the defusal, high-ranking officials, including Pune Police Com

143. WB: Suvendu Adhikari Vacates Nandigram Seat, Retains Bhabanipur Constituency

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Free Press Journal

■ **URL:** <https://www.freepressjournal.in/india/wb-suvendu-adhikari-vacates-nandigram-seat-retains-bhabanipur-constituency>

■ **Summary:**

West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari, who won the Assembly elections from both Bhabanipur and Nandigram constituencies, has decided to vacate the Nandigram seat. He met Assembly Speaker Rathindra Bose on Friday and submitted his resignation from the constituency. Adhikari will continue as the MLA from Bhabanipur, where he defeated Chief Minister and TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee. In accordance with election rules requiring a candidate elected from two constituencies to vacate one seat within 14 days of the results, Adhikari formally resigned from the Nandigram seat. West Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari secured decisive victories in both Nandigram and Bhabanipur during the 2026 Assembly elections, defeating TMC candidates by significant margins, including Mamata Banerjee in Bhabanipur. The BJP achieved a historic mandate, winning 207 of 294 seats, while the TMC was reduced to 80 seats. Calling it the beginning of "Sonar Bangla," Adhikari announced major governance steps immediately after taking office. In the first Cabinet meeting, his government approved transferring land to the BSF for India-Bangladesh border fencing within 45 days to curb illegal infiltration.

144. BSF HQ Blast Probe Deepens as Two Key Arrests Unravel Cross-Border Module Behind Jalandhar IED Attack

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** TFIPOST

■ **URL:** <https://tfipost.com/2026/05/bsf-hq-blast-probe-deepens-as-two-key-arrests-unravel-alleged-cross-border-module-behind-jalandhar-ied-attack/>

■ **Summary:**

UP ATS Uncovers Pakistan-Linked Reconnaissance Network After Surveillance of

RSS Offices and Police Stations The investigation into the improvised explosive device (IED) blast outside the Border Security Force (BSF) Punjab Frontier headquarters in Jalandhar has intensified with the arrest of two key accused, Umar Deen and Anil Kumar, exposing what officials describe as a wider, structured conspiracy involving interstate operatives and suspected cross-border handlers. Punjab Police, in coordination with central agencies and the Delhi Police Special Cell, confirmed that the arrests are part of an expanding investigation that has now led to 17 detentions. The breakthrough follows weeks of surveillance, digital tracking, and movement analysis across Punjab, Uttar Pradesh and Delhi, with investigators tracing communication and travel patterns linked to the accused. According to senior officials, the module functioned through a division of roles. Umar Deen, a taxi driver from Zirakpur, was allegedly tasked with planting the IED outside the BSF headquarters. The device was reportedly placed inside a dustbin near the high-security perimeter and later triggered remotely using a SIM-based mechanism. Officials also suspect he received around ₹1 lakh for executing the operation. Anil Kumar, originally from Uttar Pradesh and residing in Amritsar, was allegedly assigned to record the explosion. Investigators said he travelled from Amritsar to Jalandhar specifically for this purpose. A vide

145. The Woman Behind Some Of Trump's Most Controversial Truth Social Posts: Who Is Natalie Harp?

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** News18

■ **URL:** <https://www.news18.com/world/the-woman-behind-some-of-trumps-most-controversial-truth-social-posts-who-is-natalie-harp-ws-l-10093009.html>

■ **Summary:**

The longtime Trump loyalist reportedly compiles and uploads many of the president's late-night Truth Social posts, including some that have triggered backlash. US

President Donald Trump's Truth Social account has increasingly evolved into far more than a standard presidential social media feed. It now functions simultaneously as a campaign platform, grievance board, political attack machine and official communications channel. According to a Wall Street Journal report, one woman has emerged as a central figure behind much of that activity: Natalie Harp. The 34-year-old executive assistant to Trump reportedly plays a key role in shaping and managing the president's late-night Truth Social activity, including reposts amplifying conspiracy theories, attacks on political opponents, inflammatory memes and AI-generated imagery. The scrutiny around Harp intensified after several controversial Truth Social posts drew backlash, including an AI-generated image portraying Trump as a Christ-like figure and another video containing racist imagery depicting former President Barack Obama and Michelle Obama as apes. While the White House publicly blamed an unnamed staffer for "erroneously" posting the Obama video, people familiar with the matter told WSJ that Harp was the aide who uploaded both posts at Trump's direction. All About Natalie Harp Harp first entered Trump's political orbit during his first term and gained national attention during the 2020 Republican National Convention. A bone

146. From 1951 To 2026, EC Tracks Voter Surge, Turnout In Assam, Bengal, TN, Kerala And Puducherry | Nation

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Ommcom News

■ **URL:** <https://ommcomnews.com/india-news/from-1951-to-2026-ec-tracks-voter-surge-turnout-in-assam-bengal-tn-kerala-and-puducherry/>

■ **Summary:**

New Delhi: The Election Commission of India has released detailed data charting the electoral journey of Assam, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, West Bengal and the Union Territory of Puducherry from the first general and Assembly elections after Independence to

the Assembly polls held in April and May 2026. The data highlights a sharp rise in voter strength over the decades, along with consistently high polling participation across these regions. The Election Commission of India (ECI) released the data under the theme "Chunav Ka Parv, Matdata Ka Garv", highlighting how the electorate in these four states and the Union Territory has multiplied several times over the decades, while voter turnout has remained among the highest in the country. Among all the states, West Bengal has recorded the highest latest polling percentage at 93.71 per cent in the Assembly polls, the highest since Independence. The state's electoral participation graph shows a steady climb from the early decades after Independence, when polling remained below 50 per cent in the 1950s, to consistently crossing the 75 per cent mark from the late 1970s onwards in both the Lok Sabha and Assembly polls. The number of voters in the state has surged from nearly 76 lakh in 1951 to over 6.38 crore ahead of the 2026 Assembly election. Assam has also shown a remarkable rise in electoral participation in the just-concluded Assembly elections. The latest turnout figure stands at 86.33 per cent. The voter base in the state has expande

147. Indonesia, the biggest Muslim-majority country, is on a risky path

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Hindustan Times

■ **URL:** <https://www.hindustantimes.com/world-news/indonesia-the-biggest-muslim-majority-country-is-on-a-risky-path-101778840703351.html>

■ **Summary:**

Indonesia's president, Prabowo Subianto, has seen his country explode before. It was in 1998, during the Asian financial crisis. Then, an economic collapse led to mass protests and the toppling of Mr Prabowo's father-in-law, Suharto, a notoriously corrupt dictator. It also cast Mr Prabowo, who had hoped to succeed Suharto, into the political

wilderness. It took him a quarter of a century to claw his way back, finally winning the top job in 2024. So you might think he would be extremely wary of another fiscal crisis. You would be wrong. The leader of the world's biggest Muslim-majority country has centralised power and surrounded himself with a flock of flatterers. He dumped a respected finance minister and replaced her with Purbaya Yudhi Sadewa, who has called the IMF "stupid" and who told The Economist in April that the president need not worry about "developments in the global economy [or] in the global oil price". Indonesian businessfolk are scared to speak out, perhaps because Mr Prabowo is a thin-skinned former general with a sketchy human-rights record, or perhaps because he has recently been bullying big business. Dig deeper Mr Prabowo appears to be insulating himself from reality. So he may not listen to sober advice. Nonetheless, here is some. His pet projects are unaffordable. Before the Iran war, spending a projected 10% of the budget on just two of them -- free school meals and a network of 80,000 village co-operatives -- was merely wasteful. Now, the energy crunch

148. Mayawati slams Akhilesh Yadav over SP spokesperson's 'anti-Brahmin remark'

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/mayawati-slams-akhilesh-yadav-over-sp-spokespersons-anti-brahmin-remark/2932212/>

■ **Summary:**

She said the leadership silence is causing the matter to escalate and assume greater gravity. In a post on X in Hindi, Mayawati said, "The widespread outrage and vehement condemnation regarding the indecent, unseemly, and objectionable remarks directed at the Brahmin community made by a prominent national spokesperson of the Samajwadi Party, are entirely natural. However, the silence of the SP leadership known for engaging in narrow, caste-based politics on this matter,

is further exacerbating and significantly escalating the situation. The situation is also becoming increasingly tense." The BSP chief said, "Taking a serious note of the hurt inflicted upon the honour and self-respect of the Brahmin community by the irresponsible statement of the SP spokesperson, it would likely be appropriate for the SP chief to take immediate cognisance of the matter, offer an apology and express remorse to the Brahmin community." She said this recent episode has demonstrated to the public that the SP's casteist tactics and character -hostile towards the Brahmin community, just as they are towards Dalits, the Most Backward Classes, and the Muslim community -- have not changed.

149. Congress infighting erupts in Gujarat after Ahmedabad local body poll defeat

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The New Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/gujarat/2026/May/15/congress-infighting-erupts-in-gujarat-after-ahmedabad-local-body-poll-defeat>

■ **Summary:**

AHMEDABAD: The Congress party's defeat in Gujarat's local body elections has triggered internal unrest in Ahmedabad, with six ward presidents removed from their posts and workers openly questioning the city leadership. After the Ahmedabad Municipal Corporation (AMC) election results, internal differences within the party came into the open. While the Congress slightly improved its seat tally, the BJP won 160 of the 192 seats, leaving the Congress with just 32 seats. The Congress had briefly celebrated symbolic victories, especially after winning a full panel in BJP stronghold Khadia. However, the celebrations soon turned into internal blame and dissatisfaction after the overall results. Following the defeat, the Gujarat Congress leadership held zone-wise review meetings in the presence of state Congress president Amit Chavda. The party reportedly reviewed booth-level failures, weak

organizational structures and election management in several wards. Soon after the meetings, Ahmedabad City Congress president Sonal Patel removed six ward presidents from their responsibilities, holding them accountable for poor organizational performance during the elections. The move, however, triggered strong reactions within the city unit.

150. No information on post-poll violence in Bengal, action to follow after verification: CM

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/india/no-information-on-post-poll-violence-in-bengal-action-to-follow-after-verification-cm/2932185/>

■ **Summary:**

Chattopadhyay, speaking during the first session of the newly constituted assembly, alleged that several people had been forced to flee their homes due to violence across the state after the assembly elections. "Violence has been taking place in several places. Many people are homeless now. The government should take strict action," the TMC legislator said in the House. In response, Adhikari said, "We have no information about such incidents...If anyone has been displaced, the police and administration will ensure they are returned home." The CM asserted that those involved in violence would not be spared, and the law would take its course in all genuine cases. The TMC also staged a walkout for a brief period after BJP legislators raised the "chor chor" (thieves) slogan in the assembly. The members of the opposition party were also absent during the Speaker's election but later returned to the House. BJP MLA Rathindra Bose was elected unopposed as the Speaker of the West Bengal assembly, becoming the first legislator from the northern part of the state to hold the chair. After the Speaker's election, Adhikari said the proceedings of the assembly will be telecast live so that people know what is happening inside the

House. He said the House would play a key role in fulfilling the aspirations of the people and function strictly in accordance with Constitutional principles and established rules. "We will move the assembly forward, keeping the Constitution in mind," the chief min

151. BJP MLA Rathindra Bose elected unopposed as West Bengal assembly Speaker

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** dtNext.in

■ **URL:** <https://www.dtnext.in/news/national/bjp-mla-rathindra-bose-elected-unopposed-as-west-bengal-assembly-speaker>

■ **Summary:**

The development is being seen as a strategic signal from the BJP government towards a region that has emerged as one of the BJP's strongest political bastions in the state over the last decade. Associated with the RSS and a chartered accountant by profession, Bose is a known face in north Bengal politics. Bose's election is also seen as a departure from a long-observed political convention in the state, where parties traditionally preferred lawyers or legislators with legal backgrounds for the Speaker's chair. During the previous TMC regime, veteran legislator Biman Banerjee served as Speaker.

152. BJP leaders won using fraudulent votes, alleges TPCC Chief Mahesh Kumar Goud

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <http://www.uniindia.com/bjp-leaders-won-using-fraudulent-votes-alleges-tpcc-chief-mahesh-kumar-goud/south/news/3843995.html>

■ **Summary:**

Hyderabad, May 15 (UNI) Telangana Pradesh Congress Committee (TPCC) President Bomma Mahesh Kumar Goud on Friday alleged that union Ministers Bandi

Sanjay Kumar and G Kishan Reddy had won their elections using "fraudulent votes" and claimed that this was the reason they were now "trembling with fear." Addressing the media at BRK Bhavan after meeting with Chief Electoral officer, C Sudhrashan Reddy, on the upcoming SIR process in Telangana, Mahesh Kumar alleged that vote theft had taken place in 14 states across the country and claimed that the electoral process was conducted in a malicious and unethical manner. He cited the elections in West Bengal as an example, alleging that while 8.2 crore new votes were added nationwide, around 5.90 lakh existing votes were deleted. Referring to West Bengal, he claimed that nearly 90 lakh votes were deleted while 60 lakh new votes were added, leading to changes in political equations and affecting election outcomes. The TPCC chief said that since no elections are scheduled in Telangana for the next two years, the Congress party had requested the Chief Election Commissioner to extend the Special Summary Revision (SSR) process over a period of one year. He stated that the total number of voters in Telangana was expected to increase to 3.35 crore by 2025 and expressed concern that conducting the SIR process simultaneously with Census operations could create difficulties. Mahesh Kumar said poor people whose names were deleted from voter rolls

153. Former Kolkata CP Vineet Goyal suspended along with 2 other IPS officers in Bengal for lapses in RG Kar doctor rape and murder probe

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <http://www.uniindia.com/former-kolkata-cp-vineet-goyal-suspended-along-with-2-other-ips-officers-in-bengal-for-lapses-in-rg-kar-doctor-rape-and-murder-probe/east/news/3844052.html>

■ **Summary:**

Kolkata, May 15 (UNI) West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Friday

suspended Vineet Goyal, the former commissioner of Kolkata Police, and two more IPS officers, including Indira Mukherjee and Abhishek Gupta, for alleged lapses in the RG Kar rape and murder. Goyal was the police commissioner in Kolkata when a 31-year-old postgraduate trainee was raped and murdered inside the RG Kar Medical College and Hospital on August 9, 2024. Mukherjee was then posted as the deputy commissioner central, and Gupta held the position of the deputy commissioner north. Adhikari said that these officers were suspended and a departmental enquiry will follow as "they were involved in offering a financial bribe to the family members of the victim and at least one officer held a press conference without any written order from the Kolkata Police or the home department." The rape and murder inside a state-run hospital had triggered widespread protests across the globe. In Kolkata, residents from all walks of life joined in street protests and night long vigils. A civic police volunteer, Sanjay Roy, 33, was arrested in connection with the case by the Kolkata Police before the case was handed over to the CBI. Announcing the decision, Chief Minister Adhikari said the action followed a review of the Kolkata police response to the incident, which he described as having been "seriously mishandled". Adhikari stated that, as he holds the portfolio of the home ministry, he had formed a fact finding co

154. Hijab row reignites in Karnataka as Congress defends religious symbols in schools

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Zee News

■ **URL:** <https://zeenews.india.com/india/hijab-row-reignites-in-karnataka-as-congress-defends-religious-symbols-in-schools-3047723.html>

■ **Summary:**

A fresh political row erupted in Karnataka over the hijab issue after Chief Minister Siddaramaiah defended the right to wear religious symbols like turban, kada, tilak,

holy ash, kalawa in educational institutions while ruling out the use of saffron shawls, drawing sharp reactions from the BJP. Clarifying the state government's stand, Karnataka Minister Priyank Kharge said the Congress government had not withdrawn any dress code and was only ensuring equal space for constitutionally protected religious practices. "We did not withdraw the dress code. All we have said is that all religious practices will have equal space in society, which is as per the Constitution. Be it a turban, kada, tilak, holy ash, kalawa or head scarf, what is the ambiguity in it? We are very clear. Whatever the Constitution allows you to practice, you are eligible to do so. If BJP has a problem with it, they can go to court," Kharge said. Drawing a distinction between hijab and saffron shawls, he added, "Saffron shawl is not a religious practice. BJP needs to concentrate on youngsters' education. The government of Karnataka and the Congress party are very clear that we are here to build youngsters' future by giving them education. If BJP wants to put saffron shawls on children and make them Gau-rakshaks and Dharm-rakshaks, let them do it to their children." Backing the Karnataka government's move, Jamaat-e-Islami Hind Karnataka State Secretary Mohammed Yusuf Kanni said India's secular and democratic cha

155. Meet Congress Leader, Dr Ketan Bhatikar, Dies At 38 From Snake Bite, Was A Physio For Goa Ranji Team

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** BollywoodShaadis

■ **URL:** <https://www.bollywoodshaadis.com/articles/meet-dr-ketan-bhatikar-79175>

■ **Summary:**

Congress leader, Dr Ketan Bhatikar, passed away at the age of 38, leaving his friends and family heartbroken. According to reports, the young leader was also working as a physiotherapist in Goa and died after an alleged snake bite. As people around the world mourn the loss of the esteemed leader, let's take a quick look at what we know

about him and his career. Dr Ketan Bhatikar passed away after being bitten by a snake. The tragic news of Dr Ketan Bhatikar's passing started making rounds on May 15, 2026. According to reports, the Congress candidate for the upcoming Ponda Assembly by-election reportedly died from a snake bite while travelling near Karmal Ghat along the Goa-Karnataka border on Thursday, May 14, 2026, night. He was rushed to a hospital in Dharbandora, where doctors declared him dead on arrival. The news of his passing was confirmed by police on the morning of May 15, 2026. Dr Ketan Bhatikar was the party's face during the recently cancelled Ponda assembly bypoll. The police spoke with PTI and issued a formal statement confirming Ketan's demise, and were quoted as saying: "Bhatikar had got down at Karmal Ghat, on the Goa-Karnataka border, for some reason, when a snake bit him. He was rushed to the Primary Health Centre in Dharbandora, Goa, where doctors declared him brought dead." Dr Ketan Bhatikar's political career Dr Ketan Bhatikar was the face of Congress for the Ponda by-election. However, the elections were cancelled following a high court verdict. Accordin

156. Kerala CM-Designate V D Satheesan Meets Former CM Pinarayi Vijayan At His Residence | VIDEO

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Free Press Journal

■ **URL:** <https://www.freepressjournal.in/india/kerala-cm-designate-v-d-satheesan-meets-former-cm-pinarayi-vijayan-at-his-residence-video>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram: Kerala Chief Minister-designate V D Satheesan met his predecessor Pinarayi Vijayan at the latter's residence here on Friday. Satheesan has been meeting senior leaders since Thursday after being named the chief minister by the AICC. He reached Vijayan's residence shortly after 12.10 pm. Vijayan and his family came out to receive Satheesan, following which the two leaders went inside

and held discussions. Vijayan held Satheesan's hand as he escorted him into the house. They also spoke about health and diet while sharing light moments over tea. Vijayan was having green tea during the interaction. Satheesan also appreciated Vijayan's disciplined lifestyle. The residence was recently rented at Bakery Junction after the LDF lost power and Vijayan vacated the official residence. Satheesan was the Leader of the Opposition in the Kerala Assembly during Vijayan's second tenure as chief minister from 2021 to 2026. With Satheesan set to take over as chief minister, Vijayan, who has been elected as the CPI(M) legislature party leader, is expected to become the Leader of the Opposition in the Assembly. The two leaders had several exchanges, both inside and outside the Assembly, during the tenure of the previous government. After the visit, Satheesan and Vijayan jointly met reporters. Satheesan said he visited Vijayan, describing him as one of the senior-most leaders in Kerala who has served as chief minister for 10 years and as CPI(M) state secretary for 16 years. "We h

157. Sabarimala recap: Key takeaways from Supreme Court's 16-day marathon hearing

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/legal-news/sabarimala-supreme-court-nine-judge-verdict-reserved-key-takeaways-10691037/>

■ **Summary:**

Over 16 days of hearings in the Sabarimala temple entry reference case, a nine-judge Constitution bench of the Supreme Court repeatedly grappled with a constitutional question far larger than the issue of women's entry into the one temple. With the bench, comprising CJI Surya Kant, Justices B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh, Ahsanuddin Amanullah, Aravind Kumar, Augustine George Masih, Prasanna B Varale, R Mahadevan, and Joymalya Bagchi, reserving its verdict on May 14, after a

marathon hearing, it may redefine the relationship between constitutional morality, social reform, and denominational autonomy. On Day 16 of the hearing, the Centre, represented by Solicitor General of India Tushar Mehta, argued that Article 25(1), which guarantees freedom of conscience and the right freely to profess, practise and propagate religion, does not itself provide for gender equality. "Article 25(1) does not provide for gender equality for the simple reason that Articles 15 and 16 already prohibit discrimination on the grounds, inter alia, of sex," he said. Here's are key takeaways from Supreme Court hearings The bench also reflected on the role of denominations in preserving religion. Justice B V Nagarathna observed that denominations and religious organisations hold communities together around a shared philosophy and are necessary for the "perpetuation of religion" in the country. Also Read | Sabarimala reference: There won't be religion in country if you mix articles of Constitution, says Justi

158. EC to conduct Special Intensive Revision from May 30: Odisha's Chief Electoral Officer

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/odisha/ec-to-conduct-special-intensive-revision-from-may-30-odishas-chief-electoral-officer/article70982355.ece>

■ **Summary:**

"The Election Commission (EC) will conduct a month-long Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Odisha from May 30," an official said on Friday (May 15, 2026). "The exercise will continue till June 28, while the final electoral rolls after the revision will be published on September 6," Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Odisha R. S. Gopalan said. Phase 3 of SIR in 16 States, three UTs from May 30, says ECI He said training of booth-level officers (BLOs) and booth-level agents (BLAs) will be conducted between May 20 and 29, following which BLOs will undertake door-to-door

verification from May 30 to June 28. He informed that rationalisation of the polling stations will also be completed by June 28. The draft electoral rolls will be published on July 5, and claims and objections can be filed till August 4. "After disposal of the objections, the final electoral rolls will be published on September 6," he said.

"Currently, Odisha has 38,123 polling booths, and the number will increase to 45,255 after completion of the exercise," the CEO said. As part of the revision process, 45,255 BLOs will conduct house-to-house verification across the State. 9.8 lakh deletions in Odisha's voter rolls after electoral mapping process "So far, seven political parties have appointed 27,723 BLAs for the exercise," Mr. Gopalan said. The BLOs will verify details of existing voters, enrol eligible citizens who have attained 18 years of age, delete names of deceased or shifted persons, an

159. Viral Then Hunted: How Bengal's Digital Mob Came For The Pocket Paratha Man | BOOM

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** BOOMLive

■ **URL:** <https://www.boomlive.in/decode/viral-then-hunted-how-bengals-digital-mob-came-for-the-pocket-paratha-man-31569>

■ **Summary:**

After the Bharatiya Janata Party's sweeping win, Bengal's post-poll violence has found a new weapon: the internet. Raju Ghosh hasn't opened his stall in over a week. He won't say where he is. Unknown numbers call in the middle of the night, with abuse, threats, and ultimatums to shut his shop forever. His pregnant wife has been advised to bed-rest. Four labourers who woke up with him at 2 am every morning to knead dough, roll flatbreads and fry them in batches have no work. "I feel extremely threatened," he said. "I cannot divulge my exact location." A month ago, Ghosh was one of Bengal's most recognisable faces. Raju Da Pocket Paratha became popular for a plate of food: three parathas, unlimited torkari of seasonal vegetables and

potatoes, a boiled egg, and his trademark apple-shaped onion -- all for thirty-five rupees outside Sealdah railway station. He had become an internet sensation. Food vloggers crowded him for content. Reels racked up views in lakhs. The queue grew so long that he had to designate a separate time slot after the 9 am rush for the cameras, so they wouldn't crowd out the commuters who actually needed to eat. Then the Assembly election results came on May 4. The BJP swept Bengal with 207 seats. And within 24 hours, the internet had begun its accounting. West Bengal is not new to post-poll violence. Vandalisation, arson, the deaths of party workers on both sides -- the state has seen all of this after previous verdicts. But what followed the May 4 result h

160. 25 foreign nationals detained for illegal voting in Tamil Nadu Assembly polls - CNBC TV18

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** cnbctv18.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.cnbctv18.com/india/25-foreign-nationals-detained-for-illegal-voting-in-tamil-nadu-assembly-polls-wsj-19906793.htm>

■ **Summary:**

The accused, who were travelling on foreign passports, were intercepted by officials from the Bureau of Immigration and later detained by local police after indelible ink marks were found on their fingers. Around 25 foreign nationals have been arrested or detained for allegedly casting votes in the recent Tamil Nadu Assembly elections. They reportedly used fraudulently obtained identity documents, police sources confirmed to The Hindu. Legal action has been initiated against the accused under provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), the Representation of the People Act, 1950, and other relevant laws. Investigators revealed that most of those detained were Sri Lankan nationals, while some reportedly held British and Canadian citizenship. Several more foreign nationals who arrived in India around the election

period may have also cast votes and remained in the country to avoid immediate scrutiny, as authorities had begun verifying passengers' credentials at airports. After receiving intelligence inputs that some foreign citizens were attempting to leave after allegedly voting, law enforcement agencies alerted officials at airports in Chennai, Madurai and other locations. Following this, multiple passengers were intercepted before boarding international flights. The verification and detention operation began around a week ago and is still ongoing. Speaking with The Hindu, a senior official said, "We conducted discreet inquiries and alerted the authorities who detained 25

161. DK Shivakumar Claims SIR Exercise Meant To 'Cut' SC, BC, Minority Votes In Karnataka

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** english

■ **URL:** <https://news.abplive.com/elections/karnataka-dk-shivakumar-claims-sir-exercise-meant-to-cut-sc-bc-minority-votes-1843839>

■ **Summary:**

Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls begins May 30. Bengaluru, May 15 (PTI) Karnataka Deputy Chief Minister D K Shivakumar on Friday charged the SIR of electoral rolls was being rolled out to "cut" SC, BC and minorities votes, and said the ruling Congress in the state will ensure that they are "protected". Shivakumar, also the state Congress chief, said that the party is educating all its leaders regarding Special Intensive Revision of the electoral rolls. The Election Commission of India on Thursday announced the rollout of phase-3 of the SIR in 16 states and three Union Territories involving 36.73 crore voters in a phased manner beginning May 30. Karnataka was also being covered. "We know that (SIR being rolled out), we have got all information. We are educating all the party leaders. Across the party line -- let BJP and JD(S) also secure all their votes," Shivakumar said. Speaking to reporters here, he said, "it's (SIR) aim is to see to that Scheduled Caste, backward class and the

minority votes are cut. But we will see that it is protected. Every one born in India should have their right." "In Karnataka 88 to 90 per cent has been mapped (mapping of electors). But still we will try to educate all of them," he added. Punjab, Jharkhand, Karnataka and Telangana are the opposition-ruled among the states where the SIR exercise will be held. The final voters' roll of Karnataka will be out on October 7. A section of leaders and organisations opposed to SIR had met

162. VD Satheesan says avoiding Congress faction of his own helped UDF win in Kerala

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** OnManorama

■ **URL:** <https://www.onmanorama.com/news/kerala/2026/05/15/v-d-satheesan-says-avoiding-congress-faction-of-his-own-helped-udf-win-in-kerala.html>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram: Chief Minister-designate V D Satheesan opens up to Malayala Manorama. Q: Did these 11 days of uncertainty take a heavy emotional toll on you? A: Not at all. I had the satisfaction of having carried out the responsibility entrusted to me by the Congress leadership effectively. The rest was for the national leadership to decide. Q: Don't you think the decision took too long? A: I do not agree with that view. Where else, other than in Congress, does such a democratic process take place? After the Legislature Party authorised the party president to take a decision, the high command held discussions with all key leaders. This was not about any individual leader appointing someone of their choice. I am proud of my party. Such processes would never take place in the CPM or the BJP. Q: Someone who hasn't even been a minister is becoming Chief Minister and is suddenly being addressed as 'CM'. What is going through your mind? A: It is hard to come to terms with it. But I have the confidence of having spent a quarter of a century in the Assembly. I have always been a legislator who tried to understand matters across all departments and

emerging issues. Q: But there are also some who criticise you for lacking administrative experience... A: I am a confident person, and I will quickly grasp the issues at hand. I firmly believe I will be able to lead accordingly. No one can do this alone; what truly matters is the team. My effort will be to move forward in coordination

163. Opaqueness around Rahul's foreign trips worrisome, violation of rules says Kiren Rijiju

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** 5 Dariya News

■ **URL:** <http://www.5dariyanews.com/news/489170-Opaqueness-around-Rahuls-foreign-trips-worrisome-violation-of-rules-says-Kiren-Rijiju>

■ **Summary:**

Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju on Friday backed the BJP's demands for clarity on the "funding" of Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi's foreign trips as well as the "unaccounted" income that was being spent on facilitating the same. Speaking to the media, Rijiju also stated the 'opaqueness' around certain foreign visits by the Congress MP was worrisome as it amounted to a violation of Parliamentary protocols. "The questions being raised are serious because if any member of Parliament travels abroad, he or she must inform the Secretariat of the Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha, three weeks in advance," the Union Minister said, outlining the rules that every lawmaker must adhere to, purportedly for security reasons. Rijiju's remarks come on the back of controversy around 'money trail' pertaining to Rahul Gandhi's foreign tours, which highlights a glaring mismatch between his declared income and expenses on foreign tours, in the past two decades, while abroad. On Thursday, BJP MP Sambit Patra, in a scathing charge at Rahul, claimed that the declared income of Congress MP has been Rs 11 crores but he has spent about Rs 60 crore in the 54 foreign trips undertaken across continents, including Europe, the Middle-East, and also questioned from where the LoP was

drawing funds for such trips. Rijju said that if Rahul's expenses abroad exceed the income declared in his election affidavit, it becomes a matter of concern for the Income Tax department. Whether this income i

164. A NOTable warning for Congress in West Bengal

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Times of India

■ **URL:** <https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/a-notable-warning-for-congress-in-west-bengal/articleshow/131113695.cms>

■ **Summary:**

If NOTA, or None of the Above, is meant to be a protest button, Bengal's 2026 assembly election showed a mellowing of that protest. But the same data also flashed a sharper warning, not for TMC or the Left, but for Congress. Across the comparable 293-seat base (Falta is yet to vote), NOTA votes dropped from 6.53 lakh in 2021 to 4.95 lakh in 2026. That is a fall of 1.58 lakh votes, or 24.24%. This was not because fewer people voted. Total votes polled in these same seats rose from about 6.01 crore to 6.38 crore. Yet fewer voters chose NOTA. Its vote share slipped from 1.09% to 0.78%. In 2021, NOTA ranked fourth in 195 seats. In 2026, it ranked fourth in only 80. It moved down the candidate order, more often finishing fifth, sixth or lower. By itself, this should have been a story of NOTA losing visibility. However, the data also serves as a proxy for Congress's performance. NOTA exceeded Congress in 92 seats, RSP in 3, and AIFB and CPI(M) in 2 each. NOTA's median vote in 2026 was only about 1,569. That is not high. But Congress's median was only 1,924, and in 156 of its 292 contests, Congress polled fewer than 2,000 votes. The contrast with other parties explains why the number looks so stark. BJP's lowest vote count was 13,180. TMC's lowest was 38,876. NOTA was never going to cross them. The 2021 contrast makes Congress's collapse clearer. That year, Congress contested far fewer seats because of its seat-sharing arrangement with the Left. In the comparable base, it

165. UK Government Shaken as Starmer Faces Leadership Challenge

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/uk-government-shaken-as-starmer-faces-leadership-challenge-7431350.html>

■ **Summary:**

The British government faces weeks of uncertainty as embattled Prime Minister Keir Starmer prepares for a leadership challenge from the popular mayor of Manchester, Andy Burnham LONDON (AP) -- The British government faces weeks of uncertainty as embattled Prime Minister Keir Starmer prepares for a leadership challenge from the popular mayor of Greater Manchester, Andy Burnham, who can't formally launch his bid until he finds a way back into Parliament. Burnham's path to Westminster is far from certain. He will first have to overcome a strong challenge from the anti-immigrant Reform UK party in a special election for the parliamentary seat that was vacated to make way for him. British government borrowing costs rose Friday and the pound weakened on investor concern about continued disarray at the heart of government. The pound has dropped 1.4% against the U.S dollar this week. Also Read | World Shares Lower and South Korea's Kospi Hits Record High. Weeks of speculation about Starmer 's future broke into open rebellion within the governing Labour Party on Thursday as Burnham declared his intention to seek the top job and two other senior members positioned themselves for their own bids. The pressure to replace Starmer increased after Labour posted disastrous results in last week's local elections, losing votes to Reform UK on the right and the Green Party on the left. Housing Secretary Steve Reed on Friday appealed to party members to step back from the brink of a divisive lead

166. Paranjpe was inducted in Shiv Sena to stop him from joining MVA; NCP was kept in loop: Samant

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/maharashtra/paranjpe-was-inducted-in-shiv-sena-to-stop-him-from-joining-mva-ncp-was-kept-in-loop-samant/article70982284.ece>

■ **Summary:**

Anand Paranjpe resigned from the NCP helmed by Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar, and later joined the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena Maharashtra Minister Uday Samant on Friday (May 15, 2026) said former Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) leader Anand Paranjpe was inducted into the Shiv Sena to stop him from joining any Opposition party, and added that the Sunetra Pawar-led party was kept in the loop about his induction to avoid any misunderstanding with it. Mr. Paranjpe on Thursday (May 14, 2026) resigned from the NCP helmed by Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar, and later joined the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena. Both the NCP and the Shiv Sena are part of the ruling Mahayuti in Maharashtra along with the BJP. Addressing a press conference on Friday (May 15, 2026), Mr. Samant said Mr. Paranjpe, a two-time MP who represented the Shiv Sena from Thane and Kalyan Lok Sabha constituencies, was inducted into the Shiv Sena to ensure that he does not enter any Maha Vikas Aghadi (MVA) party. "We were of the opinion that Anand Paranjpe should not enter any MVA party," the Shiv Sena leader said. "When we decided to induct Mr. Paranjpe into Shiv Sena, Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde tried to call NCP president Sunetra Pawar, but she was in an event and they could not talk immediately," he said. "After that the party tried to contact NCP MP Parth Pawar, but could not get through to him. Then, his younger brother Jay Pawar was contacted and he was informed about the Mr. Paranjpe's inducti

167. 'Don't isolate Muslim League': VD Satheesan's first major political message stresses secular unity

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <https://www.uniindia.com/~/-don-t-isolate-muslim-league-vd-satheesan-s-first-major-political-message-stresses-secular-unity/States/news/3843971.html>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram, May 15 (UNI) Kerala Chief Minister-designate V D Satheesan on Friday strongly defended the Indian union Muslim League against what he described as deliberate attempts to isolate and target the party, asserting that there would be "no compromise" on secular values under his leadership. In his first major political statement after being chosen to lead the new government, Satheesan said campaigns directed solely against the Muslim League were aimed at creating divisions in society and strengthening communal forces in the state. "The Muslim League should not be attacked in isolation. If the League weakens, communal forces will occupy that political space. The League, too, is a political force that prevents such elements from growing," Satheesan said. Describing the Muslim League as a key constituent of the United Democratic Front (UDF), he credited the party with playing a major role in the alliance's electoral success. According to Satheesan, attempts to portray the League negatively were politically motivated efforts intended to trigger communal polarisation in Kerala. "There will be no compromise with campaigns based on hatred. There will be absolutely no compromise on secular positions. We did not compromise during the election campaign, and there is no question of compromising after the election either," he said. The Chief Minister-designate stressed that Kerala's social fabric should not be disturbed by divisive politics and warned against attempts to sp

168. BJP leaders won using fraudulent votes, alleges TPCC Chief Mahesh Kumar Goud

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <https://www.uniindia.com/~/bjp-leaders-won-using-fraudulent-votes-alleges-tpcc-chief-mahesh-kumar-goud/States/news/3843995.html>

■ **Summary:**

Hyderabad, May 15 (UNI) Telangana Pradesh Congress Committee (TPCC) President Bomma Mahesh Kumar Goud on Friday alleged that union Ministers Bandi Sanjay Kumar and G Kishan Reddy had won their elections using "fraudulent votes" and claimed that this was the reason they were now "trembling with fear." Addressing the media at BRK Bhavan after meeting with Chief Electoral officer, C Sudhrashan Reddy, on the upcoming SIR process in Telangana, Mahesh Kumar alleged that vote theft had taken place in 14 states across the country and claimed that the electoral process was conducted in a malicious and unethical manner. He cited the elections in West Bengal as an example, alleging that while 8.2 crore new votes were added nationwide, around 5.90 lakh existing votes were deleted. Referring to West Bengal, he claimed that nearly 90 lakh votes were deleted while 60 lakh new votes were added, leading to changes in political equations and affecting election outcomes. The TPCC chief said that since no elections are scheduled in Telangana for the next two years, the Congress party had requested the Chief Election Commissioner to extend the Special Summary Revision (SSR) process over a period of one year. He stated that the total number of voters in Telangana was expected to increase to 3.35 crore by 2025 and expressed concern that conducting the SIR process simultaneously with Census operations could create difficulties. Mahesh Kumar said poor people whose names were deleted from voter rolls

169. Who is Rathindra Bose? CA turned politician elected unopposed as West Bengal Assembly speaker | Mint

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** mint

■ **URL:** <https://www.livemint.com/politics/news/who-is-rathindra-bose-ca-turned-politician-elected-unopposed-as-west-bengal-assembly-speaker-11778835172762.html>

■ **Summary:**

BJP MLA Rathindra Bose was elected as Speaker of the 18th West Bengal Legislative Assembly, becoming the first representative from North Bengal to hold the position. Rathindra Bose, a BJP MLA, was unanimously chosen as the Speaker of the 18th West Bengal Legislative Assembly on Friday, making him the first representative from North Bengal to occupy the position, as reported by PTI. His candidature was put forward in the House by Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari, after which pro tem Speaker Tapas Roy held a voice vote. Roy later announced Bose's election as Speaker after receiving the backing of all 207 BJP MLAs in the assembly. Bose secured victory from the Cooch Behar constituency by a margin of 23,284 votes, or 11.4 percentage points, defeating Avijit De Bhowmik of the All India Trinamool Congress. Congratulating him on the appointment, Bengal CM Suvendu Adhikari said that Bose, a chartered accountant by profession, brings valuable administrative knowledge along with organisational experience to the position. Bose became the first MLA from north Bengal in post-Independence history to hold the Speaker's chair in the West Bengal assembly. Adhikari had on Thursday announced Bose, the MLA from Cooch Behar Dakshin seat, as the BJP's candidate for the Speaker's post in the newly constituted 18th West Bengal assembly, while the opposition TMC decided not to field a nominee. Speaking to reporters at the Assembly, Bose said he would carry out the responsibility entrusted to him by th

170. CM Satheesan can democratise power -- or emulate his predecessor

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/opinion/columns/cm-satheesan-democratise-power-pinarayi-vijayan-10691083/>

■ **Summary:**

After 10 years and 10 long days, Congress has its Chief Minister in Kerala. The state's Congressmen were seasoned enough to handle the 10 years without power. The ten-day wait took its toll. After an overwhelming poll win, three chief ministerial contenders emerged, and their three-cornered contest made the electoral battle look tame. Few state units of the Grand Old Party have handled inner-party conflicts as well as Kerala's. The Congress here has a history of groups that coexist, bicker, squabble, fight, negotiate, and manage conflicts. The loser always finds the political space to wait for another day. This time, unusually, the battling leaders did not seem to have a fallback position. The CM race looked like an all-out war. Advertisement Congress watchers framed this newfound aggression in familiar terms, such as greed for power and personal ambition, aggravated by the party's serial electoral misfortunes nationwide. Media watchers added that the battle played out 24×7 because there were flood-lit battle grounds -- television and YouTube channels. These apart, there could be an unstated reason. The last CM, Pinarayi Vijayan, did something fundamental to the office. Over his decade-long tenure, his CMO became the central pole in a way Kerala has never seen before. Post-Pinarayi, the top job is bigger than ever. No wonder the contenders were fighting to the finish. The chair is almost a throne. Satheesan's ascent, therefore, is not just a power shift from the left front th

171. India News | 'Should Not Reduce PM's Security Amid Austerity Measures': Ex-R&AW; Secy Samant Goel | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/india-news-should-not-reduce-pms-security-amid-austerity-measures-ex-raw-secy-samant-goel-7431360.html>

■ **Summary:**

New Delhi [India], May 15 (ANI): Former R&AW; Secretary Samant Goel on Friday suggested that the Prime Minister's convoy and the security arrangements should not be reduced in the name of austerity measures, as PM Modi's safety is a priority in national interest. Speaking to ANI, Samant Goel opposed the move to reduce the PM's convoy amid a need to save fuel due to the global energy crisis. He said that the Prime Minister's security should rather be strengthened, given the new security threats. Also Read | NEET UG 2026 Re-Exam: NTA To Re-Conduct Medical Entrance Test on June 21; Aspirants Say Questions Will Be Tougher Next Time. Noting the volatility of the global security situation, Goel said, "The international security situation is volatile. There were attacks on President Donald Trump, despite the US being considered to be safe. There are elements against India, carrying out terror activities, especially from our neighbouring state. In such a situation, I believe, we should keep special arrangements for the Prime Minister's security. Such austerity measures are not in the national interest. Amid new threats of drones and sniper guns, we should rather strengthen the security, instead of reducing it." He highlighted that PM Modi has received security threats since he was the Chief Minister of Gujarat. Also Read | PM Narendra Modi Meets UAE President MBZ, Signs Key MoUs on Defence, Energy Cooperation and USD 5 Billion Investment. "Security is not a status symbol, but given as

172. World News | JSMM Accuses Pakistan of Enforced Disappearances and Torture of Sindhi Activists | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/world-news-jsmm-accuses-pakistan-of-enforced-disappearances-and-torture-of-sindhi-activists-7431319.html>

■ **Summary:**

Frankfurt [Germany], May 15 (ANI): The Jeay Sindh Muttahida Mahaz (JSMM), led by chairman Shafi Burfat, has accused the Pakistani state and its military establishment of carrying out systematic repression, enforced disappearances, and extrajudicial killings of Sindhi political activists. In a strongly worded statement, addressed to the United Nations, international human rights organisations, the European Union, and democratic governments worldwide, JSMM alleged that Sindh has been subjected to political and economic exploitation since the creation of Pakistan in 1947. Also Read | PM Narendra Modi Meets UAE President MBZ, Signs Key MoUs on Defence, Energy Cooperation and USD 5 Billion Investment. JSMM claimed that Sindh, despite possessing a distinct historical identity, culture, and language, was reduced to a colony under what it described as Punjabi military domination. The statement described Pakistan as a "military-religious fascist state" accused of suppressing democratic freedoms, silencing nationalist movements, and targeting minority nations, including Sindhis, Baloch, Pashtuns, and Saraikis. JSMM further alleged that Pakistan's intelligence agencies, particularly the ISI, have operated secret detention centres where political workers are allegedly tortured and held without trial. Also Read | Claudine Longet, Famed for Shooting Trial, Dies at 84. According to the appeal, several JSMM leaders and activists, including central coordination secretary Roheel Laghari, Ejaz

173. Assam Assembly's seniormost MLA Patowary takes oath as pro-tem Speaker

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Hindu

■ **URL:** <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/assam/assam-assemblys-seniormost-mla-patowary-takes-oath-as-pro-tem-speaker/article70982423.ece>

■ **Summary:**

Seniormost MLA of the 16th Assam Assembly, Chandra Mohan Patowary, was on Friday (May 15, 2026) sworn in as the pro-tem Speaker by Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya. Mr. Acharya administered the oath to the BJP leader and former cabinet minister at a ceremony held at Lok Bhavan here. "Today, at Lok Bhavan, Assam, I administered the oath of office as the Pro-tem Speaker of the newly constituted 16th Assam Legislative Assembly to Shri Chandra Mohan Patowary," the Governor said in a post on X. "I am confident that drawing upon his vast experience and commitment to democratic values, the initial proceedings of the Assembly will be conducted with complete constitutional dignity," Mr. Acharya added. "Honoured to have taken oath as Pro-tem Speaker of 16th @AssamAssembly, administered by Hon'ble Governor of Assam Shri @Laxmanacharya54 Ji at Lok Bhavan today," the seventh-time MLA said in a post on the social media site. Mr. Patowary was first elected to the Assembly from Dharmapur constituency in 1985 as an Asom Gana Parishad (AGP) candidate. He represented the constituency six times, including twice as a BJP legislator since 2016. He has been elected to the new Assembly from Tihu constituency, created during the 2023 delimitation exercise, which includes parts of the erstwhile Dharmapur seat. As pro-tem Speaker, Mr. Patowary will administer the oath to newly elected MLAs during the first session of the Assembly beginning on May 21. The four-day session will continue till May 26, with

174. Parties gear up for Shillong by-poll

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The New Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://www.newindianexpress.com/india/2026/May/15/parties-gear-up-for-shillong-by-poll>

■ **Summary:**

GUWAHATI: Political parties are gearing up for the by-election to the Shillong Lok Sabha seat, necessitated by the demise of sitting MP Ricky AJ Syngkon of the Voice of People Party (VPP). Ricky Andrew J. Syngkon reportedly collapsed while playing football in Mawiong on the outskirts of Shillong. He was rushed to a missionary hospital, but doctors could not revive him. The Election Commission has not yet announced the by-poll schedule. Recently, the state's Chief Electoral Officer BDR Tiwari had stated that the state election department is ready and waiting for the schedule. He said the by-poll had to be held within six months from Syngkon's demise. Chief Minister Conrad K. Sangma's National People's Party (NPP) and the VPP have already announced their candidates for the upcoming election. The VPP has fielded academician Batskhem Myrboh, while the NPP has nominated DRL Nonglait, a prominent scholar who also serves as the president of the Khasi Authors' Society. Speaking to the media, former Shillong MP Vincent H. Pala expressed confidence in a strong Congress performance, noting that the proposal for his candidacy will be sent to the party's central leadership for a final decision. Meanwhile, it remains to be seen whether the BJP and the United Democratic Party -- both partners in the NPP-led ruling coalition -- will choose to contest the by-election. Once the dominant political force in Meghalaya, the Congress party is now fighting for its survival in the state. Currently, t

175. 'Don't isolate Muslim League': VD Satheesan's first major political message stresses secular unity

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <http://www.uniindia.com/-don-t-isolate-muslim-league-vd-satheesan-s-first-major-political-message-stresses-secular-unity/south/news/3843971.html>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram, May 15 (UNI) Kerala Chief Minister-designate V D Satheesan on Friday strongly defended the Indian union Muslim League against what he described as deliberate attempts to isolate and target the party, asserting that there would be "no compromise" on secular values under his leadership. In his first major political statement after being chosen to lead the new government, Satheesan said campaigns directed solely against the Muslim League were aimed at creating divisions in society and strengthening communal forces in the state. "The Muslim League should not be attacked in isolation. If the League weakens, communal forces will occupy that political space. The League, too, is a political force that prevents such elements from growing," Satheesan said. Describing the Muslim League as a key constituent of the United Democratic Front (UDF), he credited the party with playing a major role in the alliance's electoral success. According to Satheesan, attempts to portray the League negatively were politically motivated efforts intended to trigger communal polarisation in Kerala. "There will be no compromise with campaigns based on hatred. There will be absolutely no compromise on secular positions. We did not compromise during the election campaign, and there is no question of compromising after the election either," he said. The Chief Minister-designate stressed that Kerala's social fabric should not be disturbed by divisive politics and warned against attempts to sp

176. Opaqueness Around Rahul's Foreign Trips Worrisome, Violation Of Rules: Rijiju | Nation

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Ommcom News

■ **URL:** <https://ommcomnews.com/india-news/opaqueness-around-rahuls-foreign-trip-s-worrisome-violation-of-rules-rijiju/>

■ **Summary:**

New Delhi: Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju on Friday backed the BJP's demands for clarity on the "funding" of Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi's foreign trips as well as the "unaccounted" income that was being spent on facilitating the same. Speaking to the media, Rijiju also stated the 'opaqueness' around certain foreign visits by the Congress MP was worrisome as it amounted to a violation of Parliamentary protocols. "The questions being raised are serious because if any member of Parliament travels abroad, he or she must inform the Secretariat of the Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha, three weeks in advance," the Union Minister said, outlining the rules that every lawmaker must adhere to, purportedly for security reasons. Rijiju's remarks come on the back of controversy around 'money trail' pertaining to Rahul Gandhi's foreign tours, which highlights a glaring mismatch between his declared income and expenses on foreign tours, in the past two decades, while abroad. On Thursday, BJP MP Sambit Patra, in a scathing charge at Rahul, claimed that the declared income of Congress MP has been Rs 11 crores but he has spent about Rs 60 crore in the 54 foreign trips undertaken across continents, including Europe, the Middle-East, and also questioned from where the LoP was drawing funds for such trips. Rijiju said that if Rahul's expenses abroad exceed the income declared in his election affidavit, it becomes a matter of concern for the Income Tax department. Whether th

177. Hijab Row Reignites In Karnataka As Congress Defends Religious Symbols In Schools | Nation

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Ommcom News

■ **URL:** <https://ommcomnews.com/india-news/hijab-row-reignites-in-karnataka-as-congress-defends-religious-symbols-in-schools/>

■ **Summary:**

Bengaluru: A fresh political row erupted in Karnataka over the hijab issue after Chief Minister Siddaramaiah defended the right to wear religious symbols like turban, kada, tilak, holy ash, kalawa in educational institutions while ruling out the use of saffron shawls, drawing sharp reactions from the BJP. Clarifying the state government's stand, Karnataka Minister Priyank Kharge said the Congress government had not withdrawn any dress code and was only ensuring equal space for constitutionally protected religious practices. "We did not withdraw the dress code. All we have said is that all religious practices will have equal space in society, which is as per the Constitution. Be it a turban, kada, tilak, holy ash, kalawa or head scarf, what is the ambiguity in it? We are very clear. Whatever the Constitution allows you to practice, you are eligible to do so. If BJP has a problem with it, they can go to court," Kharge said. Drawing a distinction between hijab and saffron shawls, he added, "Saffron shawl is not a religious practice. BJP needs to concentrate on youngsters' education. The government of Karnataka and the Congress party are very clear that we are here to build youngsters' future by giving them education. If BJP wants to put saffron shawls on children and make them Gau-rakshaks and Dharm-rakshaks, let them do it to their children." Backing the Karnataka government's move, Jamaat-e-Islami Hind Karnataka State Secretary Mohammed Yusuf Kanni said India's secular and dem

178. BJP targets Rahul Gandhi over 'opaque' foreign visits and expenses

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Zee News

■ **URL:** <https://zeenews.india.com/india/kiren-rijiju-questions-rahul-gandhi-foreign-trip-s-funding-controversy-3047713.html>

■ Summary:

Union Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju on Friday backed the BJP's demands for clarity on the "funding" of Leader of Opposition (LoP) Rahul Gandhi's foreign trips as well as the "unaccounted" income that was being spent on facilitating the same. Speaking to the media, Rijiju also stated the 'opaqueness' around certain foreign visits by the Congress MP was worrisome as it amounted to a violation of Parliamentary protocols. "The questions being raised are serious because if any member of Parliament travels abroad, he or she must inform the Secretariat of the Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha, three weeks in advance," the Union Minister said, outlining the rules that every lawmaker must adhere to, purportedly for security reasons. Rijiju's remarks come on the back of controversy around 'money trail' pertaining to Rahul Gandhi's foreign tours, which highlights a glaring mismatch between his declared income and expenses on foreign tours, in the past two decades, while abroad. On Thursday, BJP MP Sambit Patra, in a scathing charge at Rahul, claimed that the declared income of Congress MP has been Rs 11 crores but he has spent about Rs 60 crore in the 54 foreign trips undertaken across continents, including Europe, the Middle-East, and also questioned from where the LoP was drawing funds for such trips. Rijiju said that if Rahul's expenses abroad exceed the income declared in his election affidavit, it becomes a matter of concern for the Income Tax department. Whether this income i

179. Why Siddaramaiah government's reversal of school hijab ban touches off a storm

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/political-pulse/why-siddaramaiah-governments-reversal-of-school-hijab-ban-touches-off-a-storm-10690976/>

■ Summary:

The recent decision of the Congress-led Karnataka government to withdraw the previous BJP government's 2022 order banning hijab in schools and pre-university colleges (classes 11 and 12) has triggered sharp reactions from the Opposition BJP-led NDA in the state. While the BJP has attacked the Congress government, calling the decision "appeasement and vote bank politics", the JD(S) has questioned its timing. Advertisement The Congress government led by Chief Minister Siddaramaiah has however strongly defended the move, saying it is meant to protect the "tradition and culture-based symbols" of all communities, not only Muslims. In February 2022, the then Basavaraj Bommai-led BJP government had issued the order stipulating that students must stick to the uniform prescribed by schools and PU (pre-university) colleges, triggering protests across the state and stoking communal tensions, especially in coastal Karnataka, where the issue had first erupted in December 2021. Also read | Hijab row: Siddaramaiah says order aligns with Kendriya Vidyalayas' policy, asks if allowing sacred thread also appeasement Following the BJP government's order, issued weeks ahead of then annual exams, several Muslim girls wearing hijab were stopped from attending their classes. Subsequently, many Muslim girls had reportedly discontinued their schooling or were forced to enrol themselves in educational institutions that permitted hijab. Advertisement Hearing the matter, the Karnataka High Court had upheld

180. After DMK's shock loss, Stalin wants suggestions to turn the party around. His sister, Kanimozhi, may be the trump card

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/opinion/columns/dmk-stalin-party-kanimozhi-vijay-tvk-aiadm-10691029/>

■ Summary:

The defeat of the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) and All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) by the newcomer Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) took many by shock. The two Dravidian parties have tried to explain their respective successes and losses, while scholars of Tamil politics grapple to make sense of the Vijay phenomenon. On Thursday, former Chief Minister and DMK leader M K Stalin put out a video on his X account, where he graciously claimed responsibility for the defeat of the DMK and invited the public to offer suggestions for improvement in the future. There is no doubt that the DMK needs to evolve and reinvent itself according to the times, as Stalin himself noted. For that to happen, however, the DMK must bring in a real leadership transformation -- and the name is Kanimozhi Karunanidhi. Advertisement Time and again, women voters have not found much inspiration in the DMK. When Jayalalithaa was around, AIADMK was able to garner women's votes in larger numbers than the DMK. Her welfare measures, such as the Amma Mess, greatly empowered women at the local level. In contrast, the DMK leadership is not only seen as male, it is also seen as a space where women cannot aspire to higher positions. Despite welfare measures such as free bus-passes for women, the Kalaigal Magalir Urimai Thittam, Pudhumai Penn Thittam, and others, the DMK was unable to project its impact onto its image. Worse, law and order problems also contributed to a negative public perception. V

181. UK PM Keir Starmer has a new challenger: Great Manchester Mayor Andy Burnham

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Indian Express

■ **URL:** <https://indianexpress.com/article/world/andy-burnham-labour-leadership-keir-starmer-pressure-10690964/>

■ **Summary:**

Andy Burnham, Mayor of Great Manchester is now on a potential route back to parliament as PM Starmer faces a leadership challenge due to tensions in the Labour Party. Less than two years after the Labour Party returned to power promising 'stability' after years of Conservative turmoil, Starmer is now fighting for his political survival. Now, Andy Burnham has a chance to become Labour Party's next leader after Manchester MP Josh Simons said that he would resign and would trigger a by-election to make way for Burnham, says the BBC. The move ended days of speculation about whether Burnham could secure a possible path back into Westminster. Andy Burnham says 'will ask Labour Party to allow him to contest' Andy Burnham has confirmed he will ask the Labour Party's national executive committee (NEC) to allow him to stand in the leadership contest, as per a report by the Guardian. On the other hand, allies of UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer said that he would not try to block Burnham's bid, after concerns were raised by the party's MPs. As per a report by the Guardian, Andy Burnham said a 'much bigger change' is needed across the country and also highlighted the cost of living crisis as an important issue in his campaign to return to Westminster. He said, "This is why I now seek people's support to return to parliament: to bring the change we have brought to Greater Manchester to the whole of the UK and make politics work properly for people". Burnham has been seeking to return to par

182. Hijab row reignites in Karnataka as Congress defends religious symbols in schools - Mangalorean.com

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Mangalorean.com

■ **URL:** <https://www.mangalorean.com/hijab-row-reignites-in-karnataka-as-congress-defends-religious-symbols-in-schools/>

■ **Summary:**

Bengaluru: A fresh political row erupted in Karnataka over the hijab issue after Chief Minister Siddaramaiah defended the right to wear religious symbols like turban, kada, tilak, holy ash, kalawa in educational institutions while ruling out the use of saffron shawls, drawing sharp reactions from the BJP. Clarifying the state government's stand, Karnataka Minister Priyank Kharge said the Congress government had not withdrawn any dress code and was only ensuring equal space for constitutionally protected religious practices. "We did not withdraw the dress code. All we have said is that all religious practices will have equal space in society, which is as per the Constitution. Be it a turban, kada, tilak, holy ash, kalawa or head scarf, what is the ambiguity in it? We are very clear. Whatever the Constitution allows you to practice, you are eligible to do so. If BJP has a problem with it, they can go to court," Kharge said. Drawing a distinction between hijab and saffron shawls, he added, "Saffron shawl is not a religious practice. BJP needs to concentrate on youngsters' education. The government of Karnataka and the Congress party are very clear that we are here to build youngsters' future by giving them education. If BJP wants to put saffron shawls on children and make them Gau-rakshaks and Dharm-rakshaks, let them do it to their children." Backing the Karnataka government's move, Jamaat-e-Islami Hind Karnataka State Secretary Mohammed Yusuf Kanni said India's secular and dem

183. Chandra Mohan Patowary sworn in as Pro-tem Speaker of 16th Assam Assembly

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The Assam Tribune

■ **URL:** <https://assamtribune.com/assam/chandra-mohan-patowary-sworn-in-as-pro-t-em-speaker-of-16th-assam-assembly-1611657>

■ **Summary:**

Guwahati, May 15: Senior BJP leader Chandra Mohan Patowary was sworn in as the Pro-tem Speaker of the newly constituted 16th Assam Legislative Assembly on Friday ahead of the commencement of the first Assembly session later this month.

Lakshman Prasad Acharya administered the oath to Patowary at Lok Bhavan in Guwahati. In a post on social media, the Assam Governor expressed confidence in Patowary's ability to conduct the initial proceedings of the Assembly with constitutional dignity. "Today at Lok Bhavan, Assam, Shri Chandramohan Patowary was administered the oath as the Pro-tem Speaker of the newly constituted 16th Assam Legislative Assembly. I am confident that with his vast experience and commitment to democratic values, the initial proceedings of the Assembly will be conducted with full constitutional dignity," Acharya said. Speaking to the press after the ceremony, Patowary said he had been entrusted with the responsibility of overseeing the swearing-in of newly elected MLAs during the Assembly session beginning May 21. "I have been appointed as the Pro-tem Speaker for the Assembly session scheduled from May 21 by the Assam Governor today. I have been assigned with the responsibility to oversee MLA oath taking," Patowary said. Expressing gratitude to Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma and the people of the state, the senior BJP legislator highlighted his long political journey. "I have been elected to the Assembly for the seventh term. I express immense warmth for the b

184. Congo, Rwanda head for showdown over Francophonie top job

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** ThePrint

■ **URL:** <https://theprint.in/world/congo-rwanda-head-for-showdown-over-francophoni-e-top-job/2932153/>

■ **Summary:**

The diplomatic contest is unfolding amid continued clashes between Congo and the Rwanda-backed AFC/M23 rebels, who seized control of the eastern cities of Goma and Bukavu in early 2025. Rwanda denies allegations from Kinshasa, Western nations and U.N. experts that it backs the insurgents. Mediation efforts by the United States, Qatar and the African Union have failed to halt the fighting. The OIF post carries significant diplomatic weight, with a mandate covering education, cultural policy, human rights and economic cooperation. Rwanda's Louise Mushikiwabo, the incumbent secretary general, is seeking a third term. She faces a challenge from Congo's Juliana Lumumba, a former culture minister and the daughter of the country's independence leader and first prime minister. Mauritania's Coumba Ba, a presidential adviser, and Romania's former prime minister Dacian Cioloș are also running.

CONGO IS WORLD'S LARGEST FRENCH-SPEAKING COUNTRY Kinshasa has thrown significant diplomatic weight behind Lumumba's bid, which was announced in late February. The candidate recently travelled to several African countries as well as Canada, the OIF's second-largest funder. Congolese government spokesperson Patrick Muyaya told Reuters that Kinshasa was pursuing the bid "in a positive and constructive spirit", pointing to the growing demographic and cultural weight of French-speaking Africa. With a population of about 100 million, Congo is the world's largest French-speaking country. "For us, this el

185. Meet Kerala CM, VD Satheesan's Wife, Lakshmi Priya, All About His Family And Life Before Congress

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** BollywoodShaadis

■ **URL:** <https://www.bollywoodshaadis.com/articles/meet-kerala-cm-vd-satheesan-wife-lakshmi-priya-family-life-before-congress-79173>

■ **Summary:**

VD Satheesan is currently in the headlines after becoming the new Chief Minister of Kerala. The All India Congress Committee (AICC) chose him for the position over other party veterans, including KC Venugopal, and officially announced the decision on May 14, 2026. Satheesan is scheduled to be sworn in as the state's 13th Chief Minister on May 18, 2026, at 10:00 a.m. at the Central Stadium in Thiruvananthapuram. Many have lauded Congress' decision to back the unpredictable candidate, while others questioned its rationale. According to the latest reports, Satheesan secured the chair with backing from major UDF allies. Additionally, he received internal support, with senior Congress leader AK Antony stating that Satheesan commands significant grassroots backing, which would benefit the party. Amid the buzz around the new Chief Minister of the state, who has an over 96 percent literacy rate, his personal life is in the spotlight. Here's everything we know about his family background, including his parents, and his spouse, R Lakshmi Priya. VD Satheesan's journey from a lawyer to the CM of Kerala PC: File Photo VD Satheesan is a senior Indian National Congress leader who was named as the 13th Chief Minister of Kerala. His appointment followed the Congress-led United Democratic Front's (UDF) massive victory in the 2026 Kerala Assembly elections, in which it secured 102 out of 140 seats. It subsequently shifted the political winds in the state by ending a decade of rule by the Left D

186. EC to conduct SIR of electoral rolls in Odisha from May 30, says CEO

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Business Standard

■ **URL:** https://www.business-standard.com/india-news/ec-to-conduct-sir-of-electoral-rolls-in-odisha-from-may-30-says-ceo-126051500773_1.html

■ **Summary:**

The EC will conduct a month-long Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Odisha from May 30, an official said on Friday. The exercise will continue till June 28, while the final electoral rolls after the revision will be published on September 6, Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of Odisha R S Gopalan said. He said training of booth-level officers (BLOs) and booth-level agents (BLAs) will be conducted between May 20 and 29, following which BLOs will undertake door-to-door verification from May 30 to June 28. He informed that rationalisation of the polling stations will also be completed by June 28. The draft electoral rolls will be published on July 5, and claims and objections can be filed till August 4. Also Read Delhi voter list revision exercise to begin from June 30: Officials SC says free and fair polls need an independent Election Commission No shortage, yet long queues at fuel pumps; Odisha, Jharkhand see curbspremium Odisha CM Mohan Majhi halves convoy, urges citizens to use public transport Crude tanker detained off Odisha coast over unpaid bunker fuel dues After disposal of the objections, the final electoral rolls will be published on September 6, he said. Currently, Odisha has 38,123 polling booths, and the number will increase to 45,255 after completion of the exercise, the CEO said. As part of the revision process, 45,255 BLOs will conduct house-to-house verification across the state. So far, seven political parties have appointed 27,723 BLAs for the

187. Who is Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar? The TMC MP Mamata Banerjee dropped as Lok Sabha Chief Whip after 40 years of loyalty

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Zee News

■ **URL:** <https://zeenews.india.com/india/who-is-kakoli-ghosh-dastidar-mamata-banerjee-removes-tmc-chief-whip-3047697.html>

■ **Summary:**

TMC supremo and former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee has removed Dr Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar as the Trinamool Congress Chief Whip in the Lok Sabha, replacing her with Kalyan Banerjee. Kakoli had held the post for only nine months after being appointed in August 2025. The decision comes in the backdrop of the TMC's recent electoral setbacks in West Bengal and is being seen as a significant shift within the party leadership. Also Read: Heaven on Earth exists in India! Inside the stunning Valley of Flowers & 7 other breathtaking global floral paradises - See pic

Who is Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar? TMC MP's political journey A doctor-turned-politician from Barasat, Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar has represented the constituency in the Lok Sabha four consecutive times in 2009, 2014, 2019 and 2024. Currently serving in the 18th Lok Sabha, the 66-year-old leader has long been regarded as one of Mamata Banerjee's trusted loyalists. Their political association reportedly dates back to student politics in 1976, making it a relationship that has spanned nearly five decades. Over the years, Kakoli has held several key organisational positions within the Trinamool Congress. She previously served as the National President of the All India Trinamool Mahila Congress and is also a member of the Panel of Chairpersons in the Lok Sabha. Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar's medical career and family background

Apart from politics, she has an extensive medical background. Specialising in Obstetrics and Gynaecology,

188. CBI raids seven locations in ■550-cr Haryana fund siphoning case

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Hindustan Times

■ **URL:** <https://www.hindustantimes.com/cities/chandigarh-news/cbi-raids-seven-locations-in-550-cr-haryana-fund-siphoning-case-101778836421028.html>

■ **Summary:**

On April 8, the federal agency took over the probe into the alleged misappropriation of more than ■550 crore of Haryana government funds parked with IDFC First Bank and AU Small Finance Bank. A CBI spokesperson said the allegation is that certain officials of IDFC First Bank and AU Small Finance Bank, in connivance with Haryana officials working in various departments misappropriated government funds through fraudulent means. The spokesperson said search operations were conducted at seven locations, including houses, business establishments/showrooms of jewellers, premises of suspected beneficiaries of the misappropriated government funds, and other private entities connected with the investigation. "During searches, various incriminating documents and articles were recovered and seized. These include financial records and digital evidence pertaining to the fraud and suspected misappropriation. So far, 16 people have been arrested in the case and several leads are being pursued," the spokesperson said. The CBI registered a regular case (RC), equivalent to an FIR, replicating the first information report by the Haryana Anti-Corruption Bureau (ACB) on February 23, 2026, against unknown accused. The RC was registered after the Haryana government made a reference to the Centre granting its consent. On April 8, the central government issued a notification through the department of personnel and training under Section 5 of the DSPE Act, extending CBI's jurisdiction to Haryana for i

189. Udhayanidhi's team to review DMK's poll debacle across Tamil Nadu

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** dtNext.in

■ **URL:** <https://www.dtnext.in/news/tamilnadu/udhayanidhis-team-to-review-dmks-pol-l-debacle-across-tamil-nadu>

■ **Summary:**

CHENNAI: The Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) has constituted a 36-member committee led largely by young functionaries close to Udhayanidhi Stalin to review the party's poor performance in the recently concluded Assembly election. The party, which had publicly targeted more than 200 seats, managed to secure only 59 seats in the election. Following the defeat, DMK president M. K. Stalin held discussions with district secretaries and took responsibility for the unexpected setback. At the same time, he announced that a detailed district-wise review would be undertaken to identify the reasons behind the defeat. As part of the exercise, the party has formed a 36-member panel, with each two-member team assigned to review the performance in two or three districts.

190. Democrats Back Independents in Some Red State Races | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/democrats-back-independents-in-some-red-state-races-7431295.html>

■ **Summary:**

NEW YORK (AP) -- Democratic leaders, desperate to compete in red states where their party brand is toxic, are embracing something new this midterm season: Not backing Democrats. In states like Nebraska, Idaho and Alaska, Democratic officials are, in some cases, looking past their own party's candidates while subtly encouraging -- or even openly promoting -- independent candidates they hope can outperform the Democratic label. The Democratic National Committee and some of its

allies in Washington are quietly supporting the new strategy. Meanwhile, some of the independent candidates are chatting in a group text about their approach as they plot a path that could shake up Congress, which is consumed by partisan gridlock. Also Read | Death Toll in Attack on Kyiv Apartment Building Rises to 24. Nebraska Democrats this week chose a nominee for U.S. Senate, Cindy Burbank, who said a major campaign priority was to ensure a Democrat wouldn't be on the fall ballot to pull support from independent Dan Osborn. Shortly after polls closed, Burbank reiterated her plan to drop out in the coming weeks during a private conversation with a party official, according to state Democratic chair Jane Kleeb. Democratic leaders believe Osborn, who came within 7 points of winning a Senate seat in 2024, has the best chance to defeat Republican Sen. Pete Ricketts. Democrats' pivot toward independents is part of an intentional strategy in some places -- and something closer to a wink and a nod in others -

191. Paranjpe was inducted in Shiv Sena to stop him from joining MVA; NCP was kept in loop: Uday Samant

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Economic Times

■ **URL:** <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/politics-and-nation/paranjpe-was-inducted-in-shiv-sena-to-stop-him-from-joining-mva-ncp-was-kept-in-loop-uday-samant/articleshow/131112584.cms>

■ Summary:

Mumbai, Maharashtra minister Uday Samant on Friday said former NCP leader Anand Paranjpe was inducted into the Shiv Sena to stop him from joining any Opposition party, and added that the Sunetra Pawar-led party was kept in the loop about his induction to avoid any misunderstanding with it. Paranjpe on Thursday resigned from the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP) helmed by Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar, and later joined the Eknath Shinde-led Shiv Sena. Both the NCP and

Shiv Sena are part of the ruling Mahayuti in Maharashtra along with the BJP. Addressing a press conference on Friday, Samant said Paranjpe, a two-time MP who represented the Shiv Sena from Thane and Kalyan Lok Sabha constituencies, was inducted into the Shiv Sena to ensure that he does not enter any Maha Vikas Aghadi (MVA) party. "We were of the opinion that Anand Paranjpe should not enter any MVA party," the Shiv Sena leader said. "When we decided to induct Paranjpe into Shiv Sena, Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde tried to call NCP president Sunetra Pawar, but she was in an event and they could not talk immediately," he said. After that the party tried to contact NCP MP Parth Pawar, but could not get through to him. Then, his younger brother Jay Pawar was contacted and he was informed about the Paranjpe's induction into the Shiv Sena, the minister added. "The NCP leaders were informed because we did not want any misunderstanding within the Mahayuti," Samant noted. Paranjpe, son of veteran Shiv Sena lead

192. "Mamata Banerjee trying to build her image, gain sympathy by presenting herself as lawyer": BJP's Arjun Singh

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Asian News International (ANI)

■ **URL:** <https://www.aninews.in/news/national/politics/mamata-banerjee-trying-to-build-her-image-gain-sympathy-by-presenting-herself-as-lawyer-bjps-arjun-singh20260515143941/>

■ **Summary:**

Kolkata (West Bengal) [India], May 15 (ANI): BJP MLA Arjun Singh on Friday launched a sharp attack on former West Bengal Chief Minister and Trinamool Congress (TMC) chief Mamata Banerjee after her appearance at the Calcutta High Court in a lawyer's attire in connection with a post-poll violence-related PIL, alleging that she was attempting to build sympathy through "strategic optics." Reacting to Banerjee appearing in court wearing an advocate's robe, Singh said the move was

politically motivated and would not succeed in influencing public perception. "Mamata Banerjee is trying to build her image, presenting herself as a lawyer to gain sympathy. These are her strategies, but the people of Bengal have rejected her. She now has no place in Bengal, and her party is almost finished," Arjun Singh told ANI. His remarks come after Mamata Banerjee appeared before the Calcutta High Court in connection with a PIL on alleged post-poll violence following the 2026 West Bengal Assembly elections. The petition was filed by advocate Sirsanya Banerjee, son of Trinamool Congress leader-cum-advocate Kalyan Bandopadhyay and also a TMC candidate from Uttarpara Assembly constituency. The petitioner alleged incidents of post-poll violence in several areas, including attacks on party offices and the displacement of workers. During the hearing, Banerjee urged the court for "immediate protection of people," alleging large-scale violence, arson and attacks on party workers after the election results. S

193. Satheesan defends IUML; terms it a deterrent against communal forces

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** metrovaartha.com

■ **URL:** <https://english.metrovaartha.com/news/kerala/satheesan-defends-iuml-terms-it-a-deterrent-against-communal-forces>

■ **Summary:**

Thiruvananthapuram | Kerala CM-designate V D Satheesan on Friday defended Congress ally and UDF partner, IUML, saying it played a decisive role in the alliance victory and was also a major deterrent against communal forces in the state. The Congress leader, speaking to reporters, said that anyone accusing the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) of being communal was trying to create a divide in Kerala. The League was one of the major backers of Satheesan for the post of CM and has faced considerable flak from various quarters over it. The CM-designate also accused the

BJP, which has been attacking the IUML and accusing it of interfering in the chief minister selection process, of spreading hatred and divisiveness at the national and state level. "The League was attacked on communal grounds during the election time also. They are an important coalition partner of the UDF and Congress and played a decisive role in our victory. They have been with us since the time of (veteran Cong leader and former CM) K Karunakaran and have an important role in the alliance."

194. No women on the table: Why Trump-Xi summit faced backlash for being masculine and exclusionary

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Firstpost

■ **URL:** <https://www.firstpost.com/world/no-women-on-the-table-why-trump-xi-summit-faced-backlash-for-being-masculine-and-exclusionary-14011550.html>

■ Summary:

In a brief yet poignant tweet, Gita Gopinath, an American economist and former deputy managing director of the International Monetary Fund (IMF), pointed out how no woman was sitting at the delegation-level talks between US President Donald Trump and his Chinese counterpart, Xi Jinping. "A painting of the end of meritocracy: A meeting of the two largest economies and not one woman at the table," Gopinath wrote in the post, sharing a photograph of the meeting, which took place on Thursday. However, the lack of women was not the only concerning takeaway from the highly anticipated US-China Summit. The lack of mention of human rights abuses, the plight of prisoners and China's tendency to flex its muscles around the world also garnered attention. With the two leaders mainly discussing trade and ongoing wars in Iran and Ukraine, many pointed out how the summit was more militarised and exclusionary, rather than addressing human interest issues. No women at the Trump-Xi delegation-level talks The bilateral summit featured all the expected pomp and pageantry. However, conspicuously absent at the table during the delegation-level

talks were women. The masculine visual garnered criticism from many experts. "We have somehow gravitated back to this idea that what matters is your network and not your capabilities - and that matters [in terms of] whether or not you get a seat at the table," Gopinath told The Guardian. "It's just inexplicable how you end up with a single-gender table, give

195. Keir Starmer to be ousted as UK PM? How a leadership challenge could unfold

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** Firstpost

■ **URL:** <https://www.firstpost.com/explainers/keir-starmer-to-be-ousted-as-uk-pm-how-a-leadership-challenge-could-unfold-14011551.html>

■ **Summary:**

British Prime Minister Keir Starmer is on the ropes politically. Reuters Keir Starmer is fighting for his political life. Dozens of MPs have called on the beleaguered UK Prime Minister to step down or at least set out a timetable for his exit. This comes after Labour's disastrous performance in the recent local body polls in England, Scotland and Wales, which saw the anti-immigrant Reform UK, led by Nigel Farage, make massive gains. Now, a number of challengers have emerged to take on Starmer. Starmer thus far has indicated that he is in no mood to do so. Earlier this week, Starmer, in a major speech to the Labour Party, said that Britain is a "reasonable, tolerant and decent" country and vowed not to walk away. But dark clouds are already on the horizon for Starmer. So, how could a leadership challenge against the UK PM unfold? Let's take a closer look. Rivals emerge Starmer has a slew of challengers lining up to take him on for the prime ministership. At the top of the list is Wes Streeting, who resigned as UK Health Secretary. Streeting wrote in his resignation letter to Starmer that, despite his "courage and statesmanship", "where we need vision, we have a vacuum". "These are all good reasons for me to remain in post, but

as you know from our conversation earlier this week, having lost confidence in your leadership, I have concluded that it would be dishonourable and unprincipled to do so," Streeting said. "It is now clear that you will not lead the Labour Party into the

196. Sri Lankan, British, Canadian nationals held for 'illegal voting' in Tamil Nadu

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** The News Minute

■ **URL:** <https://www.thenewsminute.com/tamil-nadu/sri-lankan-british-canadian-nationals-held-for-illegal-voting-in-tamil-nadu>

■ **Summary:**

Follow TNM's channel for news updates and story links. At least 25 foreign nationals were detained on Thursday, May 14, for illegally casting votes in the recently concluded Tamil Nadu Assembly elections despite holding foreign citizenship. The detentions were made at airports as the accused were attempting to flee the country. Most of those detained were Sri Lankan nationals, while others held British, Canadian, and Indonesian passports, according to reports. Authorities have seized the Electors Photo Identity Cards (EPICs) of the accused. The crackdown followed intelligence inputs received by law enforcement agencies about foreign nationals engaging in electoral malpractice. Based on these inputs, airport authorities across Tamil Nadu were alerted to identify passengers bearing indelible ink marks on their index fingers -- an indication that they had recently voted. Most of the detentions took place at Chennai airport, reports said. Among those detained were Sri Lankan nationals Ranjini (59), Sarfudeen (68), Nilanthi (44), Jeyanthan (40), Charlie Balachandran (48), Chakravarthy Logapriya (50), and Sunitha Chakravarthy (48). Officials also identified Ayyadurai (53) from the United Kingdom, Tittin Mariattu (47) from Indonesia, and Jitthendranath (38) from Canada. One of the detainees, reportedly a person of Indian origin whose identity is yet to be verified, is alleged to have acquired British citizenship in 2015 but voted in the Pattukkottai Assembly constituency in Thanjavu

197. India News | Delhi Police Crime Branch Arrests Proclaimed Offender Linked to Mewati Gang | LatestLY

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** LatestLY

■ **URL:** <https://www.latestly.com/agency-news/india-news-delhi-police-crime-branch-arrests-proclaimed-offender-linked-to-mewati-gang-7431289.html>

■ **Summary:**

New Delhi [India], May 15 (ANI): The NDR team of the Delhi Police Crime Branch arrested a notorious criminal and proclaimed offender associated with an interstate Mewati gang from Haryana. The accused was wanted in connection with a mobile showroom theft case worth Rs 35 lakh registered at Vasant Kunj North police station. According to police, after the FIR was registered, the accused had been constantly changing his hideouts and moving across different states to evade arrest. To nab him, the Crime Branch team carried out continuous technical surveillance, gathered local intelligence, and conducted field operations in the Mewat area for more than 10 days. Also Read | Kerala Lottery Result Today 3 PM Live: Suvama Keralam SK-52 Lottery Result of May 15, 2026, Watch Lucky Draw Winner List. After sustained efforts, the police team finally managed to apprehend the accused. Investigation has revealed that he has previously been involved in several serious criminal cases, including murder, theft, and burglary. Police are currently interrogating the accused, while efforts are underway to trace and arrest his other associates. Also Read | 8th Pay Commission: Employees Seek Pension Equal to 50% of Final Salary Plus DA. In another incident, Delhi Police Crime Branch arrested a proclaimed offender carrying a reward of Rs 50,000 from Anantnag in Jammu and Kashmir in connection with a fraud case registered at Mahendra Park Police Station. The accused had been absconding for several years

198. Former food and supplies minister being questioned by ED

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <https://www.uniindia.com/~former-food-and-supplies-minister-being-questioned-by-ed/States/news/3843926.html>

■ **Summary:**

Kolkata, May 15 (UNI) The former minister of the food and supplies department Rathin Ghosh landed at the Enforcement Directorate (ED) office in Salt Lake's CGO Complex for questioning on Friday morning regarding the public distribution and municipal recruitment scam. Ghosh, a senior Trinamool Congress (TMC) functionary, had earlier skipped five summons issued by the central agency. On Friday, he entered the CGO Complex at around 11am. Speaking briefly to reporters before entering the office, the Trinamool Congress leader claimed he was uncertain about the exact reasons behind the summons. "I don't know why they have called me," Ghosh said in the lobby of the CGO Complex before heading to the ED office. The ED had earlier issued multiple notices to Ghosh before the recently concluded West Bengal Assembly elections. However, he did not attend the earlier questioning sessions, reportedly citing commitments related to his election campaign. Despite the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) sweeping the West Bengal elections, Ghosh managed to retain the Madhyamgram seat in North 24 Parganas for the TMC. The victory marked his fourth successive win from the constituency since 2011. Earlier this week, another former minister of the erstwhile TMC government, Sujit Bose, was arrested by the agency in connection with the municipal recruitment scam. Bose, who previously served as Fire Services Minister, was taken into custody late on 11 May after nearly ten hours of interrogation at the ED's Sal

199. If Keir Starmer Quits As PM, Would Britain Face A General Election?

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** News18

■ **URL:** <https://www.news18.com/world/if-keir-starmer-quits-as-pm-would-britain-face-a-general-election-ws-l-10092915.html>

■ **Summary:**

More than 90 Labour lawmakers have now reportedly either called for Starmer to resign or asked him to set out a clear timetable for his departure. British Prime Minister Keir Starmer is facing the gravest political challenge of his premiership so far after a wave of anger within the Labour Party following heavy local election losses triggered open calls for his departure. The crisis escalated after senior cabinet minister and Health Secretary Wes Streeting resigned and publicly declared that Starmer "wouldn't lead the party for much longer", urging him to facilitate a leadership contest with the "best possible field of candidates". More than 90 Labour lawmakers have now reportedly either called for Starmer to resign or asked him to set out a clear timetable for his departure. But despite the growing rebellion, removing a sitting British prime minister is neither automatic nor straightforward. If Starmer were eventually forced out, or chose to resign voluntarily, Britain would not immediately head into a general election. Instead, Labour would first have to choose a new leader, who would automatically become prime minister. So how exactly would that process work? Has A Leadership Challenge Against Starmer Already Begun? Not formally. Although discontent inside Labour has spilled into the open, no official leadership contest has yet been triggered. Starmer has insisted he is continuing with the job and has shown no public indication that he intends to resign. Under Labour Party

200. Former food and supplies minister being questioned by ED

■ **Date:** 2026-05-15

■ **Source:** United News of India

■ **URL:** <http://www.uniindia.com/former-food-and-supplies-minister-being-questioned-by-ed/east/news/3843926.html>

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